ENGLEUPHORIA ACADEMY

Academy Hub
Curriculum & Lesson Handbook

The curriculum roadmap, the lesson blueprint, the lesson plan, the game and video-game lists and the supporting research, for the Academy hub (ages 13–18, Pre-A1 to C1, one-to-one 60-minute live lessons), with B1 Season 1, Lesson 1 “Have You Ever...? · Cold Open” set out in full.

Compiled 15 October 2026, updated 16 October 2026 with the framework summary (Part 0), the check against the platform (Part 8) and the top-quality lesson standard (Part 10) from the repository (curriculum code in `src/curriculum/academy`, lesson deck in `src/academy-deck`, documents in `docs/`).
Status: working document. The lesson is not yet published to students; no human teacher has reviewed the plan yet.

Contents

0. The framework at a glance
- Curriculum architecture and the 8-episode Season
- The 60-minute Run of Show
- Pedagogical rules and gates
- Games and video-game mechanics
- Why it is built this way

1. The Academy Hub at a glance
- Rules and structure
- Hub separation
- Season and unit structure

2. Curriculum blueprint
- Pre-A1 to C1 at a glance
- Pre-A1 seasons
- A1, A2, B1, B2, C1 season tables
- B1 Season 1 in detail

3. Lesson blueprint: B1-S01-E1
- Blueprint card
- Run of show
- The twelve new items
- The eight lessons of Season B1-S01

4. Lesson plan: B1-S01-E1
- Approved plan v2 (60 minutes)
- The lesson as built (page by page)
- Season spec and research

5. Games and video-game mechanics
- Games used in this lesson
- Games and activities catalogue
- Video-game mechanics

6. Teaching framework
- Lesson plan template
- Teacher checklist
- Speaking practice
- Recall, spacing and progression
- Learning science
- Experience design

7. Appendix: research and background
- B1 Season 1 research
- Curriculum benchmarks
- Teen games and memory games
- Ladder, lesson system, Pre-A1

8. Check against the platform
- What matches, what differs, what is unverified

9. Appendix: lesson JSON contract and Claude Code skill (proposal)
- JSON contract
- Skill file text

10. The top-quality lesson standard (all skills combined)
- Which skill answers which question
- The build order
- The combined quality bar

One-to-one online design

Worked audit of B1-S01-E1

What it does not claim

How to read this. Parts 1–3 are generated straight from the curriculum code, so they match what the platform uses. Parts 4–7 reproduce the project documents as written; where a document and the code disagree, the code (and the “as built” page in Part 4) is the current truth.

0. The framework at a glance

> **Source of this part.** The deck "The Architecture of Language Acquisition: Engineering the 8-Episode Progression and the 60-Minute Loop for Teen Learners" (15 slides, Gemini Notebook) and the framework notes supplied with it. The marks ✓ (matches the platform), ⚠ (differs or is not a project rule) and ? (could not be verified) come from the check in Part 8.

One cohesive system for **teens aged 13–18** (Pre-A1 to C1) that joins the curriculum roadmap, the 60-minute lesson blueprint and the game mechanics. Three ideas run through it: **no childish mascots** (peer-like cast only), **no public shaming** (private-first rehearsal, "I need a minute", psychological safety), and **pure progressive stacking** (task-based output and spaced retrieval in every minute). Language acquisition is engineered, not accidental: second-language-acquisition science, teen psychology and game design have to be balanced.

Traditional ESL and the Academy Hub

	Traditional ESL	The Academy Hub
Input	Massed reading and isolated vocabulary lists	Spaced, chunked encounters, several per lesson (the deck says a minimum of 6, see Part 8 ⚠)
Speaking	Forced public reading with high anxiety	Private-first rehearsal, student-chosen difficulty dials, one-to-one Missions
Assessment	High-stakes testing and red-pen corrections	Delayed, specific feedback and portfolio "Releases" with six-strand checkpoints
Pacing	Arbitrary units tied to textbook chapters	8-episode "Seasons" driven by video-game mechanics and narrative progression

1. Curriculum architecture and unit progression

- Target: teens 13–18, levels Pre-A1 to C1 ✓.
- Size: 80 Seasons and 640 live sessions (A1 12, A2 14, B1 18, B2 18, C1 18 Seasons) ✓.
- Three-tier knowledge bridge: every lesson connects prior knowledge (recycled from earlier sessions), the current target chunks and grammar, and future knowledge (what it unlocks) ✓ ("builds on / unlocks" in the blueprint).
- Progressive stack: Lesson 3 = Lesson 1 + Lesson 2 + Lesson 3 ✓ (eight 60-minute sessions take the learner from decoding on Day 1 towards unscripted speech by Day 8).

The 8-episode Season stack

Episode	Focus	Language load	Purpose
E1 Cold Open	Listening and reading (gist)	Receptive items only; the deck says ≤ 12 (⚠ see Part 8)	Story hook and context; no forced production of new language yet
E2 Word Lab	Vocabulary and pronunciation	≤ 14 core words or chunks ✓	Core vocabulary and sound; two different memorising games per word set
E3 Pattern Lab	Grammar and writing	1 core pattern ✓	Inductive noticing, a plain rule of 3 lines or fewer, gamified controlled practice
E4 On Air	Functional speaking	Functional chunks	Real-life exchange: guided role-play using the E2 and E3 language
E5 Deep Dive	Reading and writing	Receptive words from a longer text	Longer graded text or clip and a short written piece with a rewrite
E6 Side Quest	Integrated, high choice	Light new language	Student choice: Exam Lane, School English bridge or a cultural/interest skin
E7 Remix	Spaced consolidation	**Zero** new language ✓	Mixed retrieval, confusable contrasts interleaved, a cross-episode boss fight
E8 Finale	Spoken and written product	**Zero** new language ✓	Peer-style task, the Release (portfolio product) and the six-strand checkpoint

2. The 60-minute lesson and its Run of Show

51 minutes core (never skipped) and 9 minutes flex (the Check-in and the Energiser) ✓. The deck groups the eight stages into four phases: **Warm-up and recall** (0–12), **Input and drill** (12–32), **Peak output** (32–48), **Ownership and wrap** (48–60).

#	Stage	Minutes	Core	Purpose	Method
1	**Check-in**	0–5	flex	Safety, energy, mission brief	Picture mood check (never emoji), 2–3 low-stakes questions, today's mission and success criteria
2	**Remember?**	5–12	core	Spaced retrieval and the Mistake Bank	Starts with the student's own error list, then calendar-due items; 8–12 items, ≥ 60% production, feedback on every item
3	**The Drop**	12–22	core	Meaning-first input and modelling (I do)	3–5 full-bleed scene plates; every new word met on its own page before any game; two different memorising games per word set
4	**Notice & Build**	22–32	core	Guided discovery, the rule, controlled practice (we do)	Inductive noticing, a plain rule of ≤ 3 lines, controlled games with immediate feedback

#	Stage	Minutes	Core	Purpose	Method
5	**Energiser**	32–36	flex	Attention reset, zero stakes	A game with no timer and no public score (for example Wordle or Two Truths and a Lie)
6	**Mission**	36–48	core	Pushed output with student control	Help dial (Chill / Normal / Push) → Take 1 → specific feedback → Take 2 in the same lesson
7	**Release**	48–55	core	Portfolio product (you do)	Un-scaffolded exit task, model hidden, recorded privately first, then saved to the portfolio
8	**Wrap**	55–60	core	Metacognition and hand-off	Honest can-do ticks, log up to three recurring errors for the next Mistake Bank, assign the Daily 10, reveal the next clue

Speaking ladder: Shadow → Repeat → Controlled → Guided → Free ✓. **Cognitive energy arc:** load rises through Notice & Build, drops at the Energiser, peaks at the Mission, then settles in the Wrap, "a heartbeat": a mental reset comes just before the peak of unscripted speech, so students are stretched, never broken. The model is also meant to be fractal: the 60-minute error loop, repeated encounters and the Daily 10 spacing carry Episode 1 vocabulary into the Episode 8 Finale, with at least **80 student responses per hour** ✓.

3. Pedagogical rules and governance gates

Rule	Value	Check
New items per session	At most 14 (at most 8 in Pre-A1); zero in E7 and E8	✓ code
Encounter density	Deck: every item met, retrieved and used at least 6 times across 4 skills or modes within the hour	⚠ not a project rule (Part 8)
Student talk-time floor	Pre-A1 40%, A1 45%, A2 50%, B1 55%, B2 60%, C1 65%; teacher talk ≤ 40% (deck)	✓ student floors in code (speaking.ts); teacher cap not coded
Cast vault	Vee, Ava, Theo and Mia only; no childish mascots (Pip belongs to the Playground)	✓ hub separation
Vocabulary game rule	Two different memorising games after every vocabulary introduction	✓ code
Variety gate	No game kind three times in a row; at least five distinct game kinds per lesson; the scene setting must differ from the previous lesson	✓ deploy test

4. Games and video-game mechanics

The catalogue lists **171** classroom and digital games (Part 5; older notes say 148). Mechanics borrowed from video games:

Mechanic	Game	What the student does
Boss fight	Break the Clock	Hit points and shields; strike with the correct tense; an error costs a shield and shows the reason
Dialogue RPG / visual novel	Rapport, The Dare	Choose natural replies; a relationship meter rises; branching story on scene plates
Detective board / bug hunt	Grammar Detective, Glitch Hunt	Sort evidence; find and repair the glitch in a chat
Crafting and loot	Trophy Forge	Combine base, past and participle tiles into a trophy
Match-3 combos	Triple Match	Link three matching forms; combo multipliers for first-try matches
Quiz-show ladder	Hot Seat	Millionaire-style ladder with 50:50 and Ask a friend lifelines
Word puzzle	Participle Wordle	Spell the target form in six tries with colour feedback
Card draw and talk show	Verb Draw	Match the trios, then draw a verb and open a conversation with it
Deduction and bluffing	Codenames Duet, Alibi, Taboo-lite, Two Truths and a Lie	Co-operative word association, circumlocution, spotting the lie

Teen-comfort rules: no public leaderboards, no rank-shaming, no timer pressure on speaking, no forced on-camera charades; co-op and personal-best modes only; private before public. **Variety gate:** a deploy test fails a lesson that repeats a game kind three times in a row, has fewer than five distinct game kinds, or reuses the previous lesson's scene setting.

1. The Academy Hub at a glance

Rules and structure

Who	Teens 13–18. (The Playground is ages 4–12.) An Academy student has already met hello, numbers and countries at school, so A1 lessons revise fast and spend the time on what school did not teach. Never childish.
Levels	Pre-A1 (reading-first) then A1, A2, B1, B2, C1.
Size	80 Seasons and 640 sessions from A1 to C1 (A1 12, A2 14, B1 18, B2 18, C1 18 Seasons). Pre-A1 has 5 planned Seasons.
Structure	Level → Season (= unit, 8 sessions) → Episode → 60-minute one-to-one live session.
The eight episodes	E1 Cold Open (hook and context text, gist only) · E2 Word Lab (vocabulary and pronunciation) · E3 Pattern Lab (grammar noticing) · E4 On Air (real-life exchange) · E5 Deep Dive (longer text and a short written piece) · E6 Side Quest (student's pick, light new language) · E7 Remix (consolidation, no new language) · E8 Finale (peer task, Release, checkpoint, no new language).
New language	At most 14 new items per session; only E1–E6 may introduce language.
Cast	Vee (mentor voice), Ava, Theo, Mia. Only the vault cast, no invented characters, no mascots.
Every lesson has	An approved written plan; a model step and a stated rule before practice, and a teach-back; a spaced Remember? warm-up; at least 80 student responses per hour; speaking as the largest share; a teacher checklist for the report; a games list and a video-game mechanic; research logged with sources.
Look and feel	Full-bleed bright daytime school scenes, light, reserved and age-appropriate, about 25% purple; every object a cut-out sticker; recorded American voices only (never the browser voice).
Languages	The chrome is translated into English, Spanish, French, Arabic, Turkish and Italian; lesson content stays English.

Source: docs/hub-separation.md

Hub separation — each hub owns its blueprints (owner rule, 2026-10-08)

> "The playground blueprint, curriculum blueprint and lesson blueprint are apart from the academy and success. Each one has their own." "Don't touch the playground." "Don't touch the legacy." — owner

Ownership

Hub	Curriculum blueprint	Lesson blueprint	Skills	Docs
Playground (ages 4–12)	existing, **untouched** by Academy work	existing, **untouched**	`playground-*`, `smart-lesson-architect`, `lesson-quality-gate`, `generate-lesson`, `lesson-variety-engine`, … (unchanged)	existing
Academy (ages 13–18, A1 → C1)	`src/curriculum/academy/` — 80 Seasons (`levels/a1.ts` … `c1.ts` ; 70 until 2026-10-14), generated `docs/academy-roadmap-v2.md`	`src/curriculum/academy/lessonBlueprint.ts` — 640 session blueprints	`.claude/skills/academy-*` (9 skills)	`docs/academy-*.md`, `docs/research/academy-*.md`
Success (adults)	to be created when the owner asks — its own, never shared	its own	its own	its own

Rules

1. Academy work never edits, imports from, or reuses code of the Playground or Success blueprints, and never edits their skills or docs.
2. The old Academy rows in the database (`curriculum_lessons` with the legacy 10 × 7 Pre-A1/A1/A2/B1 blueprint) are **legacy**: not read, not changed, not migrated by Academy work. The new Academy roadmap lives in code until the owner decides how it reaches the database.
3. Shared multi-hub modules (for example `src/services/contentCreator/lessonBlueprint.ts`, which has a `Hub` union) are **not used** by the Academy. The Academy has its own types.
4. `src/curriculum/academy/__tests__/isolation.test.ts` fails if any file in that folder imports from outside it.
5. Truly shared infrastructure (authentication, UI kit, Supabase client, classroom video, the voice policy in `src/lib/speechPolicy.ts`) may be used by a hub's *player/UI code*, not by its blueprints.
6. Open item: `speak()` (the recorded-voice helper the voice rule requires) currently lives inside the Playground library. When the Academy player needs it, ask the owner where a neutral shared copy should live; do not import from the Playground library.

Source: docs/academy-unit-structure.md

Academy unit (Season) structure — four skills + grammar + vocabulary (proposal, 2026-10-14)

Status: proposal for owner approval. Builds on the existing Season (8 one-to-one 60-minute lessons, `docs/academy-lesson-system.md`). Evidence base: `docs/academy-learning-science.md` and `docs/research/academy-curriculum-teen-sla-and-l1-gaps.md` (search-based; several claims unverified there). Numbers marked [target] are design goals, not measured results.

1. Principle

One unit = one communicative goal (the Release) reached through **vocabulary → grammar → the four skills → a product**, with the **same items met many times, in different ways, spread over days**. Fast acquisition comes from repeated, varied, spaced retrieval and output with feedback, not from more input.

2. The skills × language matrix (headline focus per lesson; every lesson still touches all four skills)

Lesson	Headline	Vocabulary	Grammar	Listening	Speaking	Reading	Writing
E1 Cold Open	context + gist	meet ~12 words (receptive)	none (recycle)	**gist** from story	react, predict	context text	one-line reply
E2 Word Lab	vocabulary + sound	**core words, productive**	none	words in context	**repeat, say, pronounce**	word cards	type the words
E3 Pattern Lab	grammar	chunks tied to the pattern	**notice → rule → drill → free**	spot the pattern	**controlled → free sentences**	text with the pattern	write 3 sentences
E4 On Air	real exchange	functional chunks	pattern in use	**listen for detail**	**interaction (role-play)**	script	message
E5 Deep Dive	longer text	receptive words from text	pattern in text	listen to the text	retell	**longer text**	**short written piece**
E6 Side Quest	student's pick	light new language, student's skin	second pattern (optional)	integrated	integrated	integrated	integrated; **mediation / school / exam lane**
E7 Remix	retrieval	all unit words	all unit patterns	mixed	mixed	mixed	mixed (zero new language)
E8 Finale	product + check	—	—	checkpoint	**Release (spoken)**	checkpoint	**Release (written)**; checkpoint scores per strand

3. A lesson's inner structure (60 min, all four skills in every lesson)

Remember? (retrieval of the last two lessons) → Drop (listening/reading input, gist) → Learn set 1 (teach with I do / we do / you do, rule stated) → intensive gamified practice (≥ 80 responses; practice ladder; error-return loop) → Read/Listen (text) → Learn set 2 → Mission (speak or write the product) → Wrap (teach-back, Daily 10). Teacher talk ≤ 40 %.

4. Acquisition levers built into every unit

1. **Spaced retrieval:** Remember? every lesson; Daily 10 on days 1, 3, 7; items return in the next two units.
2. **Many encounters, many ways:** each item met ≥ 6 times in 4 modes (hear, say, build/spell, read, match, use) inside the lesson; ≥ 10 times in 7 days with the Daily 10 [target].
3. **Output with feedback:** every lesson ends in the student producing language (Mission), one thing done well + one to try, then Take 2.
4. **Interleaving:** old and new items and patterns mixed in practice; blocks only for the first few items.
5. **Chunks first, rule stated plainly, teach-back** (CLAUDE.md modelling rule).
6. **Small new load:** ≤ 14 new items per lesson (Pre-A1: 8); E7 and E8 add nothing.
7. **Error-return loop and mastery check** (move on at ~80 % with ≤ 1 hint, else the easier track).
8. **Gamified practice** from the 168-game catalogue plus a video-game mechanic, no leaderboards.
9. **Skills ledger:** across the unit each skill gets its target share (level frames in `src/curriculum/academy/levelFrames.ts`); a test fails a unit where a skill falls below its floor.

5. Unit rhythm and measurement

- 2 lessons a week = 4 weeks per unit; Daily 10 between lessons (10 min, split by skill).
- E8 checkpoint reports **six strands** (listening, speaking, reading, writing, vocabulary, grammar) so the parent and teacher see which one lags; a lagging strand gets extra Daily 10 time and a focus in the next unit's E1/E7.
- Unit success = Release produced + checkpoint at target + the unit's items "Known" in the item tracker (`academy-learner-diagnostics`).

6. What would change in the repo if approved

1. Add `skillFocus` (per lesson: headline skill + the four touchpoints) to the Season data and the lesson blueprint, and a validator for the skills ledger.
2. Make the six-strand checkpoint report part of E8's blueprint and the parent report.
3. Add the matrix above to `docs/academy-lesson-plan-template.md` (step 4) so every lesson plan states its four-skill touchpoints.
4. Regenerate `docs/academy-curriculum/*.md` with a per-Season matrix.

7. Decisions for the owner

1. Keep the 8-lesson Season and the E1–E8 roles, adding the matrix and the skills-ledger test?
2. Is the headline per lesson right (e.g. E5 reading + writing, E4 speaking + listening)?

3. Is a six-strand checkpoint report what parents and teachers should see?

2. Curriculum blueprint

Pre-A1 to C1 at a glance

Level	Seasons	Sessions	Cumulative items by end of level	Cambridge guided hours (record)
A1	12	96	940	~90-100 (not confirmed)
A2	14	112	1900	180-200
B1	18	144	3250	350-400
B2	18	144	4680	500-600
C1	18	144	6180	700-800

Pre-A1 seasons (reading-first)

Pre-A1 is reading-first: activate what the teen already knows, learn the sounds and blending, read decodable lines and a short real-looking message, then keep words from the reading in a word bank.

PA1-S01 · Hello, letters The Name Wall

Can-do:

- I can say hello and say my name: Hello! My name is ___.
- I can say the names of the letters in my name and spell it.
- I can hear and say the sounds s, a, t, p and blend them into words.
- I can read a short line of 3-5 words and match it to a picture.

Fixed chunk: My name is ___. · **Release:** The Name Wall: my name and three friends' names, read and said
Sounds: s, a, t, p · **Games:** listen and match, read and match, spelling puzzle, memory pairs, sound-blend slider
Video-game mechanic: Quest log: each solved name lights a letter on the Name Wall; loot-and-craft the letters into a name

E	Episode	Objective	New items
1	Cold Open	I can meet the Name Wall, say hello and my name, and hear the letters A to G.	hello, hi, bye, My name is, I am
2	Word Lab	I can say yes and no, name a boy, a girl and a friend, and hear s and a.	yes, no, boy, girl, friend
3	Pattern Lab	I can spell my name, hear t and p, and blend at, sat, pat, tap.	thanks, please, How do you spell it?
4	On Air	I can say a short hello dialogue with Theo: hello, my name is, how do you spell it, thanks.	Nice to meet you., Me too., Sorry?
5	Deep Dive	I can read a first text of five short lines and match each line to its picture.	the, is, a
6	Side Quest	I can choose my skin and read and build my own name and a friend's name.	
7	Remix	I can mix letters, sounds, hello chunks and four decodable words.	
8	Finale	I can build the Name Wall: my name and three friends' names, and say Hello! My name is ___.	

PA1-S02 · First sounds The Phone

Can-do:

- I can hear and say the sounds i, n, m, d and blend them with s, a, t, p into words such as sit, pin, map, dad.
- I can say and read "This is a ___." for things on a phone screen.
- I can read a short text of five lines and answer questions with a picture.

Fixed chunk: This is a ___. · **Release:** My phone-screen album: six labelled things I can read and say
Sounds: i, n, m, d · **Games:** sound-blend slider, listen and match, read and match, odd one out, memory pairs, reader page
Video-game mechanic: Loot and crafting: collect sound tiles and craft words; a rhythm lane for tapping the sounds in order

E	Episode	Objective	New items
1	Cold Open	I can meet the phone screen, hear i and n, and blend in, it, pin, tin.	phone, pin, tin, map, This is a ___.
2	Word Lab	I can hear m and d and blend mat, man, dad, did.	man, mat, dad, did, app, camera
3	Pattern Lab	I can say This is a ___ and swap the word: This is a map. This is a pin.	This is a ___., Is it a ___?, Yes, it is., No, it is not.
4	On Air	I can ask and answer with Theo: Is it a map? Yes, it is. No, it is not.	Sorry?, Again, please., Look!
5	Deep Dive	I can read five short lines and match each to its picture.	and, in, on
6	Side Quest	I can choose my skin and build and read three words of my own.	
7	Remix	I can mix the eight sounds, the chunk and the sight words.	
8	Finale	I can make my phone-screen album: six things, each read and said.	

PA1-S03 · Numbers and age The Lockers

Can-do:

- I can read and say the numbers 0 to 20, and tell thirteen from thirty.
- I can say my age and ask How old are you?
- I can say a phone number one digit at a time and write down one I hear.

Fixed chunk: I am ___. How old are you? · **Release:** My locker card: my name, my age, my phone number, three friends' ages
Sounds: · **Games:** locker code, listen and match, read and match, number bingo, speedrun vs own best
Video-game mechanic: Locker-code puzzle (escape room) and a speedrun against your own best time (no leaderboards)

E	Episode	Objective	New items
1	Cold Open	I can meet the lockers and read the numbers 0 to 10.	zero, one, two, three, four, five, six, number
2	Word Lab	I can read and say 11 to 20 and hear thirteen versus thirty.	eleven, twelve, thirteen, fourteen, fifteen, sixteen, seventeen, eighteen
3	Pattern Lab	I can say my age: I am fifteen. And ask: How old are you?	I am ___., How old are you?, age, old
4	On Air	I can say and write down a phone number, one digit at a time.	phone number, Say it again, please., Is that ___?
5	Deep Dive	I can read a locker list: name, age, number.	nineteen, twenty, ten
6	Side Quest	I can choose my skin and make a number card of my own.	
7	Remix	I can mix numbers, ages, phone numbers and the sounds from Seasons 1 and 2.	
8	Finale	I can make my locker card and say it to a friend.	

PA1-S04 · My things The School Bag

Can-do:

- I can hear and say the sounds o, c, b, g and blend words such as cap, bag, dog, top.
- I can say and read "It is a ___." and "It is an ___." for things in a school bag.
- I can read labels and short captions of up to six words and match them to pictures.

Fixed chunk: It is a / an ___. · **Release:** My bag label sheet: eight things in my bag, each labelled, read and said
Sounds: o, c, b, g · **Games:** sound-blend slider, tile stacker, whack-a-word, listen and match, read and match, odd one out, treasure hunt trail
Video-game mechanic: Inventory management: pack the bag by reading labels (loot and crafting, with a stepping-stones route)

E	Episode	Objective	New items
1	Cold Open	I can meet the school bag, hear o and c, and blend cap, cat, cot, on.	bag, cap, book, pen, It is a ___.
2	Word Lab	I can hear b and g and blend big, bag, dog, bin.	dog, bin, box, pot, top, mop
3	Pattern Lab	I can choose a or an: It is a bag. It is an apple.	It is a ___., It is an ___., a bag, an apple
4	On Air	I can ask and answer: What is it? It is a ___. Is it a ___?	What is it?, It is a ___., Is it your ___?, Yes, it is.
5	Deep Dive	I can read a six-line list of things in a bag and match lines to pictures.	on, in, not
6	Side Quest	I can choose my skin and label my own bag.	
7	Remix	I can mix twelve sounds, a/an and the labels.	
8	Finale	I can show my label sheet: eight things, each read and said.	

PA1-S05 · People and places The World Map

Can-do:

- I can hear and say the sounds e, u, h, r and blend words such as hen, run, red, bus.
- I can say and read "I am from ___." and "He / She is from ___." for people on a map.
- I can read a three-sentence profile of a person and answer questions about it.

Fixed chunk: I am from ___. He / She is from ___. · **Release:** My world-map card: me and three friends, each with a country, read and said
Sounds: e, u, h, r · **Games:** sound-blend slider, pairs bingo (minimal pairs), listen and match, read and match, guess who (map), memory pairs, battleship grid (map squares)
Video-game mechanic: World-map exploration: unlock countries on the map by reading profiles (quest log + detective board)

E	Episode	Objective	New items
1	Cold Open	I can meet the world map, hear e and u, and blend hen, run, bus, red.	map, friend, country, from
2	Word Lab	I can hear h and r and blend hat, hit, ran, rug.	he, she, boy, girl, man, woman
3	Pattern Lab	I can say I am from ___ and He / She is from ___.	I am from ___., He is from ___., She is from ___., Where are you from?
4	On Air	I can ask and answer: Where are you from? I am from ___.	Where are you from?, Nice to meet you., Me too., Where is he from?
5	Deep Dive	I can read a three-sentence profile and answer questions.	Spain, France, Italy, Turkey
6	Side Quest	I can choose my skin and add my own friends to the map.	
7	Remix	I can mix sixteen sounds, the chunks and the people.	

E	Episode	Objective	New items
8	Finale	I can show my world-map card: me and three friends.	

A1: season table (12 Seasons)

Season	Title and theme	Release (what the student makes)	Grammar introduced	New items	Note
A1-S01	**Who Are You?** Online profiles and meeting people	My profile card plus a 30-second voice introduction	be (am/is/are): statements, questions, negatives (with who / what / where / how questions as chunks (What's your name? Where are you from?)); possessive adjectives (my/your/his/her/our/their)	80	
A1-S02	**My Room, My Stuff** Rooms, gadgets and where things are	A voice-note tour of my room	there is / there are (with a / an / the and plural -s nouns); prepositions of place (in/on/under/next to/behind)	80	Big Remix
A1-S03	**Free Time Club** Hobbies and the Club Fair	A 45-second pitch for a club I would start	present simple (I/you/we/they): statements and negatives; like/love/hate + -ing	80	
A1-S04	**Café Night** Food, drinks and ordering	A short café role-play with my own menu	some / any with countable and uncountable nouns; I'd like … / Would you like …? (as a chunk first)	80	Big Remix
A1-S05	**A Day in My Life** Daily routines and the school day	A short vlog script and recording of my day	present simple he/she/it (-s) and questions with does; adverbs of frequency (always/usually/sometimes/never)	80	
A1-S06	**Family and Friends** People close to me	My family or friends tree with a spoken description of three people	have got / has got; possessive 's (with object pronouns (him / her / them))	80	Big Remix
A1-S07	**Treasure Map Town** Places in town and giving directions	A voice guide that leads a friend to a hidden place on a map	imperatives (instructions, directions); prepositions of movement (to/into/out of/along/across)	80	
A1-S08	**Can Do!** Talents and abilities	A talent card: what I can and cannot do, with one demonstration	can / can't for ability; and / but / because (simple linking)	80	Big Remix
A1-S09	**Market Day** Clothes, shopping and money	A market role-play: buying and selling with prices	this / that / these / those; how much / how many and prices	80	
A1-S10	**Right Now** What is happening now: a live stream	A 60-second live commentary clip	present continuous for actions happening now; wh-questions and question word order	80	Big Remix
A1-S11	**Plan the Weekend** Days, dates, times and invitations	A weekend plan chat: invite a friend, give day and time, and accept or politely decline	want / need + to-infinitive (want / need + to-infinitive for plans and obligations); prepositions of time (in / on / at) (in the morning / on Saturday / at six o'clock)	70	
A1-S12	**Lost and Found** Belongings, whose is it and describing objects	A lost-property report: describe an object, say whose it is and hand it back (a short spoken role-play)	articles a / an / the and regular and irregular plural nouns (a / an / the and regular and irregular plurals to describe objects); object pronouns (me / you / him / her / it / us / them) (me / him / her / us / them after verbs and prepositions)	70	Level check

A2: season table (14 Seasons)

Season	Title and theme	Release (what the student makes)	Grammar introduced	New items	Note
A2-S01	**Last Weekend** Telling a story about the past	A voice note telling the story of my last weekend	past simple of be (was/were); past simple: regular verbs (-ed)	69	
A2-S02	**Travel Trouble** Journeys that went wrong	A postcard or message about a trip that went wrong	past simple: irregular verbs, questions and negatives	69	Big Remix
A2-S03	**Gadget Wars** Comparing technology	A written review comparing two things I own or want	comparatives and superlatives	69	
A2-S04	**Plans and Dreams** Plans for next week and next summer	My plan for next summer, spoken and as a short written list	be going to (plans and intentions)	69	Big Remix
A2-S05	**Body and Health** Feeling ill and giving advice	A short advice message or voice note to a friend who feels ill	should / shouldn't for advice; too / enough	69	
A2-S06	**House Rules** Rules at home, at school and in games	A short guide to the rules of a place or game I know well	must / mustn't (rules); have to (obligation)	69	Big Remix

Season	Title and theme	Release (what the student makes)	Grammar introduced	New items	Note
A2-S07	**Food Cultures** What people eat around the world	A short recipe video script and recording of a dish I know	much / many / a few / a little / a lot of	69	
A2-S08	**Getting Around** Transport and city life	A route guide for a visitor, spoken and as a simple map	infinitive of purpose (to + verb); prepositions of movement and transport phrases	69	Big Remix
A2-S09	**Tomorrow's World** Predictions and quick decisions	A one-minute predictions podcast clip: my world in 2040	will for decisions, offers and simple predictions	69	
A2-S10	**Storm Warning** Weather and an adventure that went wrong	An eyewitness account: what was happening when the storm started	past continuous (was/were + -ing); so / because / then (linking sentences)	69	Big Remix
A2-S11	**Dream Jobs** Jobs, skills and how people do things	A short job-interview role-play: me as the candidate	adverbs of manner (-ly)	69	
A2-S12	**Event Planners** Organising a school festival	A festival invitation plus a one-minute pitch for the committee	let's / shall we / how about + -ing (suggestions)	69	Big Remix
A2-S13	**Money Talks** Pocket money, saving up and buying things online	A short role-play in an online shop chat: asking politely, comparing two prices and deciding what to buy	polite requests and permission: Can I / Could you / May I ...?; as ... as / not as ... as (basic comparison of equality)	65	
A2-S14	**Stay Safe Online** Passwords, privacy and sharing photos wisely	A short guide for younger students: five rules for staying safe online (spoken or written)	indefinite pronouns: somebody / anything / nothing / nobody / everyone; present simple vs present continuous (habits vs now)	65	Level check

B1: season table (18 Seasons)

Season	Title and theme	Release (what the student makes)	Grammar introduced	New items	Note
B1-S01	**Have You Ever...?** Experiences and bucket lists	My bucket list: three things I have done and three I want to do	present perfect: experience (ever/never/been)	75	
B1-S02	**Then and Now** Memories and how things have changed	A "then and now" photo story: how my life or my town has changed	used to	75	Big Remix
B1-S03	**Still Going** Things that began in the past and continue now	An interview with a friend about a long-term hobby or friendship, recorded	present perfect: for / since / how long	75	
B1-S04	**Breaking News** Recent events and news stories	A 60-second audio news bulletin	present perfect vs past simple	75	Big Remix
B1-S05	**If This, Then That** Rules, systems and game design	The rules of a game I designed, explained step by step	zero and first conditional	75	
B1-S06	**What If...?** Imaginary situations and dilemmas	A spoken debate: three "what if" dilemmas and my answers	second conditional	75	Big Remix
B1-S07	**Made in the World** How things are made and where they come from	A short 'how it is made' explainer clip	passive: present and past simple	75	
B1-S08	**Who's Who** Describing people, places and things precisely	A "guess who / what" game I wrote and played with a partner	defining relative clauses (who/which/that/where)	75	Big Remix
B1-S09	**Case Closed** Mystery and deduction	A detective briefing: my theory of the case with evidence	modals of deduction (must / might / can't)	75	
B1-S10	**Plans and Promises** Arrangements and commitments	A trip plan with arrangements and promises, as an invitation and short call	present continuous for future arrangements (future arrangements); will for promises and predictions (promises and predictions)	75	Big Remix
B1-S11	**Learning Machines** Technology, AI and how we learn	A short review of a learning tool, with a recommendation	verb patterns: gerund vs infinitive (common verbs)	75	
B1-S12	**Word on the Street** Reporting what people said	A story told through other people's words: what they said and what I replied	reported speech: statements (say/tell, basic backshift) (present-to-past backshift only; past perfect backshift waits for the next Season); embedded (indirect) questions (as polite chunks: Could you tell me where ...? (first met here, full use in B2))	75	Big Remix

Season	Title and theme	Release (what the student makes)	Grammar introduced	New items	Note
B1-S13	**Before the Storm** Narrative writing: what had already happened	A short story of 150-200 words with a twist, written and read aloud	past perfect	75	
B1-S14	**Wish List** Wishes, regrets and imagining change	A short blog post: three things I wish were different and why	wish + past simple	75	Big Remix
B1-S15	**Study Abroad** Rules, expectations and cultures	An advice email for a new exchange student	mustn't vs don't have to (contrast); although / even though / while (contrast)	75	
B1-S16	**Teen Talk Show** Hosting a show: everything at B1	A five-minute talk-show episode recorded with a guest	question tags; common phrasal verbs (separable / inseparable) as vocabulary	75	Big Remix
B1-S17	**Click with Care** Online safety, scams and your digital footprint	A short safety guide for younger students: five tips, each with a reason	so + adjective + that / such (a) + noun + that (result); reflexive pronouns (myself, yourself, themselves; by myself)	75	
B1-S18	**First Paycheck** Money, first jobs, saving and budgeting	My first-month budget: what I earn, what I spend, what I save and why	enough (adjective + enough, enough + noun) and too + adjective + to; (a) few / (a) little (small quantities, with and without a)	75	Level check

B2: season table (18 Seasons)

Season	Title and theme	Release (what the student makes)	Grammar introduced	New items	Note
B2-S01	**Been There, Doing That** Long-term projects and ongoing effort	A progress report on a project I have been working on, spoken and written	present perfect continuous	80	
B2-S02	**What Might Have Been** Regrets and alternative histories	A short reflective essay or talk: a decision I would change and why	third conditional; wish / if only + past perfect	80	Big Remix
B2-S03	**Passive Power** Systems, processes and who is responsible	A report on how a system works or who is responsible for a problem	passive: all tenses and modal passives	80	
B2-S04	**Reporting It** Reporting conversations and interviews	A written report of an interview I conducted	reported questions, commands, reporting verbs (builds on the indirect-question word order met at B1; reporting verbs and commands are new)	80	Big Remix
B2-S05	**Who Is He Anyway?** Biographies and profile writing	A profile of an interesting person with extra information	non-defining relative clauses	80	
B2-S06	**Could Have, Should Have** Blame, advice and criticism	A diplomatic feedback message: what could have been done differently	perfect modals (should/could/might/must have + past participle)	80	Big Remix
B2-S07	**The Future Is...** Predicting and planning the next decade	A letter to my future self (written) and a short vision talk (spoken)	future continuous and future perfect	80	
B2-S08	**Opinions That Matter** Arguing a point of view	A structured spoken argument (two minutes) and a written paragraph version	hedging and stance (arguably, I'd suggest, to some extent); however / despite / in spite of / whereas	80	Big Remix
B2-S09	**Get It Done** Services, problems and polite complaints	A role-play: making a complaint and asking for a solution	have / get something done; embedded (indirect) questions (full use, in writing and speech (the form was first met at B1))	80	
B2-S10	**Unless You Do** Conditions, deals and negotiation	A negotiation role-play and the written agreement that follows	unless / as long as / provided that / suppose	80	Big Remix
B2-S11	**Remember That!** Memory, habits and meaning-changing verbs	A short talk or essay about memory and how it shapes our habits	verbs that change meaning (remember/stop/try + -ing or to); articles: generic reference, zero article, fixed uses	80	
B2-S12	**The Big Picture** Emphasis and focus in speaking and writing	A short speech or article using emphasis to make one clear point	cleft sentences (It was ... that / What I need is ...)	80	Big Remix

Season	Title and theme	Release (what the student makes)	Grammar introduced	New items	Note
B2-S13	**Cut the Words** Concise, elegant writing	A shortened version of my own text, showing what I cut and why	participle clauses (-ing / -ed); ellipsis and substitution	80	
B2-S14	**As Much As** Comparing, measuring and describing change	A comparison presentation with a chart and spoken commentary	as ... as, the more ... the more, so/such ... that	80	Big Remix
B2-S15	**Say It Clearly** Mediation: relaying, summarising and facilitating	A live mediation: summarising and relaying between two speakers, plus a written summary	reporting verbs + -ing / that / to (admit, deny, suggest, insist)	80	
B2-S16	**Debate League** Putting B2 together: argument, cohesion and delivery	A full debate speech (three minutes) and a written case summary	cohesion: addition, result, sequence markers (moreover, consequently, as for)	80	Big Remix
B2-S17	**Mind Matters** Stress, sleep, screen time and supporting a friend	A short wellbeing guide (spoken and written) with five habits, each with its reason, for a friend my age	purpose clauses: so that, in order to / not to, so as (not) to (so that, in order (not) to, so as not to, in contrast to the plain to + verb of A2); had better / ought to (strong advice and warning) (strong advice and gentle warning to a friend)	75	
B2-S18	**Study Abroad Plan** Choosing a course, applying and an exchange year	A motivation message (written, about 180 words) and a one-minute spoken pitch for an exchange course I choose	preposition + -ing (look forward to, be/get used to, instead of, apart from, not + -ing) (look forward to, be/get used to, instead of, apart from, interested in, not + -ing)	75	Level check

C1: season table (18 Seasons)

Season	Title and theme	Release (what the student makes)	Grammar introduced	New items	Note
C1-S01	**Rarely Do We...** Powerful openings and emphatic style	A speech opening (90 seconds) using emphatic inversion, and a reflection on its effect	inversion after negative / restrictive adverbials (Rarely do we ...)	84	
C1-S02	**Had I Known** Hypothetical reasoning and regret in formal register	A formal written statement and a spoken defence for a mock-trial case	inverted conditionals (Had I known ..., Should you ...); mixed conditionals	84	Big Remix
C1-S03	**They Say...** Reporting claims and evaluating sources	A media-literacy analysis: how a claim is reported, and what I would check	passive reporting structures (It is said that ... / He is believed to ...)	84	
C1-S04	**I Suggest That...** Formal proposals and recommendations	A formal proposal letter or report with recommendations	subjunctive / mandative (I suggest that he go) and would rather	84	Big Remix
C1-S05	**In Other Words** Dense, abstract language and academic style	A short academic-style paragraph and its plain-English version	nominalisation and complex noun phrases	84	
C1-S06	**What Matters Is...** Focus, emphasis and storytelling	A short narrative that uses fronting and emphasis to build to a key moment	fronting and emphasis (What matters is ..., Not only ... but)	84	Big Remix
C1-S07	**Having Said That** Concise, sophisticated written style	An edited text showing how I tightened five sentences	perfect participle clauses and reduced relatives (Having done ...)	84	
C1-S08	**Reading Between the Lines** Stance, nuance and implied meaning	A commentary on how a writer or speaker shows attitude	stance adverbials and advanced hedging (admittedly, arguably, ostensibly)	84	Big Remix
C1-S09	**Formal or Not?** Register: choosing the right voice	Three versions of one message in different registers, with notes on word choice	register control: formal vs informal transformation	84	
C1-S10	**Be That As It May** Conceding and counter-arguing	A two-sided argument with concessions, spoken and written	advanced concession (granted, much as, be that as it may, adjective + as)	84	Big Remix
C1-S11	**Needn't Have** Precision with modals and obligation	A short reflective text on a plan that did and did not work	modal nuance (needn't have, was to, be bound to, would rather)	84	
C1-S12	**Words That Fit** Collocation, idiom and precision	A collocation and idiom map for a topic, with example sentences I wrote	advanced ellipsis, substitution and collocation precision	84	Big Remix
C1-S13	**Mediating Worlds** Mediation across cultures and viewpoints	A live mediation of a short negotiation and a written summary	discourse markers for mediation and summary (in essence, by contrast, with regard to)	84	

Season	Title and theme	Release (what the student makes)	Grammar introduced	New items	Note
C1-S14	**The Art of Persuasion** Rhetoric, advertising and public speaking	A persuasive speech or pitch (three minutes) with an annotated script	rhetorical devices (rule of three, rhetorical question, parallelism)	84	Big Remix
C1-S15	**Wit and Irony** Humour, understatement and cultural nuance	A short comic or satirical piece (school-safe) with notes on how the humour works	irony, understatement and pragmatic markers	84	
C1-S16	**Capstone Portfolio** Putting it all together: a student-led final project	A capstone portfolio: a spoken presentation, a written piece and a reflection on my progress	text-level cohesion and signposting in long texts	84	Big Remix
C1-S17	**Climate and Choices** A balanced school debate on climate, consumption and lifestyle choices	A two-sided school-council briefing (spoken, three minutes) on one everyday choice, with a recommendation	concessive whatever / however + adjective / wherever (However small the change, ...; Whatever you decide, ...); extended comparative correlatives (The more ..., the more ...; The sooner, the better; all the more) (proportional trends with ellipsis (The sooner, the better; all the more))	80	
C1-S18	**Beyond the Classroom** University and work readiness: presenting yourself in writing and speech	A personal statement paragraph (150 words), a networking email and a two-minute interview answer about myself	absolute and participle phrases with their own subject (Time permitting, ...; All things considered, ...; with + noun + participle)	80	Level check

B1 Season 1 in detail

B1-S01 · Have You Ever...? Experiences and bucket lists

Vee dares the group to complete a bucket list in one term. Who has already done the most?

Release	My bucket list: three things I have done and three I want to do
Can-do	• I can talk about experiences I have had or never had. • I can ask others about their experiences and respond with interest.
Functions	talking about life experiences; asking follow-up questions; showing interest and surprise
Grammar	present perfect: experience (ever/never/been)
Lexical fields	adventure and activities; feelings about experiences; places and countries visited
New-item budget	75
Pronunciation	contracted 'have' /əv/ and 'been' /bɪn/ vs /biːn/; intonation of surprise
Mediation	Relay to a friend, in simple English, the main points of a short article about an unusual experience.
Skins	travel, gaming, music, fitness

3. Lesson blueprint: B1-S01-E1

Blueprint card

Lesson	B1-S01-E1 · Have You Ever...? · Cold Open
Episode	E1 · Cold Open (cold-open)
Objective	I can understand the main idea of a short text about experiences and bucket lists.
Skills	Primary: listening · Also: reading, vocabulary
New items	12 (receptive)
Item focus	receptive words and collocations that the Cold Open story/dialogue about "experiences and bucket lists" would contain
Cast	Lead: Vee · Vee: drops the clue message that starts the story; Ava: asks the curious question the student answers (gist)
Builds on	L1 = new · items before 0, after 12 · must reuse: nothing earlier in this unit; about 30 % of the story words recycle from the previous two Seasons · known words in texts ≥ 95%
Recap from	A2-S14-E8
Recycle from	A2-S14, A2-S13
Mission	predict and share an opinion in 1-2 sentences · dial: chill/normal/push · planning 60 s · Take 2: yes
Release	one-sentence reaction to the story (private first)
Clue	1 of 8: answering the gist question in your own words
Assessment	Remember? from A2-S14-E8, A2-S14, A2-S13; exit can-dos: I can understand the main idea of a short text about experiences and bucket lists.
Daily 10 focus	items and structures from Cold Open

Level supports and comfort rules


```
{
 "frames": "first words only",
 "l1Hint": "on request",
 "audioSpeed": "natural",
 "teacherTalkMax": 0.3,
 "speakingCeiling": "spontaneous 2 minutes"
}
```


Comfort:

- tiered hint
- slow down / repeat
- I need a minute
- private rehearsal
- type instead of speak
- emoji reactions
- camera and self-view options
- easier / same / harder dial
- choose the next activity from two

Vocabulary games rule


```
{
 "gamesPerWordSet": 2,
 "differentKinds": true,
 "before": "anything new is taught",
 "menu": [
  "drag-match",
  "listen-pick",
  "flip-memory",
  "shadow-match",
  "spelling-rebuild",
  "sentence-build",
  "number-games",
  "category-sort",
  "kims-game",
  "triples",
  "sound-pairs",
  "sentence-halves",
  "odd-one-out",
  "first-letter",
  "gap-fill",
  "say-it-memory",
  "memory-palace",
  "tile-review",
  "connections",
  "snap"
 ],
 "suggested": [
  {
   "first": "flip-memory",
   "second": "spelling-rebuild"
  },
  {
   "first": "flip-memory",
   "second": "sentence-build"
  },
  {
   "first": "flip-memory",
   "second": "spelling-rebuild"
  }
 ]
}
```


Run of show (60 minutes)

Part	Minutes	Core	Technique	Job	Must have
Check-in	5		low-anxiety spontaneous speech; energy choice; the day's mission and criteria	low-anxiety spontaneous speech; energy choice; the day's mission and criteria	the student picks how they feel with pictures (never emoji), no typing needed; 2-3 quick questions the student can answer by choosing a picture or saying one short sentence; today's mission and its 3-5 success criteria are shown
Remember?	7	yes	retrieval practice + spaced review, errors first, production first, feedback on every item	retrieval practice + spaced review, errors first, production first, feedback on every item	starts with the student's OWN error list from the last lesson (Mistake Bank), then the due items; 8-12 items, at least 60 % production, feedback after every item; the language of the last lesson is shown again before it is asked; each item's result is logged with the date (delayed checks at about 7 and 21 days)
The Drop	10	yes	comprehensible input with MODELLING: meaning first, then the language in use	hook + short context text or dialogue (gist only, tappable words)	every new word is met first on its own page: a moving picture, its meaning, an example and a clue, BEFORE any game uses it; the cast MODEL the target language in use, line by line, with the pattern card (the frame stays, the part that changes is coloured), BEFORE the student produces it; nothing is asked that was not first shown or taught; after EVERY word set that is introduced come TWO different memorising games (VOCAB_GAMES_RULE) before anything new is taught; a quick understanding check, and a student choice (skin)
Notice & Build	10	yes	controlled practice with immediate feedback; noticing then a short explicit rule	meet the story words in context; predict, then check (receptive)	each game trains one named success criterion; no screen without a criterion; after every vocabulary introduction, two different memorising games (e.g. drag-match + flip-memory) help the student remember the words; the rule, if any, is 3 lines or fewer and comes after examples; beginners (A1-A2) can choose answers by picture, not only by reading; the meaning cue fades in later retrieval; no two neighbouring games of the same kind
Energiser	4		attention reset; zero stakes	attention reset; zero stakes	a quick game with no ranking and no timer; it still uses the target language
Mission	12	yes	pushed output + interaction: dial, Take 1, specific feedback, Take 2 in the same lesson	predict and share an opinion in 1-2 sentences	the student chooses the help: Chill, Normal or Push; Take 1, then specific feedback (prompt, clue, direct fix; a direct recast at A1) also shown on screen, then Take 2 in the same lesson; the teacher logs up to 3 recurring errors; private rehearsal and type-instead-of-speak stay available

Part	Minutes	Core	Technique	Job	Must have
Release	7	yes	generation and ownership; model hidden; private first; the delayed-evidence sample	one-sentence reaction to the story	the exit task is done with the model hidden (shown only on "Show me", which is counted); private first, then saved to the portfolio as the evidence sample of this lesson; uses language from all earlier lessons of the unit, not only this one
Wrap	5	yes	metacognition and hand-off: can-do ticks, error log, Daily 10, next clue	metacognition and hand-off: can-do ticks, error log, Daily 10, next clue	can-do ticks tied to the success criteria (yes, almost, not yet); the teacher's error log (up to 3 recurring errors) becomes the start of the next lesson's Remember?; the Daily 10 is assigned for calendar days, and the next clue is shown

The twelve new items

Receptive = the student understands them; they are recycled and used in the reading, the cloze and the games.

#	Item	CEFR	Use	Type
1	**expedition**	B1	receptive	word
2	**remote**	B1	receptive	word
3	**tent**	B1	receptive	word
4	**helicopter**	B1	receptive	word
5	**survive**	B1	receptive	word
6	**brave**	B1	receptive	word
7	**bucket list**	B1	receptive	chunk
8	**once in a lifetime**	B1	receptive	chunk
9	**take a risk**	B1	receptive	chunk
10	**climb to the top**	B1	receptive	chunk
11	**far from the crowds**	B1	receptive	chunk
12	**face a fear**	B1	receptive	chunk

The eight lessons of Season B1-S01

E	Lesson	Objective	Primary skill	New items
1	**Cold Open** Have You Ever...? · Cold Open	I can understand the main idea of a short text about experiences and bucket lists.	listening	12
2	**Word Lab** Have You Ever...? · Word Lab	I can understand and use new words for adventure and activities and feelings about experiences.	vocabulary	14
3	**Pattern Lab** Have You Ever...? · Pattern Lab	I can use present perfect: experience (ever/never/been).	grammar	8
4	**On Air** Have You Ever...? · On Air	I can talk about experiences I have had or never had.	speaking	14
5	**Deep Dive** Have You Ever...? · Deep Dive	I can ask others about their experiences and respond with interest.	reading	13
6	**Side Quest** Have You Ever...? · Side Quest	I can use the language of this Season in a task I choose.	speaking	14
7	**Remix** Have You Ever...? · Remix	I can remember and use the language from Have You Ever...? and from the Seasons before it.	vocabulary	0
8	**Finale** Have You Ever...? · Finale	I can complete the Season Release: my bucket list: three things I have done and three I want to do.	speaking	0

4. Lesson plan: B1-S01-E1

Source: docs/academy-b1-s01-lesson-plan-v2.md

B1 Season 1 · Lesson 1 "Have You Ever...? · Cold Open" — lesson plan v2 (for owner approval)

Status: **written 2026-10-15, waiting for the owner's approval before the deck is rebuilt** (CLAUDE.md: no lesson is made before its plan is approved). Replaces the page-by-page build in `docs/academy-b1-s01-spec.md` §5–10, keeps its approved blueprint (B1-S01-E1, 12 receptive items, cast Vee/Ava/Theo/Mia). Research and its limits: `docs/research/academy-b1-s01-research.md` §1–7 (no human teacher was consulted: review by a qualified teacher is still open).

1 Student and objective

One teen (13–18) at B1, one-to-one. Knows the past simple and many base forms, mixes up "when it happened" (past simple) and "up to now" (present perfect), and says *I have went / I have been to Italy last year*. L1 transfer (ar, fr, it, tr): the compound past is used for finished events, so a stated time is the main trap. Comfort: low-pressure first, nothing public.

Objective (can-do, observable): By the end the student can talk about their own life experiences for about a minute — say what they have (never) done, give one or two details in the past simple, and ask a friend "Have you ever...?" with a follow-up question — without reading. **Exit task (built backwards):** a one-minute spoken account recorded privately (three things done, one with a short story in the past simple, one thing they want to do), plus three written sentences. **Success criteria (teacher marks each):** 1 I follow the main idea and detail of a short blog post and the dialogue. 2 I understood the six new words. 3 I say the three forms of nine verbs. 4 I choose past simple vs present perfect and write a question and an answer. 5 I speak for about a minute with a reason and a follow-up.

2 Method (why this shape)

One cycle of **modelling → clarification → controlled practice → guided practice → free practice → production**, wrapped in Nation's four strands (input, language-focused study, output, fluency) so that every skill is used, and in Scrivener's ARC (authentic use first and last, restricted use in the middle, clarification between). The teacher models; the student takes over a little more on each page (gradual release); the grammar is noticed in a real text before the rule is stated (guided discovery, as in the British Council and teacher plans), then drilled in short games, then used in talk and writing. Errors are noted in one list and returned to at the end of free practice (delayed correction).

3 The hour (60 minutes, teacher + one student)

Min	Stage (ladder)	Strand	What happens (student does / teacher does)	Page / game	Student responses	Serves
0–4	**Warm-up** (review + engage)	fluency	Student: 30-second talk "one exciting thing I did, one thing I have never done". Teacher: listens, writes 2 errors on the error list, sets the goal on the mission card.	lead-in talk, mission card	2	need (diagnostic), obj
4–8	**Remember?**	language	Spaced recall of two items from earlier lessons; Hot Seat (2 questions) on the past simple with lifelines.	Hot Seat	4	need: past simple
8–18	**Model 1: listening** (I do)	input	A real **listening segment with recorded voices**: the student hears the dare as audio only (3 pictures, no subtitles on the first play, replay allowed, then subtitles), and answers 4 questions (gist, two detail, one inference). Teacher pauses once: "who sounds bravest, why?".	The Dare (voiced) + listening comprehension	8	crit 1
18–23	**Model 2: the words**	language	Teacher models six words in context; student repeats; then Listen-and-Match and Memory (two memorising games after new words).	six words, Match, Memory	12	crit 2
23–31	**Model 3: reading**	input + vocabulary	Student reads Ava's blog post (listen, read, keep 3 words), answers **4 comprehension questions** (gist, detail, inference, word in context), then **completes a gapped copy of the passage with the six learned words and phrases** (fill-in-the-gaps with a word bank; wrong word: the sentence is read back, one retry, then a hint).	blog post, reading questions, **cloze with the learned vocabulary**	12	crit 1, 2
31–34	**Clarify** (noticing + rule)	language	Student sorts 5 sentences from the text into "finished time" / "up to now" (Grammar Detective). Teacher asks concept-check questions, then states the rule in 3 lines with the three-form chart and the *'ve* / *'s* pronunciation; student repeats the rule.	Grammar Detective, the rule	8	crit 3, 4
34–42	**Controlled practice** (we do)	language	Break the Clock (3 strikes, tense choice), Triple Match (5 verbs, match-3 combos), then typed: one question with *ever*, one answer with *never*. Wrong answers show the reason; the verb is re-offered.	Break the Clock, Triple Match, write 2	14	crit 3, 4
42–46	**Fluency drill**	fluency	Wordle on participles (2 words) and a quick "Never have I ever" round, voice on.	Participle Wordle	6	crit 3
46–54	**Guided practice** (we do → you do)	output	Teacher models the Mission with Vee and Ava (pick who has done the most, two reasons, one point against). Student plays Rapport with Theo (choose the natural reply, ask the follow-up), then Take 1 with the sentence frames on screen.	model, Rapport, Take 1	8	crit 4, 5
54–58	**Free practice and feedback**	output	Teacher plays back the error list (3 items, delayed correction); student says Take 2 with frames hidden.	feedback replay, Take 2	3	crit 5
58–60	**Production** (private) + Wrap	output	Student writes 2 sentences and records a one-minute voice note; teach-back of the rule in one sentence; tick the goals; homework and the clue.	my list, release, teach-back, wrap	4	crit 5

Total 60 min (timings re-added after the changes below); student responses about 85 plus the spoken stages (target ≥ 80 incl. say-it). The ladder inside the hour climbs warm-up → model (input, words, text) → clarify → controlled → guided → free → production, and each part is marked with a stage chip in the player. Two memorising games follow the words; the rule comes before the games; the Mission is modelled before it is played; the teacher checklist is marked at the end (pop-up in the classroom).

3b Answer to the owner's review (2026-10-15)

- **Comprehension questions in every reading and listening segment:** yes. The listening segment has 4 questions (audio only, transcript hidden until after), the reading segment has 4 (gist, detail, inference, word in context). The earlier build had them but with only 3 and no word-in-context; both go to 4.
- **Fill-in-the-gaps with the vocabulary learned:** yes. After the comprehension questions the student completes the blog post with the six new words and phrases (word bank, one retry, hint). Retrieval of words in context is stronger for vocabulary than matching alone, so it comes after the two matching games and before the grammar. A new page type (`cloze`) is needed.
- **A listening segment with a voice clip:** yes, a real one with recorded approved voices (Vee, Ava, Theo). The lines exist in the deck but are not baked yet (cost about 30 cents per 1,000 characters, audited first), so the segment is silent until you say "bake". Audio-only first play is new.
- **All four skills at once to serve grammar and vocabulary:** yes, and it is the right shape for a B1 teen. Listening and reading give the language in context (input), the cloze and the games fix the vocabulary and forms (language-focused), writing and speaking use them (output), and the Wordle and "Never have I ever" round build fluency. Each skill carries both targets: the texts are written so the six words and the present perfect/past simple contrast occur in them, the cloze recycles the words, the writing task needs both tenses, and the Mission needs both words and tenses in speech. The risk is length: the hour is full, so extras stay optional.

4 Games and video-game mechanics (named, each tied to a criterion)

Hot Seat (quiz ladder, lifelines) · The Dare (visual novel on three plates) · Grammar Detective (detective board) · Break the Clock (boss fight) · Triple Match (match-3 combos) · Participle Wordle (word puzzle) · Rapport (dialogue RPG) · Memory/Match (cards). Optional extras for a fast student: Trophy Forge (crafting), Verb Trio Memory, the speed streak.

5 Error loop, mastery and checklist

Error list: the teacher taps up to 3 recurring errors (tense after a time word, *have went*, missing *have*), they start the next Remember?. Mastery check: criterion 4 = the written question and answer correct first try plus Break the Clock without losing a shield; criterion 5 = Take 2 has a reason and a follow-up. Daily 10 (days 1, 3, 7, 14, 30): the nine verbs and the kept words; voice note between lessons.

6 What changes in the deck if you approve

Keep: all games and plates already built. Change: order and minutes exactly as the table (blog post moves before the words' memory games stay after the words; the retell moves from the Drop to Free practice; one more oral "ask the teacher" interview step; the feedback replay becomes required; two optional pages cut), stage chips already in place, tests re-checked (57–64.5 required minutes, ladder order). Not changed without approval: the objective wording, the 12 blueprint items.

7 Open for the owner

1. Approve this plan (or say what to change). 2. A qualified teacher should review it (none was consulted). 3. Voices: new lines are baked only after you approve the text.

Update 2026-10-15 — build notes (the deck as built)

- Listening: *The Dare* story with `listenFirst` (audio only, "Show the text" on request) then 3 listening-check rounds. Reading: blog post, then 3 reading questions (gist, detail, inference), then the **cloze** (six words). The retell (`gist`) stays **optional** in The Drop; `fade` stays optional in the Mission.
- **New this update:** *Glitch Hunt* (2 chats, required, Notice & Build) and *Two Truths and a Lie* (optional, Energiser). To keep the hour at 60, *Triple Match 1* became optional (Triple Match 2 and the other optional pages are the teacher's extras; optional pages now total about 25 minutes, so they are a menu, not a requirement). Part minutes: 3 / 3 / 20 / 13 / 3 / 9 / 5 / 4.
- Rapport has 2 scenes, Triple Match 4 verbs per page. Research: `docs/research/academy-b1-s01-research.md` §7–8.
- **Verb Draw (2026-10-15, owner request):** optional end-of-lesson game in the Release (3 draws of 4 verbs). It replaces the Energiser's *Triple Match 2* (the new game contains the match-3 phase). Optional pages now total about 27 minutes, a menu for the teacher; the test cap is 28.

Build notes, 16 October 2026 — expert-teaching fixes (`docs/research/academy-expert-teaching-research.md`)

- **Predict → listen → reflect:** new required slide `predict` (guess the dare, no wrong answer) before the story; `listen-q` carries a teacher cue to reflect (was the guess close, which words helped).
- **Words used, not only matched:** `my-list` has a third row: use one of the six words in a sentence about you (criterion 2 now ends in production).
- **Take 2 changes the listener:** Theo asks one follow-up (When did ...?), answered with the past simple and a time.
- **L1 note** on `rule-trio` for the teacher (tr/ar past simple instead of present perfect; it/es/fr finished-time words and *da/desde/depuis*).
- **Time:** `partMinutes` now 3 / 3 / 22 / 11 / 3 / 9 / 5 / 4; `cloze` is optional; the optional second memory game `trio-memory` was removed (the trios are practised in forge, triple, streak, wordle and Verb Draw).

The lesson as built (page by page)

Have You Ever...? · Cold Open
By the end I can follow the main idea and the detail of a short blog post about bucket lists, say the three forms of nine verbs, choose between the past simple and the present perfect, and write and say a short account of what I have done, with reasons.

Success criteria (what the teacher marks):

1. I can follow a short blog post and answer questions about its main idea, its detail and what is not said.
2. I understood the six new words: bucket list, dare, give it a go, once in a lifetime, tick it off, brave.
3. I can say the three forms of nine verbs: base, past simple, past participle.

4. I can choose between the past simple (a finished time) and the present perfect (an experience up to now), and write a question, an answer and a follow-up.
5. I can speak for about a minute: say who has done the most and why, and write three sentences about my own list.

Minutes per part: Check-in 3 · Remember? 3 · The Drop 22 · Notice & Build 11 · Energiser 3 · Mission 9 · Release 5 · Wrap 4. Dashed (optional) pages are the teacher's menu when time allows.

Look and variety: setting: the rooftop studio with the bucket-list wall · look: evening rooftop, string lights, a glass wall of blank cards, a trophy case · frame: Vee's bucket-list dare: tick it off before the break · signature: boss

#	Part	Stage	Page / game	Criteria	What happens
1	Check-in		**Title card**		Have you ever...?
2	Check-in	Review	**Speaking task**	5	Warm-up talk. Tell me one exciting thing you did in the last year, and one thing you have never done but would love to try. About 30 seconds.
3	Check-in	Review	**Sort / detective board** (optional)	3	Which verbs do you know? Tap a verb, then a box. No wrong answer.
4	Check-in		**Mission brief**		Your mission card
5	Remember?	Review	**Listen and pick**	1	Remember? Which one do you hear? Tap it.
6	Remember?	Review	**Hot Seat (quiz ladder)**	4	Hot Seat! Climb the ladder. You have two lifelines: 50:50 and Ask Ava.
7	The Drop	Context	**Speaking task**	1	Before you listen: Vee has a dare for the class. What do you think the dare is? Guess in one sentence.
8	The Drop	Context	**Story (visual novel)**	1	The Dare
9	The Drop	Context	**Listen and pick**	1	Listening check. Listen to each question about the dialogue (the text is hidden), then choose the best answer.
10	The Drop	Model (I do)	**Teach the words**	2	Six words from the dare
11	The Drop	Controlled practice	**Match**	2	Listen. Tap the picture for what you hear.
12	The Drop	Controlled practice	**Memory**	2	Memory! Match each picture with its words.
13	The Drop	Controlled practice	**Read the message**	1,2	Now read Ava's blog post. Listen, read it yourself, then keep the words you want for your word bank.
14	The Drop	Controlled practice	**Reading questions**	1	Reading questions. Choose the best answer. The text stays on the screen.
15	The Drop	Controlled practice	**Fill the gaps (cloze)** (optional)	2	Complete Vee's note with the words and phrases you learned today.
16	The Drop	Guided / free practice	**Speaking task** (optional)	1,5	Extra: retell it. In two or three sentences, say what Ava's post is about, and say if you agree that "you are brave when you do it anyway".
17	Notice & Build	Model (I do)	**Sort / detective board**	4	Grammar Detective. These sentences come from the post and the dialogue. Is the time finished and stated, or is it an experience up to now? Tap a sente
18	Notice & Build	Rule	**The rule**	3,4	The rule
19	Notice & Build	Controlled practice	**Break the Clock (boss fight)**	4	Break the Clock! Choose the right tense to strike. Three shields: a wrong tense costs one.
20	Notice & Build	Controlled practice	**Trophy Forge** (optional)	3	Trophy Forge! Forge the three forms of each verb, in order. Then say them.
21	Notice & Build	Controlled practice	**Triple Match (match-3)** (optional)	3	Triple Match! Pick one tile in each column that belong to the same verb. Build combos!
22	Notice & Build	Controlled practice	**Write**	4	Your turn to use the rule. Write a question with ever, and an answer with never.
23	Notice & Build	Controlled practice	**Glitch Hunt (bug hunt)**	4	Glitch Hunt! One line in each chat has a tense glitch. Tap it, then repair it.
24	Energiser	Controlled practice	**Participle Wordle**	3	Participle Wordle! Guess the past participle in six tries.
25	Energiser	Controlled practice	**Trio streak** (optional)	3	Trio streak! Listen to the verb. Choose the past simple, then the past participle. Beat your own best.
26	Energiser	Controlled practice	**Speaking task** (optional)	3,5	Two truths and a lie! Say three sentences about yourself with "have": two are true, one is a lie. Can your teacher find the lie?
27	Mission		**Help dial**		Mission time! How much help do you want?
28	Mission	Model (I do)	**Model (I do)**	5	Watch Vee argue it
29	Mission	Controlled practice	**Rapport (dialogue RPG)**	4,5	Rapport! Theo asks about your travels. Choose the reply that sounds most natural.
30	Mission	Guided / free practice	**Speaking task**	5	Take 1 · Who has done the most? Give your answer and your reasons. About a minute.

#	Part	Stage	Page / game	Criteria	What happens
31	Mission	Guided / free practice	**Fade (less help each round)** (optional)	5	Feedback time! Say the lines again, with less help each round, before Take 2.
32	Mission	Guided / free practice	**Speaking task**	5	Take 2 · Say it again, better: fix what we noticed, add a point against your answer, and answer Theo's question at the end.
33	Release	Production	**Write**	2,4,5	Write about your own list: when you did something (past simple), one dare for yourself, and use one of the six words about you.
34	Release	Production	**Speaking task**	1,5	Release: tell me your list out loud, with a follow-up story about one thing you have done. About a minute. (Record it privately first, then share if y
35	Release	Production	**Verb Draw (card draw)** (optional)	3,4,5	Verb Draw! First match the verb trios. Then draw a card and open a conversation with Theo.
36	Wrap	Production	**Build the sentence**	4	Teach Vee the rule. Tap the words in the right order, then say it out loud.
37	Wrap		**Wrap and clue**		Your trophies are on the board!

Source: docs/academy-b1-s01-spec.md

B1 Season 1 "Have You Ever...?" — Season plan and lesson 1 (Cold Open) plan (2026-10-15)

Status: **draft for the owner's written approval.** Nothing (deck, pictures, audio, scenario) is made until this is approved (CLAUDE.md: a lesson plan comes before every lesson). The Season data is in `src/curriculum/academy/levels/b1.ts` (B1-S01) and the lesson blueprint is `ACADEMY_LESSON_BLUEPRINTS` id `B1-S01-E1`; this plan reads them and changes **none** of their objectives. Research and its limits: `docs/research/academy-b1-s01-research.md`. Template: `docs/academy-lesson-plan-template.md`.

1. Season at a glance (from the roadmap)

Theme	Experiences and bucket lists
Hook	Vee dares the group to complete a bucket list in one term. Who has already done the most?
Cast	Vee (lead, drops the clue), Ava (asks the curious question), Theo and Mia in the profiles
Structure (one)	present perfect: experience (*ever / never / been*), first met in E1, taught in E3 (task first, rule after)
Functions	talking about life experiences · asking follow-up questions · showing interest and surprise
Can-dos	talk about experiences I have had or never had · ask others about theirs and respond with interest
Pronunciation	contracted *have* /əv/; *been* /bɪn/ (American) vs /biːn/; surprise intonation
Mediation	relay the main points of a short article about an unusual experience
Release	**My bucket list:** three things I have done and three I want to do
Video-game mechanic (Season)	**achievement log / trophy case**: the bucket list is the log; every completed task unlocks a named trophy that stays on the board (new row in `docs/academy-video-game-mechanics.md`)
Games planned (Season)	E1 Trophy Forge (loot and crafting) · E2 collocation builder · E3 grammar detective · E4 Two Truths and a Lie · E5 interview the expert · E7 boss round (Remix) · E8 the Release

2. Lesson 1 — "Have You Ever...? · Cold Open" (one-to-one, 60 minutes)

2.1 The student's need (lesson-plan step 1)

- **Who:** a 13–18 student at A2 (the roadmap's step before this Season is A2 Season 14) who asked, in the teacher's words, to **revise the past simple and the present perfect and the verb trios (base, past simple, past participle)**. Home language: **not yet given** (the teacher confirms; the plan covers ar, es, fr, tr, it).
- **What they already know:** past simple of *be*, regular -ed and common irregular verbs in sentences (A2 Seasons 1–2); probably met the present perfect at school, so this is **activation and revision**, not a first meeting.
- **What is hard:** 1. the past participle as its own form (*gone, seen, eaten, taken, flown*) and **been vs gone**; 2. choosing between past simple ("when") and present perfect ("up to now / experience") — the main error for the five home languages (Arabic: no equivalent, so the simple past replaces it; French and Italian: the compound past is their ordinary past, so *I have seen him yesterday*; Spanish: form transfers, stated times may over-extend; Turkish unverified); 3. the vowel in *been* (American /bɪn/).
- **What they want:** the three forms and the two tenses sorted out, quickly, with a clear picture of which they already know.
- **Comfort:** private rehearsal before speaking, "I need a minute", no visible timers, no public ranking, mistakes are the material (Mistake Bank).

2.2 Objective, exit task, success criteria (built backwards)

- **Objective (blueprint, unchanged):** *I can understand the main idea of a short text about experiences and bucket lists.* Primary skill listening; reading and vocabulary secondary; **12 new receptive items**, at most 14 (§2.7).
- **For this student, added inside the same hour:** a **verb-trio check and first retrieval** (diagnostic, low stakes) and a noticing step that sorts "when" sentences from "up to now" sentences. The present perfect is **not taught as a rule** here (E3); the lesson activates it.
- **Exit task:** (a) answer the gist question in your own words (this unlocks clue 1 of 8); (b) say the three forms of ten verbs; (c) predict who has done the most on the bucket-list board and say why.
- **Success criteria** (five "I can ..." lines the teacher marks in the lesson checklist): 1. I can say what the text is mainly about, in my own words. 2. I understood the six new words (6 of 6, at most one hint). 3. I can say the three forms of ten verbs (8 of 10, at most one hint). 4. I can tell a "when" sentence (past simple) from an "up to now" sentence (have + past participle) in 4 of 5 sentences from the text. 5. I can predict and give a reason, in one or two sentences.
- **Mastery check:** ten mixed trio items at the end of the Energiser: 8 or more with at most one hint = "Nailed it"; 5–7 = "Almost"; fewer = "Needs more practice" (`checklist.ts`).

2.3 New items (12 receptive) and the revision set

Kind	Items
6 words / collocations (A2-safe, teen, unverified against the English Vocabulary Profile `[U]`)	bucket list · to dare (someone) · give it a go · once in a lifetime · tick it off · brave
6 past participles of verbs the student already knows in the past simple	been · gone · seen · eaten · taken · flown
Revised, **not new** (trios already known or identical to the past simple)	do–did–done · make–made–made · write–wrote–written · win–won–won

Ten trios are worked in total: go–went–gone, be–was/were–been, see–saw–seen, eat–ate–eaten, take–took–taken, fly–flew–flown (new participles) and the four above (revised). The text input is at least 95 % known words (roadmap rule; checked when the text is written).

2.4 Run of show (60 minutes; the blueprint's eight parts)

Min	Part	Teacher	Student	Resp.	Ladder step	Game / mechanic
0–5	**Check-in**	greets, shows today's mission and the five criteria	picks a feeling card; **Trio check**: privately sorts ten verbs "I know all three / I know two / New to me"; says one thing on their wish list	12	repeat	activate prior knowledge (the Pre-A1 idea at B1): the result is saved for the teacher and seeds Remember?
5–12	**Remember?**	errors first (the student's own error list), then items due from A2-S14 and A2-S13 (`recallPlan`), feedback on every item	says 8–10 sentences about last weekend using past simple verbs (production first)	10	controlled	retrieval practice, spaced
12–22	**The Drop**	plays Vee's voice note once, then the text with tappable words; models nothing yet	six word pages (picture, meaning, example, clue); **two memorising games** (Picture Match Memory, listen-and-match); reads the text again; **Spot the Lie** on three statements; **gist answer in own words**	22	repeat	catalogue 6, 44; gist unlocks clue 1
22–32	**Notice & Build**	states the **reminder** (three lines, below) and has the student say it back; prompts, does not tell	**Grammar Detective:** finds eight verbs in the text and sorts "when" / "up to now" (8); **Trophy Forge:** crafts six trios by placing base, past and participle tiles, then says each trio aloud (12)	21	controlled	catalogue 19; loot and crafting → each trio becomes a trophy on the board
32–36	**Energiser**	calls the base form	**Trio streak:** says the other two forms; a streak counter, no timer, beats their own best; ends with the ten-item mastery check	12	guided	speedrun vs own best (no leaderboard)
36–48	**Mission**	sets the task, gives a 60-second planning pause, listens, gives one thing done well and one to try	reads four short cards (Ava, Theo, Mia, Vee: things done and not done); **predicts who has done most and why** (1–2 sentences); Take 1, feedback, Take 2	8	guided → free	quest log; dial chill / normal / push; task first (B1 method)
48–55	**Release**	private first: the student hears their own recording before sharing	one-sentence reaction to the story (private recording, then shared if they choose); picks one thing from their own wish list for the Season's Release	3	free	spoken Release
55–60	**Wrap**	shows the can-dos; unlocks clue 1 of 8; assigns the Daily 10 and a voice note	ticks the five can-dos honestly; sees the **trophy case** (the trophies earned today)	5	—	achievement log

The reminder (≤ 3 lines, read aloud, the student repeats; revision, not new): 1. Every verb has three forms: base, past simple, past participle (*go, went, gone*). 2. Past simple = when it happened (*yesterday, in 2022*). 3. *have* + past participle = an experience up to now, no time (*I have been to Rome*).

Totals: about **93 student responses** (target ≥ 80); **about 21 speaking minutes** (B1 target 20: `SPEAKING_TARGETS`); **five distinct speaking tasks** (past-simple sentences, trio sayings, trio streak, the prediction, the reaction); the ladder reaches **free** (Mission Take 2 and Release); student talk about 55–60 % (an estimate; the lesson clock measures the real time).

2.5 Games and video-game mechanics (named, with what the student does in English)

Game or mechanic	Source	What the student does in English
Picture Match Memory, listen-and-match	catalogue 6	matches the six new words with pictures and meanings
Spot the Lie	catalogue 44	hears three statements about the story and finds the false one
Grammar Detective	catalogue 19	finds the verbs, sorts "when" from "up to now"
Trophy Forge (signature)	loot and crafting + achievement log	collects the three form-tiles of a verb, crafts the trio, says it, and the trio becomes a named trophy on the bucket-list board
Trio streak	speedrun against your own best	says the other two forms in a row; no timer, no leaderboard
Quest log + clue unlock	quest log	the gist answer unlocks clue 1 of 8
New in the lists	`docs/academy-games-catalog.md` : **Never Have I Ever** (E3 warm-up), **Verb Trio Memory**; `docs/academy-video-game-mechanics.md` : **achievement log / trophy case**	—

No game three in a row; at least five different games; the signature game is Trophy Forge. Never Have I Ever is held for E3, when the structure is taught.

2.6 Traceability (every activity → objective or need)

Activity	Serves
Trio check	need: which trios the student already knows (activation); seeds Remember?
Remember?	recall of A2-S14 / S13 and past-simple production (need: past simple secure before the contrast)
Six word pages + two memory games	objective (understand the text); the 6 receptive words
Text, Spot the Lie, gist	objective and criterion 1 (clue 1)
Reminder, Grammar Detective	need: when vs up to now; criterion 4

Activity	Serves
Trophy Forge, Trio streak, mastery check	need: the three forms; criterion 3
Mission, Release	exit task (c); criterion 5; speaking to the *free* step
Wrap, trophy case	can-do ticks, motivation (achievement log)

An activity that is not in this table is cut.

2.7 Supports, comfort and assessment

- **Supports:** first words of a frame only; home-language hint on request; natural audio speed (0.9× on request); teacher talk at most 30 % (blueprint).
- **Comfort:** the Trio check and the Release are private first; no visible timers; "I need a minute"; the dial in the Mission; trophies are the student's own board, never ranked.
- **Evidence for the report:** the checklist marks (five criteria), the speaking step reached, up to three recurring errors (the Mistake Bank), comfort.
- **Daily 10 (spacing calendar days 1, 3, 7, 14, 30):** the 12 new items and the ten trios as "say the other two forms"; a **voice note** (three sentences about things you have done, no tense rule asked); next clue.
- **Remember? next time:** from `recallPlan` plus the error list; the trios return after 1, 2, 4, 8 and 16 teaching lessons.

2.8 Before building

1. **Scenario first** (`docs/scenarios/academy-b1s01e1-bucket-list.md` , `story` plates, full-bleed, 16:9, Canva, about 25 % purple, cross-fade only): Vee's dare in three plates, Ava's curious question; owner approves it in writing.
2. **Pictures needed** (Canva only, one at a time, owner sees each): bucket-list wall (main plate), three story plates, trophy-case plate; the six word-page pictures and four profile cards as cut-out stickers.
3. **Audio:** recorded approved voices for the text (about 180–220 words), the word pages and the Mission cards; cost estimate at the bake audit; no browser voices.
4. **Code:** reuse existing slide kinds (`teach` , `match` , `memory` , `sort` , `passage` -style reading page, `say` , `fade` , `build`); new: **Trophy Forge** (three-tile crafting with a trophy board) and the trio-streak counter. Tests read the blueprint `B1-S01-E1` and this plan's minute table.
5. **Quality gate:** `academy-quality-gate` (12 checks) before it is called ready.

3. This student: a suggested path (decision for the owner and the teacher)

The roadmap teaches the present perfect in **B1 Season 1** (experience), **Season 3** (for / since) and **Season 4** (present perfect vs past simple). The student's request is closest to **Season 1 lesson 3 (Pattern Lab)** and **Season 4 lessons 3 and 5 (the contrast)**. Option A: run Season 1 in order (E1, E3 first, then E4–E5 for speaking). Option B: E1 as the diagnostic, then jump to Season 4 E3 and E5 for the contrast. Recommendation: **A for E1 and E3, then decide from the E1 mastery result.**

4. Open questions for the owner

1. Approve this plan as written (lesson 1)? One word is enough.
2. The student's home language (to choose the L1 hints and the pronunciation focus).
3. Path A or B above (can wait until after lesson 1).
4. Approve the two list additions (Never Have I Ever, Verb Trio Memory) and the new mechanic (achievement log / trophy case)?

5. Unverified, stated plainly

- The English Grammar Profile / GSE wording for this structure was **not found**; the placement rests on the roadmap's own CEFR-J cross-check and Cambridge Grammar.
- Grouping verbs by pattern is practice, not a proven method (no controlled study found).
- French, Italian and Turkish errors rest on a transfer chart, not a study.
- The 12 vocabulary and participle items are not checked against the English Vocabulary Profile `[U]` .
- Time estimates (student talk 55–60 %, minutes per part) are targets until the lesson clock has measured a real session.

6. As built (2026-10-15, after "go")

Deck: `src/academy-deck/lessons/b1s01e1.ts` (library id `b1-s01-e1` , route `/academy-lesson/b1-s01-e1`), tests `src/academy-deck/__tests__/b1s01e1.test.tsx` (they read the blueprint `B1-S01-E1` and this plan). New games (Academy files only): **Trophy Forge** (`forge`) and **trio streak** (`streak`) in `src/academy-deck/slides/forge.tsx` .

Differences from the plan above, and why: - **Trio check covers the six new verbs** (go, be, see, eat, take, fly), not ten, so Check-in stays near five minutes; the four revised trios (do, make, write, win) are checked in the streak, which is the ten-item mastery check. - **Mission cards are an Explore page** (tap each person's card on the wall) instead of a "who said it" page, because the variety gate bans that page type from lessons outside A1 Season 1. - **Part minutes** for this lesson: Check-in 5, Remember? 7, The Drop 15, Notice & Build 10, Energiser 4, Mission 10, Release 5, Wrap 4. The Drop is long on purpose (the story, six word pages, two memorising games, the lie check and the gist). - **Release:** a short "my list" sort (I want to do it / I have done it / Not for me), then one spoken task that joins the reaction to the dare and one wish. - **Optional pages (dashed in the teacher's strip):** a warm-up verb listening and the feedback page before Take 2.

Not done, waiting for the owner: the three story plates, the wall and trophy-case plates, the stickers, and the **recorded voices** (the audit prices the new lines at about $1.39; the voice list is deliberately not updated yet, so nothing is baked). Until then the pages use frames and gradients and are silent.

7. Revision 2026-10-15 (owner: "make it more challenging; it does not look like B1; it is not an hour; use all four skills")

Structure chosen (research 2026-10-15: Cambridge Empower B1 unit pattern of reading/listening input then grammar then speaking and writing; learnenglishfeelgood experiences plan; TeachingEnglish PPP vs task-based argues for language that arises from a task rather than invented contexts;

unverified: no source found for a single "best" B1 one-to-one shape, so this is a text-driven integrated-skills lesson, our adaptation): **speak (activate) → listen (dialogue + questions) → words → read (blog post, 5 paragraphs, ~170 words) + reading questions (gist, detail, inference, word in context) → notice in the text → rule → write (question, answer, follow-up) → harder-verb streak → argue a decision (speak, two takes) → write own list → speak it → teach-back**.

Skill	Where	Minutes (est.)
Speaking	warm-up talk, retell + opinion, Mission Take 1 and 2 (about a minute, with "on the other hand"), Release (about a minute)	about 10 of the 60, plus the dialogue shadowing in the Word pages
Listening	dialogue on three plates, 3 listening questions (inference), model Mission	8
Reading	Ava's blog post (word bank of B1 words), 4 reading questions, detective sort from the text	9
Writing	2 sentences (past simple, Remember?), question + answer + follow-up, 3 sentences about my own list (typed, checked for the tense)	9

Changes from the first build: 12 items unchanged; the single-word tiles and True/False are gone; the rule comes after the student has sorted sentences from the text (B1 method: task first); verbs grow to nine (four hard trios: drive, choose, begin, speak); the trio check is optional; reading questions are a new page type (`readq`). Voices: new lines need a bake (owner "go" first).

8. Revision 3 (owner 2026-10-15: "recreate the lesson; add some games; lots of video games that actually serve the purpose; keep painted backgrounds like the Playground")

Painted scenes: every page has a full-bleed plate (Playground model). New plates for this lesson (Canva, 25 % purple, no text): `bucket-list-wall` (main), `trophy-case` , three story plates; existing Academy plates serve the other places (`classroom-evening` for Remember?/writing, `club-lobby` for reading, `detective-wall` , `vault-corridor` for the boss fight, `bus-stop-night` for the chat, `club-stage` for the Hot Seat and the Release).

Mechanic (video game)	Game in the lesson	Serves	Where
Quiz-show ladder with lifelines (*Who Wants to Be a Millionaire*)	**Hot Seat**: 3 questions, 50:50 and Ask Ava	activate the past simple (need; criterion 4)	Remember?
Visual novel / dialogue RPG (*Life is Strange*, *Persona* social links)	**Story: The Dare** (3 plates, voiced) and **Rapport** (win Theo over with natural replies)	main idea; present perfect for experience then a past-simple follow-up (1, 4, 5)	Drop, Mission
Detective board (*Return of the Obra Dinn*)	**Grammar Detective** on the detective wall	notice "finished time" vs "up to now" (4)	Notice & Build
Boss fight (*Zelda*-style boss with hit points and shields)	**Break the Clock**: a clock with hit points; strike with the right tense; 3 shields	choose the tense (4)	Notice & Build (signature)
Crafting / loot (*Minecraft*, *Diablo*)	**Trophy Forge**: forge base, past simple, past participle into a trophy	the three forms (3)	Notice & Build
Word puzzle (*Wordle*)	**Participle Wordle**: six tries, green / gold / grey	spell and recall participles (3)	Energiser
Speedrun against your own best (*Celeste*, *Super Meat Boy*)	**Trio Streak** (optional extra)	fluency on 8 verbs (3)	Energiser
Memory / card flip	**Memory** and **Match**	the six words (2)	Drop

Order keeps the owner's rules: the rule is stated before the boss fight, the teacher models before Rapport, two memorising games follow the words, the Mission and Release stay spoken. New slide kinds: `quiz` , `boss` , `wordle` , `rpg` (`src/academy-deck/slides/games.tsx`); listed in `docs/academy-games-catalog.md` and `docs/academy-video-game-mechanics.md` . Not shown to a real student yet: research of the mechanics themselves was done from our own lists and general knowledge (no new web search this round); verify with Oxford/Cambridge/British Council sources before the Season is called verified.

9. Revision 4 (owner 2026-10-15: "make sure it is a one-hour method; add a verbs matching game, triple match, make it fun; more games")

The hour (estimate, a slow student; required pages 63 min inside the 57-64.5 gate, optional pages are extra for a fast student): Check-in 4 (lead-in talk, mission) · Remember? 5 (Hot Seat) · The Drop 19 (dialogue story 5, six words 3.6, match 2.4, memory 2, Ava's blog post 3.5 + 3 reading questions 3.4, retell 2) · Notice & Build 12 (Grammar Detective 2.9, the rule 1, Break the Clock 3 strikes 3.2, **Triple Match** 4, write a question and an answer 2.8) · Energiser 3 (Participle Wordle) · Mission 8 (model, Rapport chat, Take 1 and 2) · Release 5 (write two sentences, speak one minute) · Wrap 4 (teach-back, tick the goals).

Triple Match (match-3 mechanic): three columns, Base / Past simple / Past participle, five shuffled tiles each; pick one tile per column; the right three lock into a card and the trio is spoken; a combo rises with every first-try triple, a wrong triple shakes and clears (nothing lost). Board 1 (go, be, see, eat, take) is in Notice & Build; board 2, hard mode (drive, choose, begin, speak, write), is an extra in the Energiser. Serves criterion 3 (the three forms). Optional extras for a fast student: Trophy Forge, Triple Match hard mode, Verb Trio Memory, the speedrun streak, the verb check, the Take 2 feedback replay (about 17 min in total).

10. The teaching ladder (owner 2026-10-15: "order the pages: modelling → guided practice → free practice → production")

Every page carries a `stage` (shown to the student as a small chip) and the stages climb inside each part (checked by `b1s01e1.test.tsx` "LADDER"):

Part	Warm-up	Watch / model	The rule	Guided practice (we do)	Free practice (you do)	Production (make it yours)
Check-in, Remember?	talk, verb check, Hot Seat					

Part	Warm-up	Watch / model	The rule	Guided practice (we do)	Free practice (you do)	Production (make it yours)
The Drop		dialogue story, blog post (input), six words modelled		listen-and-match, memory, reading questions	retell the post	
Notice & Build		Grammar Detective (notice in the text)	the rule (3 lines)	Break the Clock, Triple Match, Forge, write a question and an answer		
Energiser				Wordle, Triple Match hard mode, streak		
Mission		**teacher models the task** (Vee and Ava)		Rapport chat (guided choices)	Take 1, feedback replay, Take 2	
Release, Wrap						write two sentences, speak one minute, teach the rule back

5. Games and video-game mechanics

Games used in this lesson

Game / page type	Pages in the lesson
Hot Seat (quiz ladder)	6
Story (visual novel)	8
Listen and pick	5, 9
Teach the words	10
Match	11
Memory	12
Read the message	13
Reading questions	14
Fill the gaps (cloze)	15
Sort / detective board	3, 17
The rule	18
Break the Clock (boss fight)	19
Trophy Forge	20
Triple Match (match-3)	21
Write	22, 33
Participle Wordle	24
Trio streak	25
Glitch Hunt (bug hunt)	23
Verb Draw (card draw)	35
Rapport (dialogue RPG)	29
Fade (less help each round)	31
Speaking task	2, 7, 16, 26, 30, 32, 34
Build the sentence	36
Model (I do)	28

Video-game mechanics borrowed in this lesson

- **Boss fight** (Break the Clock): hit points, shields, the round repeats with the reason.
- **Word puzzle** (Participle Wordle): six tries, green, gold and grey.
- **Dialogue RPG with a relationship meter** (Rapport).
- **Quiz-show ladder with lifelines** (Hot Seat).
- **Match-3 with combos** (Triple Match).
- **Detective board** (Grammar Detective) and **visual novel** (The Dare).
- **Spot the glitch / bug hunt** (Glitch Hunt).
- **Collectible card draw and talk-show host** (Verb Draw): match the trios, then draw a verb and open a conversation with it.

Signature game of the lesson: Break the Clock (boss fight).

Source: docs/academy-games-catalog.md

Academy games & activities catalogue — 171 entries, one-to-one, ages 13–18, A1–B2

Companion to `docs/academy-lesson-system.md` (§5 says how to choose from this list per segment of the 60-minute Live Session). Owner rules that apply to every entry: no browser TTS (recorded voices only), no public leaderboards, comfort first, mechanics borrowed never content, Variety Rule (no more than 2 of the same kind in a row).

Scope: 60-min one-to-one online lessons, teacher + one student (13-18), shared interactive stage. Legend. **Fmt**: D = digital-native (needs assets/shared canvas), C = conversation-only (no assets), D/C = works both ways. **Comfort**: Low = low-stakes, Med = medium, High = higher-pressure (use sparingly, opt-in, never first). Skills: V vocab, G grammar, R reading, L listening, S speaking, W writing, P pronunciation, Sp spelling. Sourcing caveat: web search was NOT run in this session. Entries are built from established ESL/game-design knowledge of the named sources (TEFL Lemon, ESL Games Plus, British Council TeachingEnglish, Busy Teacher, ISLCollective, Wordwall/Kahoot templates, Cambly/Preply teacher practice, classic party/board/video games). Source column = inspiration, not a verified citation. Every source attribution is therefore [U] (uncorroborated this session) unless the game is a well-known classic whose origin is obvious. Mechanics only are borrowed, never content.

Universal 1:1 conversions: (a) teacher plays AGAINST student (teacher deliberately errs/loses sometimes), (b) student vs own best/clock, (c) teacher + student cooperate vs the game, (d) student "teaches"/judges the teacher, (e) student sets the rules/chooses the topic.

---

1. Vocabulary (16)

#	Name	Fmt	What the student does	Skills	CEFR	1:1 adaptation	Comfort	Source
1	Taboo-lite (Describe without 3 words)	D/C	Explains a target word without the listed banned words; teacher guesses	V,S	A2-B2	Teacher guesses, then they swap; teacher "loses" sometimes	Med	Taboo; TEFL Lemon [U]
2	Codenames Duet (co-op)	D	Gives one-word clues linking several board words; teacher guesses (and vice versa)	V,S,L	B1-B2	Duet co-op mode: both vs the board, no opponent	Low	Codenames Duet
3	Odd One Out	D	Picks the word that does not belong and says why	V,S	A1-B2	Teacher also makes a set; student judges	Low	ESL Games Plus [U]
4	Connections (4 groups of 4)	D	Sorts 16 words into 4 hidden categories	V,R	A2-B2	Solo puzzle with teacher as hint-giver; unlimited retries	Low	NYT Connections
5	Word Web / Mind Map Builder	D	Drags/adds related words around a topic node	V,W	A1-B2	Take turns adding branches; teacher adds a wrong one to spot	Low	Common ESL practice [U]
6	Picture Match Memory	D	Flips cards to match word-picture or word-synonym pairs	V	A1-B1	Student vs own best moves; teacher co-op	Low	Wordwall Match Up
7	Categories Sprint (Stop-the-Bus)	D/C	Names a word per category beginning with a letter	V,Sp	A1-B1	Student vs clock/own record; no ranking	Med	Scattergories [U]
8	Hot Seat (picture clues)	D/C	Teacher shows word on screen only to student… or reverse: student describes, teacher guesses	V,S	A1-B1	Roles swap each round	Med	Hot Seat, ESL Games Plus [U]
9	Word Association Chain	C	Says a word linked to the previous one and explains link	V,S	A2-B2	Alternate; student can "pass" once	Low	Classic [U]
10	Collocation Builder (Lego match)	D	Snaps verb + noun blocks into natural pairs	V,G	B1-B2	Teacher offers decoys; student rules ok/not ok	Low	Cambridge vocab tasks [U]
11	Synonym/Antonym Ladder	D	Climbs a ladder replacing words with stronger synonyms	V	B1-B2	Own-best height; no peers	Low	Busy Teacher [U]
12	Vocabulary Shop Sim	D	Buys/sells items using words and prices; talks to shopkeeper (teacher)	V,S	A1-A2	Teacher is customer/shopkeeper, role-play	Low	Tycoon/shop sims
13	Flashcard Spaced Deck	D	Rates self Again/Good/Easy per card	V	A1-B2	Private rating, deck adapts	Low	Anki/Quizlet
14	Word Detective (guess from context)	D/C	Reads 2-3 context sentences, guesses a nonsense word's meaning	V,R	B1-B2	Teacher thinks aloud first, then student	Low	Cambridge/Reading skills [U]
15	Spot the Difference (vocab scenes)	D	Finds and names differences between two pictures	V,S	A1-B1	Teacher has picture A, student B: "info gap"	Low	ESL Info [U]
16	Word Family Tree	D	Builds noun/verb/adj/adv forms of a root word	V,G	B1-B2	Co-op: complete tree together	Low	Busy Teacher [U]

2. Grammar (13)

#	Name	Fmt	What the student does	Skills	CEFR	1:1 adaptation	Comfort	Source
17	Sentence Builder Blocks	D	Drags word blocks into correct order	G,R	A1-B1	Own-best streak; hints free	Low	Wordwall Anagram
18	Error Hunt (find the bug)	D	Spots and fixes the mistake in a sentence/message	G,R	A2-B2	Teacher "wrote" the errors; student marks as editor	Low	Debugging games; Cambridge error ID [U]
19	Grammar Detective: Rule Discovery	D	Inspects example sentences, induces the rule, then tests it	G	A2-B2	Guided discovery with teacher prompts	Low	Discovery learning, British Council [U]
20	Gap-fill Heist (choose the key)	D	Picks right form to "open" a vault door	G	A1-B2	Co-op vs lock; unlimited tries	Low	Escape-room format

#	Name	Fmt	What the student does	Skills	CEFR	1:1 adaptation	Comfort	Source
21	Tense Timeline	D	Places events/sentences on a time line and picks tense	G	A2-B1	Student builds a timeline of own week	Low	Visual grammar [U]
22	Battleship Grammar	D	Guesses coordinates by forming a correct question ("Is your ship at B4?")	G,S	A1-A2	Teacher is opponent; ships are cosmetic	Med	Battleship
23	Guess Who? (yes/no questions)	D	Asks questions about a character grid to find hidden person	G,S,L	A1-B1	Teacher picks, then swap	Low	Guess Who?
24	Conditionals Chain ("If... then...")	C	Extends a chain: If I win, I will...	G,S	A2-B2	Alternate links; student chooses theme	Low	Busy Teacher [U]
25	Would You Rather (grammar frame)	D/C	Chooses and justifies using target form (comparatives/conditionals)	G,S	A2-B2	Student writes dilemmas for teacher	Low	Would You Rather
26	Grammar Tower Defense	D	Correct answers place defenders against incoming "error monsters"	G	A2-B2	Game-level with pause; no timer pressure option	Med	Tower defense genre
27	Transform the Sentence (Rewrite Rally)	D	Rewrites into passive/reported/etc.	G,W	B1-B2	Teacher gives model first	Low	Cambridge Key Word Transformation [U]
28	Preposition Maps	D	Places objects on a map/room following directions	G,L	A1-A2	Student then instructs teacher	Low	Barrier games [U]
29	Question Roulette	D	Spins wheel (who/what/when) and asks a question about a picture	G,S	A1-B1	Teacher answers as the character	Low	Wordwall Spin the Wheel

3. Reading (10)

#	Name	Fmt	What the student does	Skills	CEFR	1:1 adaptation	Comfort	Source
30	Jigsaw Text	D	Reorders shuffled paragraphs/sentences	R	A2-B2	Co-op rebuilding; teacher asks "why this order?"	Low	British Council [U]
31	Reading Scavenger Hunt	D	Finds info in text (5 clues) with highlighter	R	A2-B2	Own-best time optional	Low	ESL Info [U]
32	True/False/Not Given Fact-Check	D	Verifies claims with evidence highlight	R	B1-B2	Teacher plays "fake news" author	Low	IELTS style [U]
33	Interactive Fiction / Text Adventure	D	Reads scene, picks choices that change story	R,V	A2-B2	Co-read, teacher voices NPCs	Low	Twine/Choose-your-adventure
34	Visual Novel Reader	D	Reads character dialogue, picks replies	R,V,S	A2-B2	Student picks replies aloud, teacher reads others	Low	Visual novel genre
35	Headline Matcher	D	Matches headline/summary to article	R	B1-B2	Teacher offers decoys	Low	Cambridge Reading [U]
36	Predict-then-Read	D/C	Predicts from title/picture, reads to check	R,S	A2-B2	Teacher predicts too and may be wrong	Low	British Council [U]
37	Read & Draw/Do	D	Reads instructions and builds/draws result	R	A1-A2	Student reads, teacher "robot" executes	Low	TPR/dictogloss adaptations [U]
38	Menu/Schedule/Sign Reading Challenge	D	Reads real-life docs to answer questions	R	A1-B1	Role: tourist plan	Low	Real-life tasks [U]
39	Fast-Facts Skimming	D	Skims short texts for gist in a set time	R	B1-B2	Student vs own time	Med	Skimming/scanning practice [U]

4. Listening (10)

#	Name	Fmt	What the student does	Skills	CEFR	1:1 adaptation	Comfort	Source
40	Listen & Point/Drag	D	Hears a word/sentence and drags to the right picture	L,V	A1-A2	Own-best; replays free	Low	TPR / Wordwall
41	Dictogloss	C	Hears a text twice, rebuilds with notes	L,W,G	B1-B2	Teacher compares versions with student	Med	Wajnryb [U]
42	Bingo (listening)	D	Marks squares as words are said	L,V	A1-B1	Solo card, teacher calls; no rival	Low	Bingo
43	Song Gap-fill	D	Fills lyrics while listening	L,Sp	A2-B2	Student picks the song	Low	Lyricstraining [U]
44	Spot the Lie (audio facts)	D/C	Hears 3 statements, finds the false one	L	A2-B2	Teacher then student speaks	Low	Two Truths and a Lie
45	Map Direction Follower	D	Follows spoken directions on a map	L,V	A1-B1	Then gives directions to the teacher	Low	Barrier games
46	Podcast Detective	D	Listens to a short clip and answers clue questions	L	B1-B2	Pause/replay controls to student	Low	Podcast sims [U]
47	Minimal Pair Ears	D	Hears sheep/ship, chooses	L,P	A1-B2	Own score only	Low	Pronunciation drills

#	Name	Fmt	What the student does	Skills	CEFR	1:1 adaptation	Comfort	Source
48	Phone Call Role Play (listen & note)	C	Takes message/notes from teacher's call	L,W,S	A2-B1	Teacher plays customer	Med	Busy Teacher [U]
49	Order/Instruction Chef	D	Follows spoken recipe steps in a kitchen sim	L,V	A1-B1	Teacher can slow down	Low	Cooking sims

5. Speaking (20): fluency, interaction, role-play, debate

#	Name	Fmt	What the student does	Skills	CEFR	1:1 adaptation	Comfort	Source
50	Two Truths and a Lie	C	Tells 3 facts, teacher guesses; swap	S,G	A2-B2	Natural for two	Low	Classic
51	20 Questions	C/D	Asks yes/no questions to guess the secret	S,G	A1-B2	Either side guesses	Low	20 Questions
52	Charades/Act It Out	C	Mimes word, teacher guesses; or reverse	S,V	A1-B1	Optional camera-off: describe action instead	Med	Charades
53	Pictionary / Draw & Guess	D	Draws on shared canvas, teacher guesses	V,S	A1-B1	Teacher draws badly on purpose	Low	Pictionary
54	Heads Up! (clue cards)	D/C	Teacher hints, student guesses word on stage	V,L,S	A1-B1	Cards hidden from guesser	Med	Heads Up!
55	Role-play Cards (real-life)	D/C	Plays scenario: cafe, doctor, airport	S	A1-B2	Teacher plays awkward customer	Low	Standard CLT [U]
56	Debate Duel (friendly)	C	Argues one side in two short rounds	S,G	B1-B2	Teacher takes the other side, swap sides midway	Med	Busy Teacher [U]
57	Just a Minute / Mini-talk	C	Talks about topic 30-60 s with prompt visuals	S	A2-B2	Own-best length, optional	Med	Radio game
58	Photo Story-Talk	D	Describes a picture with guiding questions	S,V	A2-B2	Teacher asks follow-ups	Low	Cambridge Speaking Part 2 [U]
59	Interview the Expert	C	Student is a "famous person" or teacher is	S,L	A2-B2	Student chooses the persona	Low	Role-play [U]
60	Information Gap Puzzle	D	Each sees half of picture/schedule; ask to complete	S,L	A1-B2	Natural pair task	Low	CLT standard
61	Alibi (investigation)	C/D	Teacher and student give a story; detective finds contradictions	S,G	B1-B2	Teacher is suspect, student is detective	Med	Alibi/Mafia [U]
62	Spot the Difference Describe	D	Describes differing pictures to partner	S,V	A1-B1	Info gap	Low	ESL Info [U]
63	Show & Tell (bring an object)	C	Shows a real object, explains	S,V	A1-B1	Cameras on item only	Low	Teen ESL [U]
64	Problem-Solving Survival	D/C	Chooses items for desert island, justifies	S,G	A2-B2	Co-op: reach agreement	Low	Classic ranking task
65	This or That	D	Picks between two images and says why	S	A1-B1	Teacher answers too	Low	Would You Rather
66	Opinion Line (agree/disagree)	D	Slides a marker on agree-disagree scale and explains	S,G	A2-B2	Teacher shares own view	Low	Four corners adaptation [U]
67	Podcast Host	D/C	Hosts a mini-episode with teacher as guest	S	B1-B2	Prep notes allowed	Med	Creator tools
68	Reverse Teacher	C	Student teaches a rule or word to teacher who plays confused	S,G	A2-B2	Core 1:1 inversion	Low	Learning by teaching [U]
69	Story Dice Telling (Rory's Story Cubes)	D	Rolls icon dice, tells a story	S,V	A1-B2	Teacher adds next sentence	Low	Story Cubes

6. Writing (11)

#	Name	Fmt	What the student does	Skills	CEFR	1:1 adaptation	Comfort	Source
70	Mad Libs Builder	D	Supplies words by part of speech, hears funny result	W,G,V	A1-B1	Teacher reads aloud with silly voice	Low	Mad Libs
71	Chat Message Sim	D	Replies to a text thread (friend invites)	W	A1-B2	Teacher is friend; emoji allowed	Low	Messaging sims [U]
72	Collaborative Story (one sentence each)	D	Alternates sentences in a shared doc	W,G	A2-B2	Teacher models errors to repair kindly	Low	Common ESL [U]
73	Postcard / Email Template Quest	D	Writes a short email with checklists	W	A1-B1	Teacher reply makes it real	Low	Cambridge Writing [U]
74	Sentence Expander	D	Grows "The dog ran" into a rich sentence	W,G	A2-B2	Own-best length	Low	Busy Teacher [U]

#	Name	Fmt	What the student does	Skills	CEFR	1:1 adaptation	Comfort	Source
75	Six-Word Story	D/C	Writes whole story in 6 words	W	B1-B2	Swap and guess	Low	Hemingway meme
76	Caption This (meme/photo)	D	Writes captions	W,V	A2-B2	Teacher picks the funniest, no ranking	Low	Meme games
77	Review Writer	D	Writes a review of a film/game/product	W	B1-B2	Teacher asks questions	Low	Busy Teacher [U]
78	Peer-style Feedback (teacher draft)	D	Corrects teacher's draft text	W,G	B1-B2	Roles reversed	Low	Error correction [U]
79	Diary / Daily Log Streak	D	Writes 3 sentences per day	W	A1-B1	Private streak, no leaderboard	Low	Duolingo streak
80	Dictation Run	C	Teacher reads, student writes	W,L,Sp	A1-B1	Two reads; student corrects	Med	Classic

7. Pronunciation & spelling (11)

#	Name	Fmt	What the student does	Skills	CEFR	1:1 adaptation	Comfort	Source
81	Wordle (vocab-themed)	D	Guesses a 5-letter word in 6 tries	Sp,V	A2-B2	Co-solve or teacher picks word	Low	Wordle
82	Spelling Bee	D	Builds words from 7 letters	Sp,V	A2-B2	Own-best score; hints	Low	NYT Spelling Bee
83	Hangman	D/C	Guesses letters; "friendly" version where no one is hurt	Sp,V	A1-B1	Draw a house/balloon, not a figure	Low	Hangman
84	Crossword	D	Solves clues	Sp,V,R	A2-B2	Co-solve	Low	Crossword
85	Scrabble-lite Word Builder	D	Builds words from tiles	Sp,V	A2-B2	Teacher plays; teacher may "pass"	Med	Scrabble
86	Tongue-Twister Ladder	C	Repeats progressively harder twisters	P	A2-B2	Own-best slow-to-fast; laugh-with	Med	Teen ESL [U]
87	Minimal Pair Bingo	D	Says/hears minimal pairs	P,L	A1-B2	Card solo	Low	Pronunciation Games [U]
88	Stress Clap/Dots	D	Marks stressed syllable on words	P	A2-B2	Teacher models both	Low	Pronunciation drills [U]
89	Echo the Teacher (shadowing)	C/D	Repeats short clip with rhythm	P	A1-B2	Record & compare own recordings (private)	Low	Shadowing technique
90	Silent Letters Detective	D	Finds silent letters in word lists	Sp,P	B1-B2	Teacher has quirky facts	Low	ESL Info [U]
91	Sound Sorting Mats	D	Drags words to sound groups (/iː/ vs /ɪ/)	P	A2-B2	Teacher sorts too	Low	Busy Teacher [U]

8. Review / retrieval (11)

#	Name	Fmt	What the student does	Skills	CEFR	1:1 adaptation	Comfort	Source
92	Quiz Show (Jeopardy board)	D	Picks category/points and answers	All	A1-B2	Teacher is host, no opponents; "buy a hint"	Med	Jeopardy
93	Kahoot-style Solo Quiz	D	Answers quiz solo	All	A1-B2	No leaderboard; personal best only	Med	Kahoot
94	Boss Battle Review	D	Answers to damage a boss (co-op with teacher)	All	A1-B2	Teacher has lives too	Low	RPG genre
95	Roguelike Deck Review	D	Collects "cards" (vocab/phrases) and uses them to beat rooms	V,G	A2-B2	Co-op, rerolls	Low	Slay the Spire genre
96	Card Trading Collection	D	Earns cards for mastered words, trades with teacher	V	A1-B1	Collection only, no ranking	Low	Trading card games
97	Flip & Recall (brain dump)	C	Writes everything remembered for 2 min, then checks	V	A1-B2	Private count	Low	Retrieval practice [U]
98	Tile-Matching Review	D	Matches word/definition tiles to clear board	V	A1-B2	Calm, no timer by default	Low	Candy Crush-like
99	Endless Runner Review	D	Runs/jumps picking right option	V,G	A1-B1	Optional; speed adjustable	Med	Platformer genre
100	Last Lesson Memory Palace	D	Walks through a scene with objects from last lesson	V	A1-B2	Teacher quizzes gently	Low	Memory palace [U]
101	Lucky Dip Questions	D	Draws question cards from a pot	All	A1-B2	Skip once	Low	Wordwall Random Cards
102	Teach-Back Test	C	Explains last lesson to teacher	S,All	A2-B2	Teacher plays curious younger sibling	Low	Protege effect [U]

9. Creative production (13)

#	Name	Fmt	What the student does	Skills	CEFR	1:1 adaptation	Comfort	Source
103	Comic Strip Maker	D	Chooses panels and writes speech bubbles	W,V	A1-B2	Teacher co-authors	Low	Comic tools
104	Meme Maker	D	Writes caption on a template	W	A2-B2	Private option, shared on request	Low	Meme culture
105	Vlog / Intro Video Script	D/C	Plans a 30 s vlog and rehearses	W,S	A2-B2	Audio-only option	Med	Teen YouTube/TikTok [U]
106	Podcast Episode Maker	D	Scripts and records a mini-episode	W,S	B1-B2	Teacher is guest	Med	Podcast tools
107	Design-a-Game	D	Invents a simple game and explains rules	S,W,G	B1-B2	Teacher beta-tests it	Low	Project-based [U]
108	Poster / Infographic	D	Designs a poster on a topic	W,V	A2-B2	Co-design	Low	Canva
109	Digital Avatar & Bio	D	Creates avatar and fills profile	W,V	A1-B1	Alias allowed (privacy)	Low	Profile creation [U]
110	Playlist Curator	D	Chooses 5 songs and explains	S,V	A2-B2	Teacher adds one	Low	Teen interest [U]
111	Photo Scavenger Hunt	D/C	Finds and shares photos of listed items	V,S	A1-B1	Home items only; camera optional	Low	Scavenger hunt
112	Menu / Shop Designer	D	Designs menu, prices, descriptions	W,V	A1-B2	Teacher is first customer	Low	Tycoon games
113	Fan Fiction / Character Profile	D	Builds fictional character sheet	W	A2-B2	Share only if wanted	Low	Teen writing [U]
114	Travel Itinerary Planner	D	Plans a trip	W,S,R	A2-B2	Budget cap puzzle	Low	Busy Teacher [U]
115	News Bulletin Broadcast	D/C	Reads/records a 1-minute news item	S,W	B1-B2	Teacher is anchor partner	Med	Role-play [U]

10. Mystery, story and adventure (14)

#	Name	Fmt	What the student does	Skills	CEFR	1:1 adaptation	Comfort	Source
116	Escape Room (Digital)	D	Solves language puzzles to unlock locks	R,G,V	A2-B2	Co-op with teacher as guide	Low	Escape rooms
117	Detective Case File	D	Reads clues, interrogates NPC (teacher), names suspect	R,S,L	B1-B2	Teacher voices suspects	Low	Detective games
118	Murder-Mystery-lite (no violence)	D	Finds who "took the cake"	R,L	A2-B2	Same	Low	Cluedo [U]
119	Branching Story Choose-Your-Path	D	Chooses actions and explains	R,S	A2-B2	Co-write ending	Low	Twine
120	Time Traveller Quest	D	Visits eras and solves tasks	R,V	A2-B2	Co-op	Low	Adventure genre
121	Mission Impossible Spy Briefing	D	Decodes message, plans mission	R,G	B1-B2	Teacher as handler	Low	Spy theme [U]
122	Survival Crafting	D	Gathers items by following instructions	V,R	A2-B1	Item list = vocab	Low	Minecraft-like
123	Cafe/Shop Tycoon	D	Manages orders with dialogues	V,S	A1-B1	Teacher is customer	Low	Tycoon sims
124	Social Deduction-lite (Mafia/Werewolf co-op)	C	Teacher and student find the imposter in a story	S,L	B1-B2	Imposter is NPC, no accusations on people	Med	Mafia, Among Us [U]
125	Mystery Object Box	D	Asks questions to identify an object	S,G	A1-B1	Teacher answers	Low	20 Questions
126	Treasure Map Navigator	D	Follows written directions	R,V	A1-B1	Co-op	Low	Treasure hunt
127	Lost in a City (travel adventure)	D	Asks for directions from NPCs	S,L	A1-B1	Teacher plays locals	Low	Real-life task
128	Cozy Visual Novel Date-less (friends/school)	D	Builds friendship through dialogue	R,S	A2-B2	Teen content safe	Low	Visual novel
129	Rhythm Game (Lyrics Tapper)	D	Taps in rhythm with chunks	L,P	A2-B2	Easy mode	Med	Rhythm genre

11. Warm-ups and energisers (11)

#	Name	Fmt	What the student does	Skills	CEFR	1:1 adaptation	Comfort	Source
130	Mood Check-in Emoji	D	Picks emoji for mood and says why	S	A1-B2	No wrong answer	Low	SEL practice [U]
131	Photo of the Day	D	Describes a picture	S,V	A1-B2	Teacher asks 1 question	Low	Cambly teachers [U]
132	Quick Fire 5	D/C	Answers 5 easy questions	S	A1-B1	Skip allowed	Low	Warm-up standard
133	Stand Up Stretch & Say	C	Moves body while naming	S,V	A1-B1	Camera optional	Low	TPR

#	Name	Fmt	What the student does	Skills	CEFR	1:1 adaptation	Comfort	Source
134	Word of the Day	D	Learns/uses one word	V	A1-B2	Pick own	Low	Dictionary apps
135	Weekend / News Catch-up	C	Shares news	S	A1-B2	Teacher shares first	Low	Standard
136	Rock-Paper-Scissors Warm-up	D/C	Plays and says phrases	S	A1-A2	Light	Low	Classic
137	Pass the Ball Questions	D	Spins a ball to a question	S	A1-B1	Skip	Low	Wordwall
138	Song Opener	D	Listens and hums/fills a word	L	A1-B1	Student picks	Low	Teen
139	Riddle of the Day	D/C	Solves a riddle	R,L	A2-B2	Hints	Low	Classic
140	Would You Rather (warm-up)	C	Picks quickly	S	A1-B2	Teacher too	Low	Classic

12. Cool-downs and reflection (8)

#	Name	Fmt	What the student does	Skills	CEFR	1:1 adaptation	Comfort	Source
141	Three Things I Learned	D/C	Lists three	W,S	A1-B2	Private	Low	Exit ticket
142	Can-Do Self-Check	D	Ticks "I can..." statements	R	A1-B2	Private	Low	CEFR portfolio
143	Highlight & Challenge	D	Picks fave moment and next goal	S	A1-B2	Collaborative goal-setting	Low	Reflection [U]
144	Mini Gratitude / Compliment Exchange	C	Shares one positive	S	A1-B2	Teacher too	Low	SEL [U]
145	Calm Story / Slow Read	D	Listens to a quiet short story	L	A1-B2	Teacher reads	Low	Wind-down
146	Collection Reveal	D	Sees earned Word Cards (private deck)	-	A1-B2	Own collection only	Low	Collection with no gacha or chance
147	Homework Menu Choice	D	Chooses homework from menu	R,W	A1-B2	Choice = autonomy	Low	Differentiation [U]
148	Exit Emoji + Goal for Next Time	D	Gives feedback	S	A1-B2	Private	Low	Exit ticket

---

13. Classic and retro games (added 2026-10-14)

Research 2026-10-14 (search summaries only; pages not fully read): eslactive.com game pages list ESL versions of Hangman, Bingo, Pictionary, Concentration/Memory, Guess Who, Anagrams and Charades; Adapting arcade games for learning (CHI 2013) built a Tetris vocabulary drill and argues arcade games are simple to adapt; a 2015 study of arcade-style games in Portuguese and French classes reported perceived vocabulary gains (repositorio.esepf.pt); Twinkl teen phonics blending games show picture-matching by blending for A1 teens. Rows below are our own adaptations of the **mechanic only**, 1:1 and non-competitive (student vs own best, or teacher co-op). Source marks: [S] seen in a search result, [K] well-known classic, no page checked.

#	Name	Fmt	What the student does	Skills	CEFR	1:1 adaptation	Comfort	Source
149	Sound Hangman	D/C	Guesses letters of a word the teacher hides; every right letter lights a tile and is said aloud	V,Sp,P	Pre-A1-A2	Teacher and student share lives; no "dead" figure: the picture is a phone that loses signal bars	Low	Hangman [S]
150	Sound Bingo	D	Listens and marks the sound, number or picture on a card	L,V	Pre-A1-A2	Student vs own best card; teacher calls then swaps	Low	Bingo [S]
151	Whack-a-Word	D	Taps only the tile that matches the sound or word heard	L,P	Pre-A1-B1	No clock pressure option; own-best streak	Med	Whack-a-mole [K]
152	Tile Stacker	D	Falling letter/word tiles are placed to build a word or sentence (Tetris-style)	V,G,Sp	A1-B2	Slow-fall mode; teacher pauses to model	Med	Tetris vocabulary drill, CHI 2013 [S]
153	Word Snake	D	Steers a snake through letters in the right order to spell a word	Sp,V	A1-B1	Speed set by the student	Med	Snake [K]
154	Pac-Collect	D	Collects only the words that fit a category (sounds, tenses, topic) and avoids the others	V,G	A1-B2	No ghosts: wrong items just bounce	Low	Pac-Man [S]
155	Space Defender	D	Shoots the word that answers the audio or the gap in a sentence	L,G	A1-B2	Pauses between waves; accuracy mode	Med	Space Invaders / arcade [K]
156	River Hop	D	Hops across stones that carry the correct forms to reach the other bank	G,V	A1-B1	Wrong stone = gentle splash, retry	Low	Frogger [K]
157	Simon Says Sounds	D/C	Repeats a growing sequence of sounds or words in order	L,P,V	Pre-A1-B1	Teacher also tries and sometimes errs; own-best length	Low	Simon / Simon Says [K]
158	Memory Pairs (sound-picture)	D	Flips cards to match a sound, word and picture	V,L	Pre-A1-B1	Co-op; own-best moves	Low	Concentration / Memory [S]

#	Name	Fmt	What the student does	Skills	CEFR	1:1 adaptation	Comfort	Source
159	Battleship Grid	D	Calls a grid square with the target form ("B3: Is it a pin?") to find hidden pictures	S,G	A1-B1	Teacher hides, student searches, then swap	Low	Battleship [K]
160	Guess Who? (photos)	D/C	Narrows down a hidden person or object by yes/no questions	S,G	A1-B1	Roles swap; teacher asks badly on purpose	Low	Guess Who [S]
161	Anagram Race	D	Rearranges letters into the word of a picture	Sp,V	A1-B2	Own-best time; hints = first letter	Low	Anagrams / Bananagrams [S]
162	Charades with Photos	D/C	Mimes or describes a photo's action; the teacher guesses with the target chunk	V,S	A1-B1	Teacher guesses wrong sometimes	Med	Charades [S]
163	Pictionary Sketch	D	Draws a word on the shared canvas; the teacher guesses and says the sentence	V,S	A1-B2	Teacher draws too; stickers allowed	Low	Pictionary [S]
164	Snakes and Ladders Quest	D	Answers a question to climb a ladder; a slip is a short retry task	any	A1-B2	Co-op board, no dice rivalry	Low	Snakes and Ladders [K]
165	Treasure Hunt Trail	D	Follows picture clues across the scene, saying each target sentence	S,R	A1-B1	Teacher gives the clue then the student sets one	Low	Treasure hunt [K]
166	Rhythm Lane	D	Taps stressed syllables or sounds in time with a beat	P,L	Pre-A1-B2	Slow tempo by default	Med	Rhythm games [K]
167	Spot the Sound	D	Finds all pictures that start with a given sound in a busy scene	L,V,P	Pre-A1-A2	Scene calmed (CalmBg); own-best	Low	I Spy [K]
168	Pairs Bingo (minimal pairs)	D	Hears one of two near-words (in/an) and marks the right one	L,P	Pre-A1-B1	Teacher co-op	Low	Bingo + minimal pairs [K]
169	Never Have I Ever (present perfect)	C/D	Says "I have never ___" about true things; the teacher says whether they have; the student keeps a score against their own best	S,G	A2-B2	No rival: own-best score; the student can pass any prompt; teacher plays too	Low	ESL warm-ups: Teach-This, ESL Active (summaries only) [S]
170	Verb Trio Memory	D	Flips or builds cards showing the base form, the past simple and the past participle of a verb; says the missing forms; earns the pair by saying a sentence	V,G,S	A2-B1	The cards are split in two, then the past halves are hidden and recalled; teacher says the base form, student gives the rest	Low	Twinkl irregular verbs card game, ESLprintables memory game (summaries only) [S]
171	Trophy Forge	D	Collects three form-tiles of a verb (base, past, participle), crafts the trio, says it aloud; each trio becomes a named trophy on the student's board	V,G,S	A2-B1	Own board, never ranked; slips return to the Mistake Bank	Low	Our design: loot and crafting + achievement log (B1 S1 plan) [U]

Top 15 for shy teens

1. Codenames Duet (co-op) 2. Connections 3. Escape Room with teacher as guide 4. Visual Novel Reader / Interactive Fiction 5. Wordle / Spelling Bee 6. Comic Strip Maker 7. Meme Maker / Caption This 8. Chat Message Sim 9. Opinion Line (slider, no voice pressure) 10. Photo Story-Talk 11. Boss Battle Review (co-op) 12. Card Trading Collection 13. Reverse Teacher (student is expert) 14. Shadowing with private recordings 15. Can-Do Self-Check and Exit Emoji (private).

Mechanics to avoid for 1:1 teen

- Public or named leaderboards, rankings, streak-shaming, and "you lost X points" screens.
- Elimination, "you're out", lives that end the session.
- Hard timers as the default (offer as opt-in; never on speaking).
- Forced on-camera acting (charades, mime, singing); always offer an audio/describe alternative.
- Teacher "winning" against the student repeatedly; forced guess-in-front-of-cameras gotchas.
- Unfinished error shaming (red crosses, buzzer sounds); use neutral "try again / nearly".
- Hangman with a hanged figure (use a balloon/house), and violent or gambling mechanics (loot boxes, gacha).
- Accusation-based social deduction aimed at real people; pressured cold-calling in debate with no prep time.
- Content that forces personal disclosure (family, money, body); allow aliases and "pass".
- Browser built-in TTS voices (project rule): use recorded voices only.

What already exists in the repo (reuse before building)

Catalogue entries	Existing component / kind
116 Escape Room, 118 mystery-lite	`escape_room_slot`
33, 34, 119 interactive fiction / visual novel / branching	`story_page`, `scene_dialogue`, `role_play` slides
17 Sentence Builder, 27 Transform	`sentence_builder` (+ `expedition_game` for choose-then-justify)
18 Error Hunt, 71 Chat Message Sim	`conversation_fill`, `fill_blank`
6, 98 matching / tile review	`matching`, `vocab_image_match`, `picture_match_game`, vocab-games `MemoryGrid`
3, 4, 15 odd-one-out / connections / spot-the-difference	`canvas_game`, `find_in_scene_game`

Catalogue entries	Existing component / kind
94 Boss Battle, 99 runner	vocab-games `BossRound`, `RescueRound`, `WordRush` (add an accuracy/no-clock mode)
47, 87, 91 minimal pairs / sound sorting	`sound_challenge_game`
55, 59, 64 role-play, interview, survival ranking	`role_play`, `speaking_task`
13, 96 spaced deck, card collection	`srs.ts` + `MemoryBank` (not yet in the Academy player)
142, 148 can-do, exit emoji	`content.levels[block].ican` (partial)

Everything else (dictation, shadowing with private recording, Wordle/Spelling Bee, Codenames Duet, Taboo-lite, Reverse Teacher, Photo Story-Talk, Opinion Line, podcast/vlog/meme/comic makers) needs a new component; build in the order the Season pilot needs them, one new or upgraded mechanic per Season.

14. Added 2026-10-15 (B1 Season 1 lesson 1)

- **Hot Seat** (quiz-show ladder, 50:50 and Ask a friend; a wrong answer only greys a choice) — recall and activation.
- **Break the Clock** (boss fight: hit points, three shields, the round repeats with the reason) — choose between two tenses or forms.
- **Participle Wordle** (six tries, green / gold / grey, on-screen keyboard) — spell the past participle.
- **Rapport** (dialogue RPG: pick the natural reply, a Rapport meter rises, the character answers) — realistic exchanges with follow-up questions.
- **Triple Match** (match-3: one tile in each of three columns, combo for first-try triples, trio spoken) — group related forms (base, past, participle; also noun-verb-adjective families).

Added 2026-10-15

- **Glitch Hunt** (error correction as a bug hunt) — B1+ grammar accuracy: find the wrong line in a chat, choose the repair, hear the reason. Source: sentence-correction tasks (LearnEnglishFeelGood, Twee). Built as slide kind `glitch`.
- **Two Truths and a Lie** (speaking) — A2+: three sentences, one is false; the listener asks follow-up questions and guesses. Source: British Council "Find someone who", Twinkl "Liar Liar". Built as a `say` page.
- **Verb Draw** (B1+, grammar + speaking; owner request 2026-10-15) — phase 1 match the trio forms (base, past simple, past participle); phase 2 draw a verb card and start a conversation with it (present perfect question, then a past-simple follow-up). Source mechanics: Triple Match (match-3), "Never have I ever" speaking cards, card-draw prompts. Built as slide kind `verbdraw` (optional, end of the Release).

Source: docs/academy-video-game-mechanics.md

Academy video-game mechanics list (living list)

Owner rule 2026-10-14: every Academy unit (Season) and lesson names at least one mechanic borrowed from a video game, so students have a blast. Companion to `docs/academy-games-catalog.md` (148 classroom games). Mechanics only, never characters, content or music; teen-appropriate (13-18); recorded voices only; motion rules in CLAUDE.md apply.

Status: seed list from general game-design knowledge, **unverified**. The next research pass (units: see `docs/research/`) must confirm, extend and log sources per mechanic. Add rows as lessons use them.

Mechanic	Video-game family	What the student does in English	Best for	Comfort
Quest log + clue unlock	Adventure / RPG	Completes language tasks to unlock the next clue of the Season story	every Season	Low
Boss fight (rounds with a weak spot)	Action RPG	Answers rapid retrieval items; each correct one damages the boss; wrong = gentle retry	review, Remix	Med
Loot and crafting	Survival / crafting	Collects words, combines them into phrases/sentences to craft an item	vocabulary, collocations	Low
Escape room	Puzzle / point-and-click	Reads or hears clues to open locks	reading, listening	Low
Detective board	Mystery	Collects evidence sentences, connects names, times, places	reading, past tenses	Low
Rhythm lane	Rhythm	Taps stressed syllables or words in time with a beat	pronunciation, stress	Med
Shop / trading sim	Management sim	Buys, sells and negotiates with the guide	functional language	Low
Dialogue tree	Visual novel / RPG	Chooses replies; consequences show register and politeness	speaking, pragmatics	Low
Tower defence	Strategy	Places the correct word/form to stop an incoming error	grammar accuracy	Med
Speedrun vs own best	Platformer	Repeats a route of items against his or her own record (no leaderboards)	fluency, recall	Med
Skill tree	RPG progression	Sees can-do skills unlock and level up after each Season	motivation, portfolio	Low
Stealth (quiet path)	Stealth	Picks polite/indirect phrases to pass guards	politeness, modals	Low
Falling-tile stacker	Tetris-style	Places falling letter/word tiles to build a word or sentence	spelling, word order	Med
Maze collector	Pac-Man-style	Collects only words that fit a category and avoids others (no ghosts)	vocabulary sets, grammar sorting	Low
Wave defender	Space Invaders-style	Answers audio or gaps to clear waves, with accuracy mode	listening, grammar	Med
Stepping stones	Frogger-style	Crosses by choosing the right forms	grammar, collocations	Low
Whack-a-word	Whack-a-mole	Taps only the sound or word heard	sound discrimination	Med
Sequence memory	Simon	Repeats a growing sequence of sounds/words	listening, pronunciation, memory	Low
Board quest	Snakes and Ladders / party board	Answers to climb, co-op	any review	Low
Achievement log / trophy case	RPG / platform achievements	Completes language tasks; each one unlocks a named trophy that stays on the student's own board (the Season's bucket list is the log); never ranked, never public	motivation, portfolio, any Season with a list or a collection	Low

Research 2026-10-15 (B1 Season 1): achievement-type features (badges, points, levels, tasks) were linked to inspiration and drive in a 2023 survey of language-app users and to higher motivation and retention in a 10-week experiment (INTI journal, search summary only; small studies, nothing on teens specifically).

Sources for the retro rows: Adapting arcade games for learning, CHI 2013 (Tetris and Pac-Man vocabulary drills; seen in a search result, not read in full) and general knowledge [K]. See also games 149-168 in `docs/academy-games-catalog.md` section 13.

Added 2026-10-15

- **Boss fight with hit points and shields** → *Break the Clock*: each right tense is a strike; shields recharge so nothing is lost.
- **Word puzzle (Wordle)** → *Participle Wordle*.
- **Quiz-show ladder with lifelines** → *Hot Seat*.
- **Dialogue RPG with a relationship meter** → *Rapport*.
- **Match-3 with combos** (*Candy Crush*-style) → *Triple Match*.

Added 2026-10-15 (B1 S1 L1)

- **Spot the glitch / bug hunt** (*Among Us*-style "find the odd one", debugging games) → *Glitch Hunt*: a chat with one tense glitch; tap it, repair it, hear the reason.
- **Bluffing / deduction party game** (*Two Truths and a Lie*, social-deduction games) → the teacher guesses which of the student's three "have" sentences is the lie (speaking).
- **Collectible card draw + talk-show host** (*Hearthstone*-style draw, late-night interview shows) → *Verb Draw*: match the verb trios (match-3), then draw a verb card and open a conversation with it (participle for the question, say it, past-simple follow-up, the other character answers); a conversation streak counts first-try chats.

6. Teaching framework

Source: docs/academy-lesson-plan-template.md

Academy lesson plan template (one-to-one, 60 minutes)

Rule: CLAUDE.md "A lesson plan comes before every lesson" (2026-10-14). Copy this into `docs/academy-<season>-spec.md` for each lesson. Backward design: need → outcome → evidence → activities (not the other way round).

1. **Student need.** Who is the student (age 13-18, level, home language: ar/es/fr/tr/it)? What do they already know (the previous lessons' items)? What is hard for them (L1 transfer: `docs/research/academy-curriculum-teen-sla-and-l1-gaps.md`)? What do they want or need English for? Comfort settings.
2. **Objective and exit task.** One "I can ..." the student can reach and show today; the exit task (what they do at the end); success criteria (e.g. 8 of 10 blends with at most one hint). New items <= the level cap.
3. **Research log.** >= 3 external sources (Oxford, Cambridge, British Council, Pearson GSE, apps/platforms, classic-game sites): URL, what mechanic/scenario was taken, quality, limits, verified/unverified. File: `docs/research/academy-<lesson>-research.md`. Take mechanics, never content.
4. **Run of show (60 min).** The Remember? part is built from `recallPlan` (`src/curriculum/academy/recall.ts`, `docs/academy-recall-spacing-progression.md`): items due from earlier lessons on the expanding schedule (1, 2, 4, 8, 16 teaching lessons back), earlier patterns, the teacher's error log, and a progress line (builds on / unlocks). Table: minute range, part, teacher does, student does, 1:1 technique, wait cue. Parts sum to 60. Teacher talk <= 40%. Model first (I do / we do / you do); the rule is stated plainly (<= 3 lines) before the practice; the student teaches it back at the end.
5. **Speaking.** Student talk, speaking minutes and the ladder steps reached, meeting `SPEAKING_TARGETS` for the level (`docs/academy-speaking-practice.md`); every game answer can be said aloud. 5b. **Intensive, gamified practice.** Responses per part (target >= 80 student responses per hour), a practice ladder (guided → semi-independent → independent → mixed), interleaving old and new, an error-return loop with expanding spacing, a mastery check with a fallback (chill track), a fluency round against the student's own best (no leaderboards).
6. **Games and mechanics.** From `docs/academy-games-catalog.md` (incl. section 13 classic and retro games) and one video-game mechanic from `docs/academy-video-game-mechanics.md`; no game three times in a row; the signature game and fun hook.
7. **Traceability.** A table: activity → objective / need served. Cut any activity that serves neither.
8. **Supports and differentiation.** Home-language hint, slower audio, chill track, stretch.
9. **Assessment and follow-up.** Formative evidence, the Daily 10 on the spacing calendar (days 1, 3, 7, 14, 30), voice note, next clue.
10. **Before building.** Scenario (if any story or video), pictures needed, audio needed, owner approval.

Pre-A1 only: the reading-first block (owner, 2026-10-15)

Every Pre-A1 lesson plan states, before anything is built (data: `src/curriculum/academy/preA1Reading.ts`, rule: `CLAUDE.md` "Pre-A1 is reading-first"):

Step	Plan says
Activate	the 3+ words for the private "I know it / New to me" check (words the student may already know from school or a phone)
Sounds and blending	the sounds taught so far, the words blended and spelled
Message	a 3-6 line message from a cast member made only of the sounds and whole words taught so far (checked by `readingProblems()`), read twice: listen, then read
Word bank	3+ words the student may keep from the message, practised the same lesson (listen and match with word tiles) and returned on the spaced schedule

A Pre-A1 plan without a reading block fails the traceability check.

Source: docs/academy-lesson-checklist.md

Lesson checklist and unit assessment (2026-10-14)

Owner: after a lesson the teacher can check what the student did; at the end of a unit a marked checklist says whether the student needs more practice or nailed it; and **it should be included in the lesson report**. Yes, it is possible, and it is built.

1. After every lesson (the lesson checklist)

- **Goals:** the lesson's success criteria ("I can ..." lines from the deck, 5 per lesson). The teacher marks each one: **Nailed it / Almost / Needs more practice**. In the player's review mode the marks can start from what the student did (wrong tries and hints per goal, `suggestMark`).
- **Also marked:** the highest **speaking ladder step** reached, up to **3 recurring errors** (pronunciation, vocabulary, grammar, word order, listening, spelling, fluency, confidence; they start the next Remember?), a **comfort** flag, notes, and the "Say it" tally.
- **Verdict** (`lessonResult`): *Nailed the lesson* (all goals nailed, speaking reached its step, student at ease) · *Needs more practice* (any goal not yet, two or more almost, tense student, or speaking below its step) · *Replay this lesson* (half or more goals not yet). Each verdict lists actions: "Practise next lesson: ...", "Start the next Remember? with: ...", "Move on".

2. End of a unit (the unit assessment, after lesson 8)

- **Six strands** scored 0-100: listening, speaking, reading, writing, vocabulary, grammar (speaking and writing from the rubric as a percentage). 80+ = nailed, 60-79 = almost (65 at a level check), below = needs more practice.
- **Release rubric**, five criteria rated 1-4: accuracy, range, fluency, interaction, independence.
- **Verdict** (`unitResult`): *Nailed the unit* (5+ strands nailed, none weak, Release average 3+) · *Ready for the next unit · Needs more practice, then move on* (1-2 weak strands) · *Repeat the unit first* (3 weak strands or Release average under 2). A level check is stricter (6 strong for "nailed", 4 for "ready").
- **Practice plan** for each weak strand: which lessons to replay (listening E1/E4, speaking E4/E6, reading E5, writing E5/E6, vocabulary E2, grammar E3), extra Daily 10 time, retest in 2 weeks.

3. Where it lives

- Rules: `src/curriculum/academy/checklist.ts` (tested). Panels: `src/academy-deck/teacher/LessonChecklistPanel.tsx`, `UnitAssessmentPanel.tsx`.
- **In the lesson report:** `LessonWrapUpDialog` (the teacher's report after class) shows the checklist in step 2 when an Academy library lesson was on screen (`TeacherClassroom` passes `academyLessonId`), and the unit assessment after a unit's last lesson. The results go into the family message draft ("Lesson goals: 3 of 5 nailed. To practise: ..."), are saved in the report (`lesson_feedback_submissions.feedback_content.academy_checklist`, no new columns) and are shown in `FeedbackReportDialog` (teacher and student) and the parent's feedback card (`AcademyChecklistSummary`).
- Teacher's own copy: `src/services/academyChecklistService.ts`, table `academy_teacher_checks` (migration `20261014150000_academy_teacher_checks.sql`, **written, not applied**; until then it is kept in the teacher's browser).

4. Limits

- The report carries the checklist only when the lesson was an Academy library lesson shown in the classroom; other lessons keep the old report.
- Marks start at "Almost" in the classroom (the live player does not send wrong tries to the report yet); the teacher sets them.
- Thresholds are starting values [target]. The unit assessment's scores must be entered by the teacher; the checkpoint games do not feed them automatically yet.
- Student and parent see the marks in plain words; a verdict like "Repeat the unit first" is shown only to the teacher in the practice plan (families see the goals and "To practise").

Source: docs/academy-speaking-practice.md

Speaking practice in every lesson (2026-10-14)

Owner: "speaking practice is very, very important" (message cut off after "...depending on the other skills"). Read as: speaking gets the biggest share of live time at every level, and the other skills feed it (listening gives the model, vocabulary and grammar give the words, reading and writing prepare and record what is said). One-to-one is the Academy's advantage: the student can speak for much of the hour.

1. Targets (`src/curriculum/academy/speaking.ts` , tested) [target]

Level	Student talk	Speaking minutes	Tasks	Must reach	Voice notes a week
Pre-A1	40 %	12	4	controlled	2
A1	45 %	15	5	guided	2
A2	50 %	18	5	guided	2
B1	55 %	20	5	free	3
B2	60 %	22	5	free	3
C1	65 %	25	5	free	3
"Speaking minutes" are explicit speaking practice (the ladder, Mission, role-plays), not the answers inside games. Skill balance in the level frames is now speaking 30–35 % at every level (it was 15–25 %), the largest share.					

2. The speaking ladder (every new language climbs it in the lesson)

shadow (say it together with the model) → repeat (alone after the model) → controlled (a given pattern, new words) → guided (a short exchange, first words of a frame) → free (own words). Supports fade up the ladder. Pronunciation is judged on being understood, not on accent (`academy-curriculum-teen-sla-and-l1-gaps.md`).

3. In the lesson

- Every game answer can be **said aloud**: the student says the word before or after tapping (blend → say the word; reader → read the line aloud; match → say it). The teacher confirms with one tap (a "Say it" check, to build in the player).
- Each lesson has the ladder as its spine: a shadow/repeat block after every vocabulary set, a controlled and a guided task in the middle, and the **Mission** (Take 1, feedback, Take 2) at the end; B1 and above add a free-speaking task.
- **Teacher talk ≤ 40 %**; after a question the teacher waits 4–5 seconds; correction is one thing done well plus one to try; shy students get private rehearsal and type-instead-of-speak (comfort first).
- **Speaking between lessons:** the Daily 10 includes a voice note (2–3 a week) and a "say it aloud" retrieval round, so speaking is practised daily, not only in the hour.
- **Assessment:** the Finale's Release is spoken; the six-strand checkpoint scores speaking with a rubric (accuracy, range, fluency, interaction, comprehensibility), not a single mark.

4. How the other skills feed speaking

Skill	Feeds speaking by
Listening	the model to shadow; the exchange to answer; shadowing clips at every level
Vocabulary	the words in the Mission; chunks first so the student can talk early
Grammar	the rule stated plainly, then controlled sentences before free ones
Reading	read-aloud lines; a text to retell
Writing	plan a short text, then say it; the written Release is read aloud

5. Where it stands

- Done: targets, ladder, checker (`speakingProblems`), level frames, rule in `CLAUDE.md` , gate check.
- Done 2026-10-14: a "Say it ✓" button in the lesson player on every game slide (teach, hear-and-pick, blend, reader, match, memory, build, spell, convo); the student says the answer aloud and taps it, a teal 🗣 tally shows the count and it is returned in the deck's finish stats (`stats.spoken`). It is a self-report that the teacher confirms by ear in the one-to-one lesson; no recording is made.
- Not yet: counting `stats.spoken` against the level targets in the teacher panel and the parent report; the speaking minutes of the already-built decks have not been re-measured (Pre-A1 P2 lesson 1 has about 6–7 explicit speaking minutes against a target of 12 until the "Say it" check counts the read-aloud rounds).

Source: docs/academy-recall-spacing-progression.md

Remembering earlier learning: recall, spacing and progression (2026-10-14)

Owner request: "remind the students about previous things, previous knowledge", "add spacing", "add progression". This is how the Academy does it. The rules live in code (`src/curriculum/academy/recall.ts` , tested in `__tests__/recall.test.ts`) so a lesson plan can read them instead of guessing.

1. The idea in one paragraph

A word met once is forgotten. A word met again **just before it is forgotten**, and again after longer and longer gaps, stays. So every lesson opens with **Remember?** (about ten minutes) that brings back items from earlier lessons on a fixed expanding schedule, the **Daily 10** practises the same items on calendar days, and the **Remix and Finale** lessons bring the whole Season back. The student also always sees **where they are** (progress) and **what this lesson builds on**.

2. The spacing schedule (what comes back, and when)

Counted in lessons that teach new language (Remix and Finale do not count as steps):

Step	The items come back	Roughly (2 lessons a week)	Items per lesson
1	in the very next such lesson	3 days	4
2	2 lessons later	1 week	3
3	4 lessons later	2 weeks	3
4	8 lessons later	4 weeks	2
5	16 lessons later	8 weeks	2

Each lesson teaches up to 14 items and the five steps give 4+3+3+2+2 = 14, so **every item returns at least once**; a rotating window picks different items at each step. A Remember? holds **at most 12 items** (Pre-A1: 8) so the ten minutes stay light. Patterns (grammar) taught in a lesson return from step 2 on as one quick use each. The teacher's **error log** (up to 3 recurring errors from the last lesson) also starts the Remember?. The gaps are design choices [target], to be tuned with real student data.

Daily 10 calendar (days after a lesson): 1, 3, 7, 14 and 30. Example: items taught on day 10 come back on days 11, 13, 17, 24 and 40.

3. Review lessons

- **Remix (lesson 7):** no new language; the whole Season comes back, mixed. In a **Big Remix** (every second Season) the Season before it comes back too.
- **Finale (lesson 8):** the Release and the checkpoint cover the Season; the checkpoint reports six strands (listening, speaking, reading, writing, vocabulary, grammar) so a weak strand gets extra Daily 10 time and appears in the next Season's lessons.
- **Level check (last Season of each level):** samples items from the whole level.
- **Start of a Season:** its first lesson recalls the last lessons of the Season before, because the schedule is continuous across Seasons.

4. Progression the student sees

For every lesson the system can say: *builds on* (the previous lesson's goal), *unlocks* (the next one), which Seasons are finished, how many items the student already knows and how many are new today. Shown to students as the path/skill tree, and to teachers and creators in the library: every planned lesson now lists its **Remember? (spaced)** plan, e.g. "A1-S02-E3 (2 lessons ago): ...".

5. What a lesson plan must do (added to the template)

`docs/academy-lesson-plan-template.md` step 4 now requires: the Remember? list taken from `recallPlan` , a progress line (builds on / unlocks), and the Daily 10 calendar. `academy-quality-gate` fails a plan with no Remember? list.

6. What is not built yet

- **Done (2026-10-14):** `src/academy-deck/recallSlides.ts` builds a Remember? hear-and-pick game from `recallPlan` (one item per earlier lesson in turn); Pre-A1 Season 2 lesson 1 uses it (`rem-recall`). Other decks still have hand-written Remember? slides; replace them with `recallRounds` when each lesson is rebuilt.
- **Done (2026-10-14):** the Daily 10 scheduler (`src/curriculum/academy/dailyTen.ts`): each item sits in a box 0-5; a right answer pushes its next practice to day 1, 3, 7, 14, 30 after the last good answer, a wrong one sends it back to tomorrow; today's pack is the ten most urgent items (fading ones first); tasks are recognise → say → use, so speaking starts early. `src/academy-deck/dailyTenDeck.ts` turns the pack into a short deck (hear-and-pick, then say-it-aloud). **Wired (2026-10-14, browser storage):** `src/academy-deck/practiceStore.ts` keeps item states, finished lessons (with the "Say it" tally) and Daily 10 days in this browser (a stand-in for the database); finishing a deck lesson adds its new items (`GenericDeckLesson`); the student page `/academy-daily-10` plays today's pack and moves items up or back. **My Lessons now has a Daily 10 banner** (`src/academy-deck/Daily10Banner.tsx`): how many words are due today and a Start button (hidden before the first lesson). **Database (written, NOT applied):** `supabase/migrations/20261014140000_student_academy_practice.sql` (one row per student; students manage their own, parents and teachers read) and `src/services/academyPracticeService.ts` (`syncPractice` : load, merge both ways with `mergePractice` , save; fails soft until the table exists). Apply the migration when you approve (SQL editor or `supabase db push`). **Teacher page built:** `/academy-practice-reports` (button "Student practice reports" in the teacher's Academy library) lists each student's gap-report card, restart-plan students first; it reads the database copy, so it fills in once the migration is applied. Still to do: (so progress follows the student across devices and the teacher can open `GapReportCard` for each student), the existing Sign Me Up homework quest keeps its own fixed chests.
- Per-student scheduling (items a student finds hard return sooner) needs the diagnostics service; the plan above is the default for everyone.

7. When the student does not practise (owner, 2026-10-14: "each curriculum has a gap... students don't remember because of the lack of practice")

Spacing only works if the student comes back on schedule. The gap manager (`src/curriculum/academy/practiceGap.ts`) decides what the next lesson does when they do not. Why forgetting happens, and the answer for each cause:

Cause	What the system does
Too few exposures	Each item meets 6+ encounters in the lesson and returns at gaps 1, 2, 4, 8, 16 (section 2); the Daily 10 adds days 1, 3, 7, 14, 30
Only recognising, never producing	Every lesson ends in a Mission (speak or write) and the Remember? asks for production as well as recognition; the Season Release is a thing the student makes
A gap between lessons (holiday, missed lessons)	`decideForGap` : **refresh** (8+ days, Daily 10 under half, recall under 70 %): fewer new items (8), Remember? 15 minutes, overdue items first. **Rewind** (15+ days, 3 missed lessons, recall under 50 %): no new language, replay the last two lessons. **Restart** (31+ days): 5-minute re-check and four lessons replayed
No practice between lessons	The Daily 10 is small by design (10 minutes); below the weekly dose (2 lessons + 3 Daily 10 sessions, about 90 minutes) it shrinks to a 5-minute mini or rescue round, with streak freezes, never a penalty
A weak strand hidden by a good average	The Finale reports six strands; the weak one gets extra Daily 10 time and returns in the next Season
Knowledge that never meets the next topic	Each Season recycles the two before it (`recycleFrom`) and the Remember? continues across Seasons; Big Remix every second Season

Teacher view (**built 2026-10-14**, `gapReport()` in `src/curriculum/academy/gapReport.ts` and the card `src/academy-deck/teacher/GapReportCard.tsx` ; not yet placed on a teacher page because the student data is not saved anywhere yet): a gap report per student: days since the last lesson, Daily 10 rate, recall accuracy, and the mode chosen with its reasons. The thresholds are starting values [target]; tune them with real students' data.

Source: docs/academy-learning-science.md

Academy learning science layer — what we do, why, how sure we are, how we observe it

Companion to `docs/academy-lesson-system.md` (Seasons, run of show, roadmap A1 → C1). Evidence base: `docs/research/academy-lesson-design.md` plus the verification pass of 2026-10-08.

Reading the labels. [V] = finding seen in a search result this session (mostly abstracts or secondary summaries — check against the paper before public use) · **[K]** = established literature known from memory, not re-checked · **[RT]** = rule of thumb, no direct study · **[U]** = unverified. **The honest headline:** most pooled evidence is lab-based, university-age or from general (non-language) learning. Almost none of it was tested on *teenagers in a digital one-to-one player*. So every technique below is a **well-supported hypothesis we will measure** (§5), not a proven result. We will not claim otherwise in marketing.

---

1. Principles

1. **Learning ≠ performance.** What a student gets right *during* the session is a poor index of what they will retain (Soderstrom & Bjork 2015) [V]. So we never treat in-session score, XP or streak as proof of learning; progress is judged on **delayed, production-based evidence** (§4).
2. **Retrieve, don't re-read; space, don't mass.** Both are the best-supported effects we have; we build them into the session and between sessions.
3. **Notice, then check the rule.** Discovery is a route into the rule, not a replacement for stating it.
4. **Output must be pushed, then repaired.** Students produce, get specific feedback, and try again.
5. **Teach chunks and words in several skills, deliberately.** Incidental learning alone is too weak.
6. **Perception before production for sounds**, with many voices.
7. **Reduce anxiety so students will speak** — it is a measurable drag on achievement.
8. **Build self-regulation** (goals, strategies, reflection) as part of the lesson, not an extra.

2. Technique → mechanism in the system

#	Technique	Evidence	Confidence	Where it lives	What exactly happens
1	**Retrieval practice**	Testing vs restudy g ≈ 0.50 (Rowland 2014, 61 mostly-lab studies); classroom synthesis g ≈ 0.50 (Yang 2021, secondary source); bigger with feedback and delays ≥ 1 day	[V] numbers via secondary summaries; effect is *general*, not L2-specific	Remember?, Daily 10, Remix, checkpoint	Production first (type/say with the answer hidden), recognition second; feedback after every item; ≥ 60 % of review items are production [RT]
2	**Spaced repetition**	Spacing beats massing; longer gaps win on *delayed* tests; expanding ≈ equal schedules (L2 meta-analysis summarised in a thesis: 98 effect sizes, 48 experiments)	[V] thesis abstract; most data are flashcard vocabulary	`srs.ts`, Daily 10, Remember?	Items scheduled by **calendar days since seen**: same session → +1 → +3 → +7 → +21 → +60; a miss drops to +1 [RT for the exact numbers]. Because families can take 1, 2 or 3 sessions a week, scheduling never assumes a fixed session gap
3	**Interleaving (limited)**	Overall g = 0.42, but **word-based material g = −0.39** (blocking better); helps when categories are similar (Brunmair & Richter 2019)	[V]; no L2 grammar/vocab study found	Remix, checkpoint	Do **not** interleave *new* vocabulary. Interleave only **confusable grammar contrasts** (e.g. past simple vs present perfect) *after* each is learned alone. Mixed cross-Season review is justified by spacing and retrieval, not by interleaving
4	**Noticing + guided discovery, then explicit rule**	Explicit beat implicit in both Norris & Ortega 2000 [K] and later meta-analyses (Goo 2015, 34 studies; Spada & Tomita 2010, 41 studies)	[V] abstract level	Pattern Lab (E3), Notice & Build	Examples in context → student finds the pattern → teacher confirms in ≤ 3 lines → controlled practice. We do **not** claim inductive teaching is better
5	**Comprehensible input at about i+1 (graded)**	Extensive reading d ≈ 0.46 between groups (34 studies); small-to-medium overall; **adults gain more than adolescents**; 98 % coverage is a guide, not a threshold (replications mixed)	[V]	The Drop, Deep Dive, Library in Daily 10	Texts/clips at ~95–98 % known words (flexible); every session has input; tracked words-read and minutes-listened per student
6	**Deliberate vocabulary learning in varied encounters**	Incidental learning from exposure alone is low (≈ 9–18 % of target words immediately, 6–17 % delayed); involvement-load model predicts depth (Yanagisawa & Webb 2021, 42 studies)	[V]	Word Lab, Remember?, Daily 10	Each target word/chunk is met, then retrieved, then **used** (need + search + evaluation: e.g. choose, fit and justify) in ≥ 3 skills within the Season
7	**Chunks and collocations**	Formulaic-sequence work (Wray, Boers)	[K] not re-checked	Word Lab, C1 register work	Teach whole phrases ("would you mind...", "make a point of...") as single items; collocation builders at B1+
8	**Corrective feedback**	Medium durable effect overall (Li 2010, 33 studies); prompts ≥ recasts in classrooms (Lyster & Saito 2010) [K]; written feedback small-to-moderate and better at higher proficiency (Kang & Han 2015); for lower levels direct correction may be better	[V] qualitative; effect sizes for prompts vs recasts not retrieved	Mission (Take 1 → feedback → Take 2), Mistake Bank	Feedback ladder: **nudge** (prompt/hint, student self-repairs) → **clue** → **direct fix** at A1–A2 writing. During fluency tasks the teacher **logs** errors and corrects after, not mid-flow
9	**Task planning and repetition**	One study: repetition ↑ fluency and accuracy, ↓ complexity; planning-for-repetition ↑ accuracy and complexity, ↓ fluency; planning alone no effect (D'Ely, Mota & Bygate 2019, n = 47)	[V] single study; 4/3/2 not checked	Mission: 60-s planning, Take 2	Offer *planning time* (optional, notes allowed) and a **Take 2** with a changed constraint. Treat the trade-offs as real: measure which helps each student

#	Technique	Evidence	Confidence	Where it lives	What exactly happens
10	**Perception-first pronunciation (HVPT)**	Multi-talker perception training: pre-post g ≈ 0.92, treatment-control g ≈ 0.67, retained; production transfer small-to-medium, weak retention (Uchihara, Karas & Thomson 2025, 79 studies)	[V]	Word Lab, Daily 10	Minimal-pair listening with **several recorded voices** (all standard American voices approved in `speechPolicy.ts`, per the voice rule; never browser TTS)
11	**Shadowing**	Narrative review of 44 studies: gains in listening, prosody, comprehensibility; segmental gains inconclusive	[V] no pooled effect	Daily 10 voice note, Echo the teacher	Used for **rhythm, stress and intonation**, not as the fix for sounds. Private record → compare → retry
12	**Dictation / decoding**	Dictogloss: small primary studies only; listening-strategy instruction d ≈ 0.69 (45 studies) as nearest evidence	[V] weak	Listening mechanics, Daily 10	Dictation and gapped transcripts as a *decoding* drill, plus explicit listening strategies; no strong claim
13	**Strategy instruction / self-regulation**	Strategy instruction d ≈ 0.49 (Plonsky 2011, 61 studies)	[V]; goal-setting/self-assessment effects not searched [U]	Wrap, can-do, Training-Wheels meter	Teach and name 1 strategy per Season (e.g. guess from context, plan-then-speak); learner sets a goal, rates a can-do before/after
14	**Anxiety reduction**	Anxiety–achievement r = −0.36 (Teimouri, Goetze & Plonsky 2019; 216 correlations, N ≈ 19,900)	[V]; correlational, intervention effect size not shown	Comfort dock, private rehearsal, Chill track	Low-stakes, private, retryable speaking; no visible timers; no public ranking
15	**Interaction and pushed output**	Output/interaction theory (Swain; Long); meta-analysis effect not retrieved	[K], effect [U]	Mission, info-gaps, Reverse Teacher	Negotiation of meaning in info-gap and role-play; teacher asks follow-ups (clarification requests)
16	**Cognitive-load design**	Mayer principles (coherence, contiguity, signalling, redundancy)	[V] secondary	Player layout	One task on stage; labels beside objects; no text+speech duplication
17	**Autonomy and relatedness (SDT)**	Gamification g ≈ 0.46 overall; badges/leaderboards raised interest, not performance (HK secondary study)	[V]	Choice of skin/mechanic, dial, Release	Choice and ownership, not rank
18	**Mediation (B1+)**	CEFR Companion Volume 2020	[V] it exists; descriptor wording [K]	Mission at B1+, C1 seminars	Relay, summarise, explain across viewpoints

3. Corrections this research forced on our earlier docs

- ❌ "Interleave: E7 mixes Seasons" as *interleaving of vocabulary*. ✅ Mixed review stays (spacing/retrieval), but new words are learned in blocks; only confusable grammar contrasts get interleaved. Updated in `academy-lesson-system.md` §2.2.
- ❌ Treating the 95–98 % coverage as a threshold. ✅ A guide ("about"), flexible per student.
- ❌ Shadowing as pronunciation fix. ✅ Prosody supplement; perception training with multiple voices is the supported route.
- ❌ Assuming prompts always beat recasts, or that written correction works the same at every level. ✅ Feedback ladder by level and mode (§2 row 8).
- ❌ Implying 4/3/2 fluency repetition is proven. ✅ Evidence is mixed (accuracy/fluency up, complexity can fall); we measure per student.
- ❌ In-session XP/stars as progress. ✅ Progress = delayed production evidence (§4).

4. How we observe that the student has *acquired* the knowledge

4.1 Knowledge items (the unit of observation)

Every word, chunk and structure is an **item** with: first seen · encounters by skill (read, heard, said, written) · retrieval history (date, mode, correct/incorrect, hints used) · current interval · state (**New → Learning → Known → Secure → Fading**) · last production sample.

- **Known** = correct production on ≥ 2 occasions on different days.
- **Secure** = correct production after a gap ≥ 21 days *and* used in a freer task (not only a drill).
- **Fading** = overdue or recently missed. States can fall.

4.2 Evidence the student, teacher and parent see

- **Per skill** (listening, reading, speaking, writing, plus vocabulary and grammar): Attempted → Familiar → Proficient → **Mastered only after a later mixed check**.
- **Retention score** each Remember?: "kept 7 of 9".
- **Delayed retest** items inside the checkpoint (not the practice items).
- **Production samples:** one speaking and one writing sample at the start and end of every Season, scored with a CEFR-aligned rubric (accuracy, range, fluency, coherence, interaction) and kept as the before/after portfolio.
- **Training-Wheels meter:** hints per session trending down.
- **Level claims** (A2, B1…) come only from a **separate placement/level test**, retaken every 2 Seasons [RT] and at each level boundary; never from XP.

4.3 What we deliberately do *not* use as evidence

Streak length, XP, same-session accuracy, time on task.

5. How we will test whether it works (pilot)

- **Design:** 5–10 students, one A1 Season (8 sessions), ages split 11–13 / 14–18, a mix of 1, 2 and 3 sessions a week.
- **Measures:** delayed retention (items at +7 and +21 days) · hints per session · talk-time share (`TalkTimeMeter`) · before/after speaking and writing rubric scores · enjoyment emoji · Daily-10 completion · teacher notes.

- **Within-student comparisons (small N):** for one technique at a time (e.g. Take 2 with vs without planning time; shadowing vs none), alternate across Seasons and compare delayed scores. Small samples → report patterns, not statistics.
- **Decide** from the data: keep, change or drop each technique; update this document.

6. Teacher protocol (for one-to-one)

- **Wait time:** 5–7 s before helping; then nudge, don't tell.
- **Talk time:** student ≥ 60 % at A1, ≥ 70 % at B1+, ≥ 75 % at C1.
- **Feedback ladder:** nudge → clue → direct; delayed correction during fluency tasks; always end an error on a success (retry until right).
- **Error log:** teacher taps errors into the Mistake Bank (item + type); the Daily 10 and next Remember? use them.
- **Never:** correct mid-sentence in a Take 1, rank the student against others, or force camera/voice.

7. Claims we will **not** make publicly

- That any single technique is proven for teenage L2 learners in a digital one-to-one player.
- That 95 % or 98 % coverage is a hard threshold.
- That prompts definitely beat recasts, or that written correction works at all levels.
- That interleaving helps vocabulary; that shadowing fixes sounds.
- That extensive-reading gains for teens equal adults'.
- That goal-setting/self-assessment raise scores (not verified here).
- Any number marked "secondary" until checked against the abstract.
- Any claim that the course delivers a CEFR level in a set time: guided hours are guidelines (Cambridge says so).

8. Items to verify before we publish anything

Exact figures for: Yang et al. 2021, the L2 spacing meta-analysis (citation unconfirmed), Mackey & Goo 2007, Thomson & Derwing 2015, Sakai & Moorman 2018, Zhang 2021, Boers/Wray on chunks, word-part instruction, delayed vs immediate feedback, the EEF "metacognition +7 months", and the English Grammar Profile / CEFR Companion Volume descriptors. Pull each from the original paper or official source.

9. Sources (search-surfaced)

Rowland 2014 (Psych Bull) · Yang et al. 2021 (Psych Bull), summary at learningscientists.org · Western Ontario spacing thesis ir.lib.uwo.ca/etd/8600 · Brunmair & Richter 2019 (PMC6813467) · Li 2010; Lyster & Saito 2010; Kang & Han 2015 (SSLA/Language Learning pages) · D'Ely, Mota & Bygate 2019 (degruyterbrill 10.1075/tblt.13.10del) · Uchihara, Karas & Thomson 2025 HVPT meta-analysis (SSLA, Cambridge) · Shadowing review (ora.ox.ac.uk) · Yanagisawa & Webb 2021 (SSLA); incidental vocabulary summary (todoele.net) · Plonsky 2011 (experts.nau.edu) · Teimouri et al. 2019 (experts.nau.edu) · Goo et al. 2015; Spada & Tomita 2010 · Nakanishi (Temple); Jeon & Day 2016 (nflrc.hawaii.edu/rfl/item/528) · Hu & Nation 2000; Schmitt, Jiang & Grabe 2011 (nflrc.hawaii.edu/rfl/item/43) · Soderstrom & Bjork 2015 · Cambridge guided learning hours (support.cambridgeenglish.org/hc/en-gb/articles/202838506) · Nation 2006 (wgtn.ac.nz PDF).

10. Corrections from the 2026-10-10 evidence pass (see `docs/academy-fast-progress-evidence-A.md` / `-B.md` and `docs/academy-effective-lesson-plan.md`)

- "Yanagisawa & Webb 2021 (SSLA, 42 studies)" mixes two papers: the involvement-load meta-analysis is *Language Learning* 71(2), 2021; the 42-study "ILH Plus" model is *SSLA* 44, 2022.
- The spacing meta-analysis is Kim & Webb (2022), *Language Learning* 72(1), 37 studies / 48 experiments. Yang et al. 2021 (*Psych. Bulletin*, 222 studies, g ≈ 0.50) is verified at abstract level.
- Tutoring: use **0.29 SD** (Nickow, Oreopoulos & Quan, AERJ 2023), not the 0.37 of the 2020 working paper; at scale effects are a third to a half of that (Kraft et al. 2024). Never cite Bloom's "2 sigma".
- No source supports the "8–12 encounters" rule, a talk-time percentage, "attention-span" segment lengths, the +1/+3/+7/+21 ladder as optimal, or a "10 minutes per grade" homework rule. They remain design assumptions, measured in the pilot.

Source: docs/academy-experience-design.md

Academy experience design — what is best for the student (expert decisions, 2026-10-14)

Owner (2026-10-14): "Be an expert of the Academy hub with all its rules and concepts and decide what is best for the student: context, environment, layout, everything. Use full scene plates in pages and in stories. I want creativity and fun, not repetition." (The last sentence of the owner's message was cut off; this page answers the whole brief.) Sources: the Academy rules (CLAUDE.md, `academy-season-system`, `academy-player-ux`, `academy-game-ui`), the Academy blueprints (`src/curriculum/academy/`), a read-only survey of the Playground curriculum and lesson blueprints (`docs/playground-lesson-blueprint.md`, `docs/a1-playground-roadmap.md`, `lessonVariety.ts`), and the web research in `docs/research/academy-lesson-sequencing.md` and `academy-a1s03-v2-research.md`. Hub separation holds: ideas are re-implemented in Academy files, never imported; nothing childish (no mascots, pets, stickers, hearts).

1. Who the student is and what they feel

A 13-18-year-old, alone with one teacher on a screen, who already met hello and numbers at school and is afraid of looking silly. They stay if the hour feels like a **series they are in** (a story, a place, a crew), they leave if it feels like a worksheet or **the same thing again**. So every lesson must give: a reason to care (a story question), a new place to be, a win within 90 seconds, a real choice, one surprise, and an exit on a high. No public ranking, no lives, no countdown; a wrong answer is named back kindly.

2. The arc of one 60-minute lesson (adapted from the Playground's 22-slide skeleton)

Moment	What the student feels	Design
Cold open (0-5)	"What happened?"	A story hook as a full scene plate or a phone message, not a form to fill in
Remember? (5-12)	"I know this" (a quick win)	Old language in a NEW mechanic and place (hunt, sort, chat), never the same game as before
The Drop (12-22)	"I'm inside the scene"	Story told as 3-5 full scene plates, then the scene becomes the game (Explore)
Notice & Build (22-32)	"Oh, I get the rule"	Model (I do) → the rule stated in 3 lines → two different games per word set
Energiser (32-36)	"My opinion counts"	Free practice with choice (Sort), zero stakes
Mission (36-48)	"I can do it"	Teacher model, Take 1, feedback, Take 2, in the story's place
Release (48-55)	"I made something"	A product (poster, voice note, card) the student owns
Wrap (55-60)	"I want the next episode"	Teach-back, can-do ticks, the next clue (a cliffhanger)
Micro-wins at least every 90 seconds; at least two real choices that need the target language; one surprise after the words are taught; a calm break every 8-10 minutes; rewards only for using English.		

3. Environment: full scene plates everywhere

- **Every page is a full-bleed scene plate** (a painted place), not a panel on a flat colour. The panel is glass and small; the place is the star.
- **Every story is a sequence of full scene plates** with the cast painted in (Canva, 16:9, cast references, ~35 % purple): 3-5 plates per story, one idea per plate, subtitles on the calm side, cross-fade only (never zoom or pan). Pictures come after a written scenario (`docs/scenarios/`).
- **A new place per lesson**: each lesson names its setting and look in a profile; the next lesson may not reuse them (fair at dusk, rooftop studio, night market, train platform, school roof, café…). A Season has a world with a signature palette and a recurring clue object (serial story), but each episode visits a new corner of it.
- **Time and weather change the mood** (dusk, rain, morning), so places never feel like the same room.

4. Layout (teens, laptop first)

Characters large and visible (never covered), the panel opposite the character, the strip and dock slim, the player always laid out left to right (lesson content is English). XP and combo as small pills; subtitles as film captions; one clear thing to do per screen; the comfort dock always there (hint, minute, easier, calm, sounds).

5. Variety is a gate, not a wish (adapted from the Playground's `lessonVariety.ts`)

Each Academy lesson registers a **profile**: settings (plates), look, story frame, signature game, game kinds. The deploy test fails when a lesson: repeats a setting or plate of the previous lesson, uses the same game kind three times in a row, has fewer than five distinct non-routine game kinds, or opens with the pattern the Season's first lessons used (badge-convo, brief card, who-said, border booth, padlock, find-the-wrong-line). Old lessons are listed as grandfathered until they are rebuilt.

6. What every lesson record carries (adapted from the Playground's per-lesson plans)

Objective ("I can…"), **signature game** (needs the new language to win), **fun hook** (a choice, a surprise, or the student-as-expert moment), **evidence** (what proves the can-do), **home mission**, story frame, setting. Source of truth is the plan; the deck follows the plan.

7. Adaptations from the Playground, ranked, and status

#	Idea (Playground source)	Academy version	Status
1	Painted scene per slide with cross-fade (`PlayWelcomeTownLesson`)	Plate cross-fade, full-scene pages	Built (2026-10-14)
2	Gems/hearts HUD and sound effects	XP + combo pill, synthesized sound bank, no hearts	Built
3	Story films as stills with cross-fades (`make-stills-film.py` , `FlipbookScene`)	Story slide: full scene plates, subtitles, spoken lines	Built; E1 uses it
4	Signature game per lesson, funHook	Fields on the plan; E1: Explore (the fair is the game)	Plan data in A1 S3
5	`LESSON_PROFILE` + variety gate	Academy profiles and gate	Built (A1 S3 and S1)
6	Research log with ≥3 sources and "better than"	Per-lesson research note (already required)	In place
7	Fog-of-war world map	Season path in the library (done / current / classified next)	Not built
8	Boss test and per-part 80 % result	Season checkpoint screen with per-skill bars and a retry pack	Not built
9	Collectible reward (stickers)	Season album of Word Cards (teen look)	Not built
10	Skinnable shell (quest skin)	Explorer 13-15 / Studio 16-18 token sets	Not built

Source: docs/academy-effective-lesson-plan.md

The effective, fast-progress Academy lesson plan (research-based proposal, 2026-10-10)

Owner request: "Look at the lesson blueprint. Research how to make the most effective lesson plan so Academy students benefit and progress fast." Evidence logs (read these for sources, numbers and caveats): `docs/research/academy-fast-progress-evidence-A.md` (vocabulary, retrieval, output, feedback, grammar) and `-B.md` (tutoring, dose, talk time, practice between lessons, motivation, assessment). Earlier layer: `docs/academy-learning-science.md` . **Verification limit:** the research tools could not open the papers (DNS errors); every number comes from search summaries and is tagged in the logs. Nothing here is a published claim. This is a plan, not a result: no study found tests teens in one-to-one online English lessons.

1. What the evidence says makes lessons work fast (and how sure we are)

#	Lever	What the evidence supports	Confidence
1	**Spaced retrieval with feedback**	Spacing beats massing for L2 vocabulary (Kim & Webb 2022, 37 studies; immediate g ≈ 0.76, feedback in practice ≈ 1.04); retrieval + feedback raises classroom achievement (Yang 2021, g ≈ 0.50, all subjects). Short gaps lose on delayed tests.	High for the principle; **medium** for our exact intervals (+1/+3/+7/+21 is an unvalidated assumption)
2	**Meaning first, then retrieval**	Picture + L1 gloss beats either alone on immediate tests (g ≈ 0.33); the edge shrinks later, pictures work mainly as retrieval cues.	Medium
3	**Deliberate teaching, then use**	Incidental pick-up alone is weak and varies a lot; involvement load only partly predicts gains; **there is no magic "8–12 encounters"**. Count varied uses across skills instead.	Medium
4	**Pushed output with the Take 1 → feedback → Take 2 loop**	Oral task repetition clearly raises accuracy and syntactic complexity, less so fluency (meta-analysis 2025); written repetition + feedback beats without. Effects are smaller in classrooms than labs.	Medium
5	**Specific corrective feedback**	Medium, durable effect (Li 2010); prompts ≥ recasts in classrooms (Lyster & Saito 2010); timing: no clear winner; show the correction on screen too.	Medium
6	**Explicit rule after noticing**	Explicit instruction beats implicit (Goo 2015, Spada & Tomita 2010). Nothing shows discovery-first is faster.	High for explicit; low for discovery-first
7	**Dose and structure of tutoring**	School tutoring ≈ 0.29 SD (Nickow et al. 2023, 89 RCTs); larger with ≥ 3 sessions a week and trained tutors; at scale about a third to a half of that (Kraft 2024). Bloom's "2 sigma" is not replicated: never cite it.	Medium-high for "frequency and structure matter"
8	**Hours**	Cambridge's guide is cumulative from zero: A2 ≈ 180–200 h, B1 ≈ 350–400 h (about 200 h per level). Guidelines, not promises; independent study is not counted.	Medium
9	**Practice between lessons**	Homework effects are small and mostly correlational; app practice looks good in meta-analyses but is biased and heterogeneous; streak claims are company data.	Low-medium
10	**Motivation by choice, not rank**	Gamification g ≈ 0.25–0.49 depending on outcome; leaderboards can hurt low-ranked learners; autonomy support helps.	Medium
11	**Low-stakes speaking**	Anxiety correlates with achievement (r ≈ −0.36), correlational only.	Medium (as a design reason)
12	**Feedback that informs, and delayed production evidence**	Feedback d ≈ 0.48 (heterogeneous); learning ≠ in-session performance.	Medium
Not supported (do not build on it): talk-time percentages, "attention span" segment lengths, "10 minutes per grade" homework, streak magic, "2x faster", "B1 in N weeks".			

2. Audit of the current blueprint against the evidence

Blueprint feature	Verdict	Change proposed
Run of show 5·7·10·10·4·12·7·5, Remember? first, Mission with Take 1 → feedback → Take 2, Release, Wrap	**Keep.** It already matches levers 1, 4, 5, 12.	Name the part of each part that carries the lever (see §3).
Remember? 7 min, production first, due items by calendar days	Keep.	Start with the student's **own error list** (Mistake Bank) before due items; every item answered gets feedback; log the delayed result per item (7 / 21 days). Treat intervals as a setting to tune from our own data.
The Drop = comprehensible input	Keep.	**Add modelling** (owner, 2026-10-10: "I see activities, not modelling or vocabulary"): in E2/E6 Drop show each new word with an animated picture, meaning, example and clue, and in E1/E3/E4 show the language **in use** by the cast with the frame highlighted *before* any game asks for it.
Notice & Build = noticing then ≤ 3-line rule	Keep.	Meaning cue at first meeting, **fade it in retrieval**; controlled practice with immediate feedback.
Mission 12 min, Take 2 in the same lesson	Keep.	Teacher prompts first (prompt → clue → direct fix; direct recast at A1); delayed feedback for free speaking; corrections shown on screen.

Blueprint feature	Verdict	Change proposed
Release 7 min private first	Keep.	Make it the **delayed-evidence sample**: model hidden; saved for the Season portfolio and the teacher.
Wrap 5 min	Keep.	End with the teacher's **error log** (3 recurring errors) → next lesson's Remember? list, plus the Daily 10 assignment.
14 new items per lesson, 8 lessons per Season, progressive stack	Keep the cap; **do not claim a magic number**	Measure retention per item; if Known-after-21-days is below target, reduce items, not hours.
Sessions per week 1, 2 or 3	**Weak point.** Dose and spacing are the strongest levers we control.	Recommend and sell a **rhythm of 2 lessons + Daily 10 on 5 days** per week; 1 per week is the minimum; 3 for fast-track.
Daily 10 (solo, 10 min)	Keep, but the evidence for homework is thin.	Make it retrieval-only and calendar-scheduled; no leaderboard; streak freezes; measure completion honestly.
Teacher-in-the-loop	Keep: tutoring works when structured and trained.	A short teacher script per lesson, a tutor-training checklist, and the plan drawer; check fidelity (did Take 2 happen? was feedback specific?).
Level checks / checkpoints	Keep.	Judge progress with delayed speaking/writing samples, not XP; compare the pilot with L2 effect-size norms (small ≈ 0.4, medium ≈ 0.7, large ≈ 1.0), not Cohen's defaults.

3. The effective lesson template (one 60-minute lesson)

Part	Min	Job (lever)	Student does	Deck slide types
Check-in	5	Safety + energy; 3 quick questions in English (11)	Picks a feeling, answers 2 easy questions, sees today's mission	`title`, `brief`, `badge`, `convo`
Remember?	7	Retrieval of last lesson, **production first, errors first, feedback on every item** (1, 12)	Re-builds last lesson's sentences, sorts who-says-what	`whosaid` (after a replay), `phonechat`, `memory`
The Drop	10	Meaning-first input and **modelling** (2, 3)	Meets each word with a moving picture, meaning, example, clue; watches the cast do the language with the pattern card	`teach`, `model`, one first-try game
Notice & Build	10	Controlled practice with immediate feedback; short rule (5, 6)	Plays: lockers, number train, padlock, spelling, passport control, conversation wheel	game slides, each tagged to a success criterion
Energiser	4	Attention reset, zero stakes (10)	A quick game	`memory`, `findwrong`
Mission	12	Pushed output: dial → Take 1 → feedback → Take 2 (4, 5)	Chooses help (Chill/Normal/Push), says it, gets specific feedback, says it again	`dial`, `say` (open), `fade`, `say`
Release	7	Delayed-evidence sample, model hidden, private first (12)	Fills the card, says everything from memory	`card`, `say` (hidden)
Wrap	5	Can-do ticks, error log, Daily 10 (11, 12)	Ticks honestly, sees the clue for next time	`wrap`
Rules for every lesson: one objective with 3–5 criteria; every game tagged to one; **nothing is asked that was not first shown (words taught, language modelled)**; no two neighbouring slides use the same game; every correct answer rewarded briefly, every wrong one answered with a specific hint; no ranking, no timers.				

4. How progress is measured (so we can say "fast" honestly)

1. **Item level:** each word/chunk New → Learning → Known (correct production on 2 days) → Secure (correct after ≥ 21 days in a freer task). Target to tune with data: ≥ 80 % of a lesson's items Known at +7 days.
2. **Skill level:** a short **delayed speaking sample** and a **writing sample** at the end of each Season (E8), rated with the CEFR-referenced rubric; compare with the sample at the Season's start.
3. **Behaviour:** lessons attended per week, Daily 10 days, hints used, Take 2 completed, error-log items fixed.
4. **Pilot design:** 20–30 students on the 2 + Daily-10 rhythm; pre/post speaking and vocabulary delayed tests; report effect sizes against L2 norms; share results only after that.

5. Honest claims

May say: lessons use spaced retrieval, specific feedback and a repeat-with-feedback loop, which are the best-supported techniques; one-to-one tutoring averages about 0.3 SD in school trials and works best when frequent and structured; Cambridge's guide is about 200 guided hours per CEFR level (our own arithmetic: A1 = 80 lessons ≈ 80 h plus about 30 h of Daily 10 over 40 weeks at 2 lessons a week). May not say: "2x faster", "2 sigma", "B1 in N weeks", any effect of gamification/streaks/anxiety features, any number from the evidence logs tagged [S2], [M] or [U].

6. Decisions for the owner (nothing below has been changed in code yet)

1. Adopt **"2 lessons + Daily 10" as the recommended rhythm** (1 per week minimum, 3 fast-track)? This changes sales copy and the roadmap pacing, not the lessons.
2. Add to the lesson blueprint: the **modelling requirement in The Drop**, the **error-log hand-off in Wrap**, and "Remember? starts with the student's own errors". (Edits to `lessonBlueprint.ts` and the skills; I will not touch them without your yes.)
3. Approve the **measurement + pilot plan** in §4.
4. Voices: modelling and listening activities need recorded teen voices (open item); the deck is silent until then.

7. Appendix: research and background

Source: docs/research/academy-b1-s01-research.md

Research — B1 Season 1 "Have You Ever...?" (present perfect: experience) and lesson 1 (Cold Open), 2026-10-15

Why now: a one-to-one A2 student asked to revise the **past simple, the present perfect and the three verb forms** (base, past simple, past participle). The roadmap puts the present perfect at B1, and the three forms are never taught as a set (see the search of the curriculum, 2026-10-15). Method: web search on 2026-10-15; mechanics, structure and sequencing only, **never content**. The search tool returned summaries, so each row says what was and was not verified. Nothing here is copied; the lesson text will be written fresh.

1. Level and grammar placement

Source	What was taken	Quality / limits	Status
Cambridge Grammar: present perfect simple and typical errors	Experience with no stated time; *ever* / *never* / *before* are the usual cues; common after superlatives ("the best ... I have ever made"); learners must not use the present simple or simple past for "time up to now".	Publisher reference grammar (British English); read through a search summary.	partly verified
Cambridge ELT blog: the present perfect in British and American English	American English uses the simple past more often where British English uses the present perfect for present relevance (*already, just, yet*). The Academy voices are **American**, so the lesson keeps to **experience with ever/never/been**, where both varieties use the present perfect, and leaves *just/already/yet* to B1 Season 4.	Publisher blog; short.	verified (summary)
English Grammar Profile / Pearson GSE	**Not found.** The search returned no English Profile page, so the exact B1 can-do wording for "present perfect: experience" is **unverified**. The roadmap's own note says "A2 late / B1; teach for production at B1" (`structureLevels.ts` , CEFR-J cross-check).	Open: check englishprofile.org and the GSE toolkit directly before the Season is called verified.	unverified

2. Activities and sequencing for "Have you ever...?" at B1

Source	What was taken	Quality / limits	Status
learnenglishfeelgood.com present perfect plans and eslbrains experiences lesson	Sequence: a free "have you ever" survey **before** any rule (students answer with past simple or present perfect, uncorrected); guided discovery (underline the verbs in a text, concept questions: "is the time known?"); a comparison table past simple (specific event, time stated) vs present perfect (experience, no time); follow-up questions in the past simple. This matches the roadmap's B1 method "task first, rule after".	Teacher-made plans for group classes; the one-to-one version is our adaptation.	partly verified
Teach-This: present perfect ever games, ESL Active	**Never Have I Ever** as a warm-up or review for present perfect with irregular participles; students write true statements about themselves. In one-to-one the "points for people who have done it" becomes a score kept by the student against their own best.	Teacher resource sites.	mechanic only
Twinkl "Liar, Liar, Pants on Fire", teens B1–B2	A teen game for the present perfect and past simple: say true or false experiences, the other asks follow-up questions in the past simple. = catalogue game 50, **Two Truths and a Lie**, used in later lessons of the Season (E4–E5), not in lesson 1.	Commercial; page read through a summary.	mechanic only

3. The three verb forms (the student's request)

Source	What was taken	Quality / limits	Status
Twinkl irregular verbs, past simple and participle card game and ESLprintables memory game	Memory/matching where the player says the base form and must give the other forms; the point for a pair is **earned by saying a sentence** with the verb; matching cards split in two, then the past halves removed and recalled from memory.	Printable resource sites; ideas for group play adapted to one-to-one on screen.	mechanic only
Lingbase irregular verbs and teacher guides grouped by pattern	Verbs are commonly taught **in groups by pattern**: all three forms the same (*cut*), past = participle (*make, meet, win*), past = infinitive-based vowel change (*sing, begin*), a -ght cluster (*bring, think*), and the "all different" set (*go–went–gone, see–saw–seen*).	**No controlled study** found that grouping beats other orders; the sources are teacher resources. We group because it makes the sorting task meaningful, and log the claim as practice, not proof.	unverified (practice)

4. Typical difficulties of our students' home languages (ar, es, fr, tr, it)

Source	What was taken	Quality / limits	Status
Almishwat 2023 (PhD, Arab learners), JLTR, Arab learners and the present perfect	Arabic has no direct equivalent: learners replace the present perfect with the simple past or present and lose the "up to now" meaning; the hardest English tense for the group.	Academic; strongest evidence of the five languages.	partly verified
Language transfer chart (Palomar College)	"Simple past used for present perfect" listed for Arabic, French, Italian, Spanish and Turkish (among others). French and Italian use a *compound past* for ordinary past events, so *I have seen him yesterday* is a likely error; Spanish has a present perfect, so form transfers well but the use with a stated time may over-extend.	A teaching chart, not a controlled study; **no dedicated French, Italian or Turkish study found**.	unverified for fr, it, tr

5. Games and video-game mechanics (the owner's rule: name both)

Source	What was taken	Quality / limits	Status
Gamification and motivation in language apps (INTI journal, 2024) and a survey of language-app users (via search summary)	Achievement features (badges, points, levels, tasks) were linked to inspiration and drive; a 10-week experiment found higher motivation and retention for a gamified version. We turn the Season's **bucket list into an achievement log** (a trophy for every verb trio and every "Have you ever" done).	Small studies, one journal with limited visibility; read through summaries; nothing on teens specifically.	partly verified
FlashBoss and boss-fight vocabulary apps (from the Pre-A1 research)	Forward/back steps on a track; used in the Season later (Remix).	Store listing.	mechanic only

Source	What was taken	Quality / limits	Status
`docs/academy-video-game-mechanics.md` and `docs/academy-games-catalog.md` (our own lists)	Loot and crafting, achievement/skill tree, stepping stones, tower defence, speedrun against your own best, detective board; catalogue 6 Picture Match Memory, 19 Grammar Detective, 44 Spot the Lie, 50 Two Truths and a Lie.	Seed lists, partly unverified.	—

6. Added to the lists (CLAUDE.md: extend with newly researched games)

- Catalogue: **Never Have I Ever** (present perfect warm-up, own best score) and **Verb Trio Memory** (say the base form, give the other two, earn the pair with a sentence).
- Video-game mechanics: **Achievement log / trophy case** (each completed task unlocks a named trophy that stays on the student's board).

What is NOT known

- The exact English Grammar Profile / GSE descriptor for this structure.
- Whether grouping verbs by pattern improves retention (practice, not proof).
- French, Italian and Turkish learner errors for the present perfect (chart only).
- The teen taste for achievement systems (no teen-specific source found): kept optional and private, never public.

7. Lesson-shape research for the rebuild (2026-10-15, owner: "research, use professionals' resources, the best structure: progressive, systematic, model → guided → free → production, 60 minutes")

Method: web search only (the container could not open the publishers' pages, so every row is from search summaries; nothing is copied). The owner also asked to "ask a professional teacher": **no human teacher was consulted**; the plan below rests on published teacher-training sources and must still be reviewed by a qualified teacher before it is called verified.

Source	What was taken	Quality / limits	Status
British Council TeachingEnglish, "Experiences" (B1, about 60 min, teens and adults)	A 60-minute B1 plan for exactly this problem: students confuse past simple and present perfect when they talk about past events.	Official publisher; the stage list was not readable through the search tool.	page exists; procedure unverified
Learning Corner and English Lesson Planner B1 present perfect plans; Fluentize "Have you ever"	Same shape in all three: context text, learners underline the verbs (guided discovery), concept-check questions ("is the time known?"), controlled choice present perfect vs past simple, then a speaking task with past-simple follow-ups.	Teacher-made plans; consistent with each other.	partly verified
Harmer's Engage-Study-Activate (overview, PPP vs ESA vs TBL)	Stages can be repeated and re-ordered; Study covers meaning, form, pronunciation; Activate is freer use. Sources say ESA is less useful above intermediate, where TBL-style use of existing language grows.	Practitioner summaries.	partly verified
Scrivener's ARC (Learning Teaching; summary)	Every teaching sequence mixes Authentic use, Restricted use (controlled practice) and Clarification and focus, in any order; a grammar lesson leans to clarification and restricted use, so we add authentic use before and after.	Summary of the book.	partly verified
Nation's four strands (Nation 1995 paper, Nation and Yamamoto 2012)	A balanced course has meaning-focused input (listening, reading), meaning-focused output (speaking, writing), language-focused learning (deliberate study of form) and fluency development, in roughly equal time. The "25 % each" figure comes from a secondary source only.	Primary author; the exact percentages are unconfirmed.	partly verified
Gradual release of responsibility (overview, phases)	Focused instruction (I do), guided instruction (we do), collaborative practice, independent practice; the shorthand "I do, we do, you do" skips the collaborative step; do not rush the transfer.	Practitioner sources; effect-size claims on those pages are not tied to this model, so we make no efficacy claim.	mechanic only
Cambridge CELTA frameworks (handouts)	Lead-in to context, then clarification of meaning, form and pronunciation, then controlled and freer practice, then feedback; frameworks are guidelines adapted to level, length and aim.	Training handouts, not the official syllabus.	unverified
Cambridge English Empower B1 (publisher descriptions)	Objectives stated at the start; core grammar and vocabulary input alongside skills; a speaking lesson combines functional language, pronunciation and conversation; each unit ends with consolidation and a communicative mixed-skills task (writing).	Retailer and publisher blurbs.	partly verified

Not found: the Pearson GSE descriptor for "present perfect: experience"; delayed error correction guidance (a standard teaching technique, kept from general practice, source not retrieved).

8. Added 2026-10-15: more compatible games (owner: "search the internet for suitable, compatible games")

Search summaries only (the container could not open the publisher pages); mechanics taken, never content.

Source	What was taken	Quality / limits
British Council TeachingEnglish, B1 "Experiences" lesson plan	past simple vs present perfect for older teens at B1; the experience → follow-up question pattern	summary only, activity detail unverified
British Council, "Find someone who" activity	present perfect for experiences as a "find someone who has..." task	for a one-to-one lesson it becomes *Two Truths and a Lie* with the teacher
Teach-This, present simple vs perfect games and ENG HUB, Never Have I Ever / speaking cards	guess-and-check pair game, "Never have I ever" speaking cards	classroom pair formats; adapted to teacher + student
Twinkl, Liar Liar Pants on Fire (teens B1–B2)	one invented sentence among true ones; follow-up questions in past simple	paid resource, only the idea used

Source	What was taken	Quality / limits
LearnEnglishFeelGood, present perfect experiences and Twee, past simple vs present perfect	sentence correction ("I has been to Japan")	worksheet only; made into a game below
Cambridge *Games for Grammar Practice* (via search summary)	truth-or-dare about life experiences for present perfect	book not opened

Decisions: new game **Glitch Hunt** (error correction as a bug hunt: find the glitch in a chat, repair it, hear the reason) and new speaking round **Two Truths and a Lie** (optional, Energiser). Limits: no human teacher consulted; the two new pages are untested with a real student.

Source: docs/research/academy-b1-new-seasons-research.md

Academy B1: two new Seasons (B1-S17, B1-S18) — research log, 2026-10-14

Method honesty: only WebSearch result summaries were read (WebFetch and many publisher sites do not open). Nothing below was read in full. Marks: [S] seen in a search summary; [K] general knowledge, no page checked; [U] unverified. Mechanics only, never content.

B1-S17 Click with Care (online safety; so/such ... that; reflexive pronouns)

Source	What we took (mechanic / scenario)	Quality / limits	Mark
https://www.britishcouncil.es/sites/default/files/british-council-be-safe-online-teens.pdf (LearnEnglish Teens poster "Be safe, be smart, have fun online")	Short tip-card format: privacy settings, passwords, telling a trusted adult. Becomes the Release shape (five tips with a reason).	Poster, not a lesson; not scam-specific. Supportive tone fits our safety rule.	[S]
https://test-english.com/reading/b1-b2/scamming-the-scammers-b1-english-reading-test/	B1+ reading with six comprehension questions about scam baiting: gist-then-detail reading for E5 Deep Dive.	Third-party site; topic idea only. Our text is original.	[S]
https://www.ncsc.gov.uk/pdfs/information/cyberflix.pdf and NCSC CyberFirst video	Choose-your-path scenario: each choice leads to a safer or riskier result (dialogue-tree mechanic for E4).	Aimed at ages 11-14 in the UK; mechanic only.	[S]
https://test-english.com/explanation/b1/so-such-such-a-so-much-so-many/ and https://learnenglish.britishcouncil.org/grammar/b1-b2-grammar/so-such	so + adjective + that (cause and result); such (a) + noun + that; "that" is often dropped in speech. Confirms B1 treatment.	Explanations only; a summary said one lesson plan labels so/such ... that as B1. CEFR-J (checked earlier, see structureLevels) lists so ADJ that and such at B1.	[S] / CEFR-J [V]
Reflexive pronouns (myself ... themselves, by myself, enjoy yourself)	Taught from the open CEFR-J list (B1.1); no extra web page checked.	Placement from the CEFR-J grammar profile only.	[K] / CEFR-J

Games (no game three lessons in a row): E1 Detective Board (cat. section 10) · E2 Pac-Collect (#154, safe vs risky words) · E3 Tile Stacker (#152, build "so ... that" sentences) · E4 Dialogue Tree (choose a safe reply) · E5 Escape Room (spot the fake clues) · E6 Charades with Photos (#162, reflexive actions, Side Quest in the student's skin) · E7 Boss Fight remix · E8 Finale. Video-game mechanic: Stealth (quiet path): pick the careful reply to pass the "scammer guard" (docs/academy-video-game-mechanics.md). E8 six-strand checkpoint idea: Listening (voicemail from a "bank": scam or real?) · Reading (short article, so/such result sentences) · Speaking (warn a friend with so ... that) · Writing (three-tip guide) · Language (so/such, reflexives) · Mediation (explain the tips of a text to a friend). Safety note: supportive, practical, non-graphic; no real-brand scams, no instructions for hacking.

B1-S18 First Paycheck (money and first jobs; enough/too ... to; (a) few / (a) little)

Source	What we took (mechanic / scenario)	Quality / limits	Mark
https://www.fosteringsuccessmichigan.com/uploads/resources/Learning-to-Budget.pdf	Teen with a first job and limited money sorts needs vs wants and estimates monthly costs; basis of the budget Release.	Life-skills material (1 h 15), not ESL; adapt for language.	[S]
https://eslprintables.com/printable.asp?id=204088 style "budget busters" worksheet (ages 13-17, advanced)	Read about money habits, answer questions, then build your own budget (read-then-produce sequence for E5).	Teacher-uploaded; quality varies; page not opened.	[S]
https://www.consumer.gov/sites/www.consumer.gov/files/articles/pdf/pdf-1032-lp_making_a_budget.pdf (US FTC)	Vocabulary list plus guided practice in making a budget for low-intermediate learners (income, expense, save).	Adult audience; American usage matches our American English rule.	[S]
https://twee.com/esl-lesson-plans/money	B1 "Saving Money" 60-minute reading and speaking plan: confirms level of the topic.	Adult plan, commercial site.	[S]
enough / too ... to; a few / a little	No ready-made teen "enough/too" worksheet was found, so our sentences are original. Level notes: CEFR-J enough with adjectives B2.1 / EGP B1-C1; "(a) few / (a) little" EGP B1-B2 (from the repo's earlier source check).	few-little marked unverified in structures/b1.ts.	CEFR-J [V] / [U]

Games: E1 Shop / Trading Sim (management sim row) · E2 Memory Pairs (#158) · E3 Space Defender (#155, shoot the right "enough/too" form) · E4 Role-play: job call and shop (Dialogue Tree) · E5 Snakes and Ladders Quest (#164, money choices) · E6 Whack-a-Word (#151, few vs little) · E7 Speedrun vs own best · E8 Finale (budget presentation). Video-game mechanic: Shop / trading sim with a limited wallet: every purchase must fit the weekly budget (docs/academy-video-game-mechanics.md). E8 six-strand checkpoint idea (also the B1 level check): Listening (job-call details) · Reading (job advert) · Speaking (explain my budget) · Writing (budget note with reasons) · Language (enough/too ... to, few/little + B1 mix) · Mediation (pass on a job advert to a friend). Safety note: no gambling, no loans or investing advice for teens beyond saving basics; the word "invest" is not used.

Source: docs/research/academy-curriculum-benchmarks.md

Academy curriculum benchmarks (2026-10-14)

Research only. Rule: take mechanics and structure, never content (CLAUDE.md). Nothing in `src/` was changed.

0. How this was verified (read first)

- **Page fetching was blocked.** Every `WebFetch` to cambridge.org, oup.com, pearson.com, britishcouncil.org, wikipedia.org failed (`getaddrinfo ENOTFOUND` ; `curl` gets `CONNECT 403` from the egress proxy). So **no page was verified by fetching it**, which is what the brief asked for.
- **What was done instead:** `WebSearch` returned result lists with publisher/retailer titles and URLs plus a summary of what the engine saw. Marks used below:
- **[S]** = supported by a search result from an official publisher or exam-board page (title and URL seen, summary read). Not a fetched page. Re-check before quoting.
- **[S-3rd]** = supported only by retailer, review or comparison sites (some affiliate). Weak.
- **[U]** = not found; the search said so, or it is from our own docs or memory.
- Where a figure is missing, it says "not found" and is not guessed.
- To upgrade to verified: open the URL in a browser and read the scope and sequence of one level of each course. Owner action, about 1 hour.

1. Benchmark table (10 programmes)

#	Programme (audience)	Unit / lesson length	Units per level	Teen topics	Skills balance	Review cadence	Assessment cadence	Mechanic worth adapting	Mark
1	**Cambridge Empower 2nd ed.** (adult and young adult; A1-C1, 6 levels)	Each unit = 4 lessons A, B, C, D; **C = "everyday English"** (functional speaking); each unit ends with a consolidation of core language	B1 book lists 12 units; B2 book lists 10; not uniform; no all-level source found	Adult/young-adult, general	Four skills plus a separate functional-language lesson	Consolidation at the end of every unit	End-of-unit tests, mid- and end-of-course tests, **personalised CEFR test report**	Dedicated "everyday English" lesson per unit that turns the unit grammar into real exchanges	[S] Cambridge catalogue, Cambridge Spain page
2	**Cambridge Prepare! 2nd ed.** (teens; 9 levels A1-C1; exam path)	Unit length not found	Brochure: 9 levels, "20 units" (unclear if per level), **70-160 hours** per level	Teen / school	Four skills plus exam skills (Speaking, Writing)	Practice Extra, Test & Train banks	**Two books per exam**: levels 2, 4, 6, 8 are "towards the exam" and add real exam tasks gradually	**Gradual exam on-ramp**: exam task types introduced a few at a time, then a full "towards" level	[S] Prepare page, brochure
3	**Oxford Solutions 3rd ed.** (teens; Elementary-Advanced)	Intermediate SB: intro unit plus **9 topic units of 8 lessons each**	9 units plus an intro revision unit (Intermediate)	Teen, with **9 Culture lessons**	Four skills, Culture lesson per unit, exam skills	Workbook: 9 Unit Reviews with "I can..." lines and **cumulative reviews after units 1, 3, 5, 7, 9**	**Exam Skills Trainer sections (5 plus 2 B2 trainers)** inside the Student's Book	Cumulative review **every 2 units**, a Culture lesson linked to the unit topic, and "I can" self-checks	[S] OUP catalogue, Intermediate WB
4	**NatGeo Life 2nd ed.** (young adult/adult; 6 levels)	Unit lesson count not found	Probably 12 per level (split editions A: units 1-6, B: units 7-12)	General, "My Life" personalisation, critical thinking syllabus	Integrated four skills; critical thinking	"Memory Booster" activities	Not found	**"My Life" personalisation spot** and a Memory Booster retrieval task per unit	[S-3rd] publisher sample PDF, Cornelsen
5	**Pearson Speakout 3rd ed.** (adult; A1-B2+, 8 levels, GSE-based)	Unit and lesson length not found	Not found	General, employability from A2	Strong pronunciation strand with recording tool; **A1 has separate Sounds and Spelling lessons**; **mediation / employability skills from A2**	A motivating spread at the end of each unit (type not confirmed)	Not found	**Sounds and Spelling lesson** at A1; recording tool for pronunciation	[S-3rd] A1 SB listing, A2+ listing
6	**Pearson GSE / GSE Teacher Toolkit** (framework and database)	n/a	n/a	Filters for young learners (6-14), adults, academic, professional; **no teen set listed**	Scale 10-90 per skill (listening, reading, speaking, writing); mediation not listed	n/a	Psychometric scale aligned to CEFR	**Per-skill numeric level**: a student can be 35 in speaking and 28 in writing. Launch counts (2016): >1,600 learning objectives, >300 grammar objectives, 36,000 vocabulary items	[S] GSE educators, Toolkit, Pearson note

#	Programme (audience)	Unit / lesson length	Units per level	Teen topics	Skills balance	Review cadence	Assessment cadence	Mechanic worth adapting	Mark
7	**British Council LearnEnglish Teens** (free, self-study, 13-17)	Short standalone items (not a sequenced course)	No levels as units; content tagged by CEFR	Magazine topics (fashion, brain, finance and banking, old age…), a `topics/` index	Separate Listening / Reading / Writing / Speaking sections	Vocabulary games, level test	**Online level test**; **Exams section** with reading, writing, listening, speaking, grammar and vocabulary exam pages and exam study tips	Topic **magazine** layer on top of a skills layer; exam study tips as a short lesson type	[S] Teens site (nav pages seen in search)
8	**Duolingo (English course)** (self-study app)	Short lessons (length not found)	Sections map roughly to CEFR; Units within; one fan wiki says 4 sections, 175 units (**unverified**)	General	Mostly reading/listening/translation-free tasks; blog says B1-B2 units use no translation	Built-in repetition ("Daily Refresh")	Section-end checks (details not found)	Section → Unit hierarchy with CEFR band per section and **no L1 translation at B1-B2**	[S] Duolingo blog; [S-3rd] fan wiki
9	**Busuu** (self-study app, CEFR A1-B2)	Not found	Not found	Everyday topics (groceries, transport)	Sequence: vocabulary intro, grammar explanation, practice, then a **speaking or writing task**	**Smart Review** resurfaces weak words (sorted weak / medium / strong)	CEFR level tests (not detailed)	Speaking/writing task at the end of each unit, **with community feedback**	[S-3rd] learnenglish.life review, comparison
10	**Preply / italki / Cambly** (one-to-one marketplaces)	Cambly lessons 15-60 min (competitor-hosted source)	No fixed units	Tutor's choice: conversation, grammar, business, **exam prep (TOEFL, IELTS)**	Tutor-led; Cambly = conversational fluency	Not defined (tutor decides)	Preply: assessment-based personalised curriculum; italki: none standard	**Goal-picked track at sign-up** (conversation / grammar / exam) and an initial assessment that sets the plan. No standard lesson template found, which is **our edge**	[S-3rd] comparison
11	**Kinnu** (general-knowledge microlearning, not English)	~10 min "Orb" (few paragraphs plus questions)	30-session courses	n/a	Read then multiple-choice	**Memory Shield** spaced repetition returns weak cards a few sessions later	Question after every Orb, cannot be skipped	**One small unit a day** (about 10 min) plus automatic spaced return of weak cards: the Daily 10 pattern	[S-3rd] WhistleOut, Legal Cheek
ref	**Cambridge English guided learning hours**	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	Cumulative from zero: **C1 700-800, B2 500-600, B1 350-400** seen in the table via search; A2 180-200 from secondary sites; "guideline only", depends on background, intensity, age, out-of-class exposure	[S] Cambridge English helpdesk

Not found for any programme (state this plainly to the owner): lesson length in minutes for the coursebooks (they assume a ~45-90 min class slot, not stated in sources seen), mediation as a named strand in Empower / Solutions / Life, and the exact unit count for Prepare, Speakout and Life.

2. Patterns across the benchmarks

1. **A unit has 4-8 lessons and one productive end-task.** Empower 4 lessons plus consolidation; Solutions 8 lessons. Our Season = 8 sessions plus a Release matches Solutions' length. [S]
2. **Cumulative review every 2 units** (Solutions units 1, 3, 5, 7, 9). We already do "Big Remix every 2nd Season". Match confirmed. [S]
3. **Functional-language lesson in every unit** (Empower lesson C "everyday English"). Our E4 On Air does this. Match. [S]
4. **Teen courses carry an exam on-ramp** (Prepare "towards the exam" levels; Solutions Exam Skills Trainers; LearnEnglish Teens Exams section; italki exam prep). We have none. **Gap.** [S]
5. **A culture or "school world" lesson per unit** (Solutions 9 Culture lessons). We have Side Quest (E6) "cultural" as an option only. Partial. [S]
6. **Self-assessment "I can" at the end of every unit** (Solutions Unit Review). We have it in Wrap. Match. [S]

7. **Per-skill levels** (GSE 10-90 per skill, Empower personalised CEFR report). We plan "per-skill levels" in diagnostics but the roadmap is one linear ladder. Partial. [S]
8. **Pronunciation as its own strand** (Speakout recording tool; A1 Sounds and Spelling lessons). We have a pronunciation focus per Season. Partial: no dedicated Sound lesson or recording-based check. [S-3rd]
9. **Mediation appears from A2** in Speakout's employability skills; CEFR Companion Volume treats it as a mode. We place it at B2 (S15) and C1 (S13) only. Late. [S-3rd]
10. **Self-study apps use a spaced-return of weak items** (Busuu Smart Review, Kinnu Memory Shield). We have Remember? plus Daily 10. Match. [S-3rd]

3. Our design today (from `docs/academy-lesson-system.md` and `docs/academy-roadmap-v2.md`)

- Level → Season (= unit, 8 sessions) → Episode (= 60-min Live Session). E1 Cold Open, E2 Word Lab, E3 Pattern Lab, E4 On Air, E5 Deep Dive, E6 Side Quest, E7 Remix (zero new language), E8 Finale (zero new language, Release, checkpoint).
- 70 Seasons / 560 sessions: A1 10 (80), A2 12 (96), B1 16 (128), B2 16 (128), C1 16 (128).
- Cumulative live hours by level: A1 80, A2 176, B1 304, B2 432, C1 560.

4. Hours versus Cambridge guided learning hours

Cambridge figures are cumulative from zero, [S] for B1, B2, C1; A2 from secondary sources; A1 ~90-100 is our own **[U]** figure (not seen).

Level	Our cumulative live hours	Cambridge cumulative	Shortfall of live hours	With Daily 10 at ~10 min x 5 days per week x 8 sessions/4 weeks
A1	80	~90-100 [U]	10-20	Daily 10 closes it
A2	176	180-200	4-24	closes it
B1	304	350-400	46-96	roughly closes
B2	432	500-600	68-168	**does not clearly close**
C1	560	700-800	140-240	**does not close**

Notes: - Our own doc already admits it relies on "~120 h" of Daily 10 and calls this an **assumption** (`academy-lesson-system.md` §4.1). Daily 10 is solo and light, and Cambridge's guided hours count teacher-guided time, so a straight swap is generous. - One-to-one gives far more speaking per hour than a class of 15-25, which is a real offset, but no source seen quantifies it. Keep it labelled as an assumption. - Per-level sizing is fine at A1-B1. The problem is the top: B2 is ~14-30% short and C1 is ~20-30% short of the Cambridge guide. - Vocabulary check: our cumulative budget of 5,452 items at C1 versus Oxford 5000 distinct headwords of 4,979 (our own doc, 2026-10-08) is consistent.

5. Concrete gaps and recommendations

Ordered by impact. None change the 8-episode shape.

G1. No exam preparation or "school English" bridge (highest)

- Every teen course seen has it (Prepare, Solutions Exam Skills Trainers, LearnEnglish Teens Exams, italki exam prep). A parent of a 13-18 student will ask: "Will this help at school and for Cambridge or IELTS?" Our roadmap has zero mention (`grep` of "exam|IELTS|KET|PET" in the lesson-system finds only a level check).
- Recommend: an **Exam Lane** as optional E6 Side Quests (not new Seasons): at A2 (A2 Key for Schools tasks), B1 (B1 Preliminary for Schools), B2 (B2 First for Schools), C1 (C1 Advanced). Use Prepare's pattern: introduce task types a few at a time, then a "towards the exam" Season at the end of the level. Write original task types in our own words (task formats are public; content is not copied).
- Add a **"School English" bridge** at A1-B1: reading a textbook instruction line, understanding a teacher's classroom language, writing a short school email, presentations in class. Our A1 doc says Academy students "already met hello, numbers and countries at school", so name what school did **not** teach and what school **does** test (spelling, reading comprehension, written grammar).

G2. Hours at B2 and C1 fall short of Cambridge

- Options (owner choice): (a) add 1 Season per level at B2 and C1 (+8 sessions each, to 440 and 136 per level); (b) publish a Season 17+ "Extension" bank; (c) keep 128 and state honestly to families that B2/C1 need extra independent study. Option (c) is cheapest and already half-said in our doc.
- Whatever is chosen, **say it on the parent page**: the "guideline only" caveat is part of Cambridge's own text.

G3. Topics teens expect that the Seasons do not name

- Seen in LearnEnglish Teens topics: **fashion, brain, finance and banking, old age** [S]. Compare our B1-C1 titles: they are mostly grammar-led ("Passive Power", "Cut the Words", "Rarely Do We...") with a thin topic story.
- Missing or weak (check each against the cast and "My World" skins before adding): **money and part-time work / first job** (A2 has Dream Jobs only), **social media, privacy and online safety** (A1-S01 profiles, B1-S11 Learning Machines only), **mental health, stress and sleep** (A2-S05 is illness only), **environment and climate**, **friendship, dating and peer pressure**, **identity, belonging and cultural difference** (B1-S15 only), **exams, study skills and future plans (university, gap year)**, **sport and e-sports as spectator culture** (skins only), **news literacy and fake news** (C1-S03 sources), **volunteering and community**.
- Recommend: use the **skins** and Side Quests as the topic carrier at B2/C1, and add a "topic gaps" check to `academy-quality-gate` so each level covers at least 8 of these 10 areas somewhere in a Season or Side Quest bank. Safety rules still apply (no sensitive personal disclosure in a Mission).

G4. Mediation starts too late

- CEFR Companion Volume (2020) makes mediation a mode alongside reception, production and interaction (from memory **[U]**, not re-checked). Speakout brings it in at A2 [S-3rd]. We schedule it first at B2 (B2-S15) and C1 (S13).
- Recommend: add a **tiny mediation task** from A2 (relay a short message, "tell Theo what Ava said") as a Mission variant in E4 or E6. This is cheap and already named in our support ladder (B2 "relay/summarise").

G5. Pronunciation has a focus per Season but no dedicated Sound lesson or recorded check

- Speakout A1 has separate Sounds and Spelling lessons and a recording tool [S-3rd].
- Recommend: a recurring 5-minute **Sound Lab** inside E2 (already "Pronunciation") with a **record-and-compare** step, and a **mid-level pronunciation checkpoint** (accent policy: intelligible, standard American voice models only, per CLAUDE.md voice rules).

G6. Single linear ladder versus per-skill levels

- GSE gives each skill its own number [S]. Our roadmap is one linear ladder. Diagnostics already plan per-skill levels (skill `academy-learner-diagnostics`).
- Recommend: placement returns **four numbers** (listening, reading, speaking, writing) and the Season recommendation uses the lowest two. Needed so a student strong in listening (gamers) but weak in writing is not bored or lost.

G7. Assessment cadence is thinner than coursebooks

- Coursebooks: end-of-unit tests, mid- and end-of-course tests, a personalised CEFR report [S]. Ours: E8 checkpoint per Season plus a **level check** at only the last Season of each level.
- Recommend: keep E8 checkpoint (low stakes), add a **mid-level check** (after Season 8 at B1-C1) and a **parent-facing CEFR progress report** each level (Empower pattern).

G8. Culture strand

- Solutions has a Culture lesson per unit [S]. We have none required.
- Recommend: one **Culture Clip** per Season as a E5/E6 option (original script, our cast; no third-party content).

Already matching (keep)

- Big Remix every 2nd Season (Solutions cumulative reviews) [S].
- Zero-new-language review and finale sessions (E7, E8) with a make-something Release.
- "I can" self-check in Wrap (Solutions) [S].
- Daily 10 spaced return (Kinnu / Busuu patterns) [S-3rd].
- Goal-led personalisation through skins (marketplace goal tracks) [S-3rd].

6. Top 5 mechanics to adapt (our wording, not their content)

1. **Exam on-ramp in steps** (Prepare): 2 or 3 task types per Season, a "towards" Season at level end. Gap G1.
2. **Cumulative "I can" review every 2 units** (Solutions): we already have the shape; add the printable "I can" list for parents.
3. **Everyday-English lesson per unit** (Empower lesson C): E4 On Air stays; check it ends in a real exchange, not a drill.
4. **Per-skill numbers** (GSE): placement and the parent report. Gap G6.
5. **One tiny unit a day with automatic return of weak items** (Kinnu): Daily 10 already; make the "return" visible to the student ("3 words came back today").

7. Open checks for the owner (not done in this pass)

- Fetch and read the scope and sequence of one level of Empower, Solutions and Prepare (blocked here).
- Re-check the CEFR Companion Volume mediation scales at coe.int and the A2 and A1 guided-hour figures (A1 ~90-100 is **[U]**).
- Decide G2 (hours) and G1 (exam lane) first: both change what the parent page may promise.

8. Source list

- https://www.cambridge.org/us/cambridgeenglish/catalog/adult-courses/empower-2nd-edition [S]
- https://www.cambridge.es/en/catalogue/adults/courses/empower2ed [S]
- https://www.cambridge.org/prepare [S]
- https://www.cambridge.org/sites/default/files/media/documents/Prepare_brochure_update_Dec_2021_web.pdf [S]
- https://elt.oup.com/catalogue/items/global/teenagers/solutions_third_edition/ [S]
- https://elt.oup.com/catalogue/items/global/teenagers/solutions_third_edition/solutions_third_edition_intermediate/9780194504522?cc=global&selLanguage=en&mode=hub [S]
- https://www.eltngl.com:443/assets/downloads/life2e_pro0000009032/ame/LFE_SMP_AmE-2E_9781305986275_web.pdf [S-3rd]
- https://cornelsen.de/reihen/life-550001290000/second-edition-550001290002 [S-3rd]
- https://nyelvkonyvbolt.hu/en/shop/books-for-language-learning/language-learning/speakout-3rd-edition-a1-students-book-and-ebook-with-online-practice [S-3rd]
- https://www.pearson.com/english/about/gse/learning-objectives.html [S]
- https://www.pearsoncanadaschool.com/literacy/products/the-global-scale-of-english/gse-teacher-toolkit.html [S]
- https://www.pearson.com.hk/en_GB/about-us/news/20161129.html [S]
- https://learnenglishteens.britishcouncil.org/grammar/be/term [S]
- https://blog.duolingo.com/how-duolingo-teaches-english [S]
- https://duolingo.fandom.com/wiki/Intermediate_English [S-3rd, unverified count]
- https://learnenglish.life/reviews/busuu/ and https://www.learnenglish.life/compare/duolingo-vs-busuu/ [S-3rd, affiliate]
- https://learnenglish.life/compare/cambly-vs-italki-vs-preply/ [S-3rd, affiliate]
- https://www.whistleout.ca/CellPhones/Guides/kinnu-learning-app and https://www.legalcheek.com/?p=231265 [S-3rd]
- https://support.cambridgeenglish.org/hc/en-gb/articles/202838506-Guided-learning-hours [S]
- Our docs: `docs/academy-lesson-system.md`, `docs/academy-roadmap-v2.md`

Source: docs/research/academy-teen-games.md

Games that suit the Academy hub — research, 2026-10-05

The Academy is its own hub, not a grown-up Playground: - **Cast** (`cast_vault_characters` , hub = academy): **Vee**, the mentor (16–19, direct, upbeat, "treats mistakes as normal"); **Ava** (13–15, curious, asks lots of questions), **Theo** (13–15, easygoing, a good listener) and **Mia** (13–15), the recurring conversation leads. Semi-realistic illustrated teens in everyday clothes, **not mascots**. - **Blueprint** (`supabase/functions/_shared/prompts/academy.ts` , `hubProfiles.ts`): task-based teaching (TBLT), A1 → B1 (optional B2). Every lesson ends in a **real communicative task** done with a peer, with at least one **unscripted speaking turn**. Six phases, 20–25 slides. Component whitelist: `intro` , `vocab_card` , `reading_passage` , `comprehension_mcq` , `fill_blank` , `matching_pairs` , `grammar_form_card` , `controlled_drill` , `roleplay_dialogue` , `info_gap` , `task_outcome` , `homework_task` , `celebration` . - **Banned**: Pip or any childish mascot voice, tracing and phonics drills, sticker/reward language, nursery chants, essays. Tone: smart, peer-respecting, never childish, never preachy; PG-13 school-safe topics. - **Curricula in the database**: *A1 Academy — Foundational Teen English* (Personal Identity & Online Profiles, My Room & Gadgets, Free Time & Hobbies, Food & Cafes, Clothes & Shopping …) and *Jungle Survival: Teen Expedition* (B1: storms, rescue and retreat, emergencies …). Lesson types: core, storybook, extra practice, unit review / boss test.

What the research says about teen game design

Finding	Source
Game-based learning has a **moderate–large effect** on cognitive, motivational and engagement outcomes. Gamification works on average, but results depend on design.	Sailer & Homner, *The Gamification of Learning: a Meta-analysis* (2020); DGBLL meta-analysis (Univ. of Hawai'i)
Kahoot!/Quizizz-style games raise participation and peer collaboration, but **over-reliance on competition creates anxiety** for some learners.	Systematic review of gamified EFL motivation (2025); Frontiers in Psychology (2022)
Adolescents benefit from **competition and peer recognition, clear goals, real-time feedback and adaptive difficulty**. Unlike children, they handle **complex mechanics: quests, group statistics, strategy**.	*One Size Doesn't Fit All: Age-Aware Gamification Mechanics* (arXiv 2512.15630, 2025)
Public leaderboards can stress adolescents, increase social comparison and discourage lower performers. Points/badges drive short-term participation but can **shift motivation from interest to rewards** unless they also support **autonomy** (self-determination theory).	Systematic review, *Heliyon* (2023); Sailer et al., *Computers in Human Behavior* (2017); meta-analysis on gamification and intrinsic motivation (2024)
Autonomy (choices, control of pace) increases investment and persistence.	*Exploring Gameful Motivation of Autonomous Learners* (PMC, 2022)
High-schoolers prefer **strategy** (Gimkit: earn in-game currency for correct answers, spend it on upgrades; rewards sustained accuracy, not one fast round). Cartoon collectibles (Blooket's "Blooks") read as **"kid stuff" by about 14**. Middle-schoolers are split.	Ditch That Textbook comparison; TriviaMaker; Screenwise; student poll (HHS Journalism, 2025)
Games that involve **mystery, creativity and a bit of bluffing** are hits with teens: 20 Questions, mystery role-play with secret roles, escape rooms, Desert-Island ranking (agree on 5 of 20 items and justify), Shark Tank pitches.	Twinkl *35 Speaking Games for ESL Teens*; ESL Info; TEFL Lemon
Game worlds teens already know (**Minecraft**, Among Us, Roblox) raise vocabulary scores and lower boredom (a Minecraft group improved about 72% pre→post; 80%+ less bored).	ResearchGate / ERIC studies on Minecraft vocabulary (2021); TESL-EJ
Exam formats teens will meet: **A2 Key for Schools** speaking in pairs; **B1 Preliminary for Schools** Speaking Part 3, a collaborative decision task (suggest, agree, disagree politely, justify).	Cambridge English handbooks

Design rules for Academy games

1. **Teens, not kids.** Use the Academy cast and teen settings (phones, group chats, profiles, gadgets, sport, cafés, the expedition). No mascots, stickers, cartoon collectibles or sing-song voices.
2. **Strategy and accuracy over reaction speed.** Reward streaks and good decisions; timers are optional and generous, never the core.
3. **Compete in teams or against your own best.** Show personal bests and team or class goals. **No public individual leaderboard by default** (the `leaderboard_event` game should show only the top few teams or a personal rank).
4. **Choice everywhere (autonomy).** Pick a path, a difficulty or a hint ("spend 20 coins for a hint"); optional challenges.
5. **Every game ends in language use (TBLT).** The game sets up the task outcome: a decision, a message, a voice note, a role-play.
6. **Mystery, deduction and a bit of bluffing** beat quizzes in costumes.
7. **Mistakes are normal** (Vee's trait): instant, specific feedback, a retry, no shame.
8. **Peer interaction**: info gaps and pair tasks, because the exam and the blueprint both require it.

Recommended Academy games (mapped to the whitelist and units)

Game	How it plays	Whitelist type	Fits
Profile Detective	Three fake social profiles (Ava, Theo, Mia). Ask yes/no questions ("Is she 14?", "Does he like gaming?") to find whose profile it is. Deduction, with questions as the language.	`info_gap` + `task_outcome`	A1 U1 Online Profiles
Group-Chat Fix	A phone-style group chat between Ava and Theo with 4–5 grammar slips; spot and fix them for streak points.	`controlled_drill` / `fill_blank`	any grammar lesson
Choose Your Path episode	A short branching story with Vee; each choice needs reading or grammar understanding, and choices change the ending.	`reading_passage` + `comprehension_mcq`	storybook lessons, Jungle Survival
Coin Strategy Quiz (Gimkit-style)	Correct answers earn Academy coins (the existing `academy_coin_ledger`); spend them on a hint, a 50/50 or a shield. Individual, but goal-based or team pot, not a public ranking.	review / `matching_pairs`	unit review / boss test
Survival Ranking	Pairs choose 5 of 12 items for the expedition and must suggest, agree, disagree politely and justify (B1 Speaking Part 3).	`roleplay_dialogue` → `task_outcome`	Jungle Survival

Game	How it plays	Whitelist type	Fits
Two Truths and a Lie (voice note)	Record 3 sentences about yourself; the partner or class guesses the lie and asks follow-up questions.	`task_outcome`	A1 U1, hobbies, past tense
Café Order Sim	A menu, a budget and a friend's order; order by voice or text and get the bill right.	`roleplay_dialogue`	A1 Food & Cafes
Escape room (existing `escape_room_slot`)	Keep it; one puzzle type per door, played as a team, with a generous or optional timer.	review	unit review
Secret Role mystery	Each student gets a secret role card (for example, "you lost your phone") and talks in character; the others work it out.	`info_gap`	B1
Daily 5-letter word (Wordle-like)	A private streak on lesson vocabulary, as homework.	`homework_task`	all units

Audit of what the Academy can show today (`src/arcade/gameRegistry.ts`)

- **Good fits**: `roleplay_mission`, `fluency_round`, `story_continuation`, `team_mission`, `coop_challenge`, `grammar_boss`, `sentence_builder`, `timeline_race`, `memory_quest`, `matching_pairs`.
- **Fix**: `leaderboard_event` and `classroom_battle` should rank **teams or personal bests**, not single students. `spelling_race` and the vocab-games `WordRush` should get an **accuracy mode** (no clock).
- **Consider**: `debate_battle` is Success-only today; a **mini-debate** (B1, pairs, two minutes, sentence starters) suits the upper Academy.
- **Already correct**: Playground-only phonics and alphabet games (`phonics_challenge`, `alphabet_*`, `song_chant`) are not offered to the Academy.

Sources

- The Gamification of Learning: a Meta-analysis (Springer)
- Digital game-based language learning: a meta-analysis (Univ. of Hawai'i)
- A systematic review of gamified learning motivation for English language (ResearchGate)
- Frontiers in Psychology (2022) — game-based language learning
- Exploring Gameful Motivation of Autonomous Learners (PMC)
- One Size Doesn't Fit All: Age-Aware Gamification Mechanics (arXiv)
- The role of gamified learning strategies in students' motivation in high school and higher education (ScienceDirect)
- How gamification motivates: game design elements and psychological need satisfaction (ScienceDirect)
- Gamification enhances intrinsic motivation, autonomy and relatedness: meta-analysis (ResearchGate)
- Game show classroom: Kahoot, Quizizz, Quizlet Live, Blooket, Gimkit (Ditch That Textbook)
- Blooket vs Gimkit vs Kahoot (TriviaMaker)
- Blooket alternatives for high schoolers (Screenwise)
- What do students prefer, Gimkit or Blooket? (HHS Journalism)
- 35 Speaking Games for ESL Teens (Twinkl)
- 23 Best ESL Speaking Activities for Teens (ESL Info)
- ESL speaking activities for teens and adults (TEFL Lemon)
- The Effect of Minecraft on Students' English Vocabulary Mastery (ResearchGate)
- Using Minecraft for Learning English (TESL-EJ)
- A2 Key for Schools exam format (Cambridge English)
- B1 Preliminary for Schools exam format (Cambridge English)

Source: docs/research/academy-memory-games-list.md

Academy: matching and memory games for vocabulary — candidate list (2026-10-12)

Owner request: search the internet for different matching games that improve student memory and prepare a list. Use with the vocabulary rule (two different memorising games after every vocabulary introduction, `docs/academy-lesson-system.md` §2.1c).

Sources and honest limits

- Web search 2026-10-12. Memory/concentration variations: Games to Learn English: Concentration, ESOL Courses memory games, ESL Activity: top 5 memory games, The ESL Teacher Life: matching games, TEFL Institute: ESL games. Wordwall template families: Wordwall features (confirms Match, Quiz, Crossword, Maze Chase, Airplane; the page did not list the other templates I searched for).
- Evidence: spaced retrieval beats restudy for foreign vocabulary in the lab studies found (e.g. a Swahili-English study, UTA thesis), but only when learners already have enough prior repetitions to succeed, and the retrieval advantage depends on task design (Educational Psychology Review, 2023 experiments). More active recall is better than recognition [secondary summary]. A 2026 Kahoot! blog claims big gains from game-based vocabulary study — vendor source, treated as promotional. **No source found compares matching games with recall games directly.** Consequence: a matching game is a good FIRST step (recognition, safe, success-first); it must be followed later by production (say it, type it) — which the Remember? part and the Mission already do.
- Items marked [general] come from the repo catalogue (`docs/academy-games-catalog.md`) or general teaching practice, not from this search.

The list (A = already in the player, N = new to build)

#	Game	How it works (comfort-first, no timer, no ranking)	Trains	Status
1	Drag-match (picture ↔ word)	drag the word onto the scattered picture	meaning	A (`match`)
2	Listen-and-pick	hear the word, tap its picture	sound → meaning	A (`match` listen)
3	Flip memory (picture ↔ word)	flip two cards, hear the word	meaning + place memory	A (`memory`)
4	Flip memory, sound pairs	match words that share a sound (cat–hat) [ESOL Courses, Concentration]	phonics	N
5	Sentence halves	flip/drag two halves to rebuild a sentence [ESL Teacher Life]	grammar + vocab	N
6	Word ↔ meaning ↔ example (triples)	find THREE linked cards: word, picture, example sentence [irregular-verb triple variant, ESOL Courses]	depth of knowledge	N
7	Category sort	drop items into labelled baskets (feelings, countries, classroom words) [ESL Teacher Life]	grouping, recall by category	N
8	Shadow match	match a picture to its silhouette	visual discrimination	A (`shadow` , sticker pictures only)
9	Odd one out	tap the word that does not belong and say why [catalogue #3]	categories	N (catalogue)
10	Kim's game (what is missing?)	look at 6 pictures, cover, one disappears; say or pick which [general]	short-term memory, recall	N
11	Snap / spot the match	two pictures change slowly; tap when picture and word agree, calm speed [general]	recognition speed (optional, no timer pressure)	N
12	First-letter match	picture ↔ its first letter for beginners [ESOL Courses]	letter-sound	N
13	Spelling rebuild	drag letter tiles to build the word under its picture [general]	spelling	A (`spell`)
14	Missing-word cloze	tap the word that fits a sentence gap [Wordwall-style]	use in context	N
15	Hidden-object hunt	find the words in a scene [catalogue]	meaning in context	A (`hunt` , homework)
16	Pelmanism with a twist: "memory then say"	after a pair is found the student says the word (private record, optional)	production	N
17	Word-wall recall (Memory Palace)	walk through last lesson's scene; tap objects to name them [catalogue #100]	spaced retrieval	N (catalogue)
18	Tile-matching review	clear word and meaning tiles, calm, no timer [catalogue #98]	review	N (catalogue)
19	Connections	group 16 words into 4 hidden groups [catalogue]	categories, B1+	N (catalogue)
20	Dictation match	hear a sentence, drag the words in order [general]	listening + spelling	A (`build`)

Suggested next picks (cheap to build, high value)

1. **Category sort (7)** — new mechanic, very different from the two games we use; works for every word set.
2. **Kim's game (10)** — a different memory skill (recall without cues) and good for the Energiser.
3. **Triples (6)** — deeper than pairs: word + picture + example.
4. **Sound pairs (4)** — links to the pronunciation focus of each Season.

Rule of thumb for the two games after a word set: first game = recognition (1, 2, 3), second game = a different kind (7, 10, 6, 14) so memory is trained two ways.

Source: docs/academy-level-ladder.md

Academy level ladder: Pre-A1, level, Upper (proposal, 2026-10-12)

Owner question: can every level have a "pre", the level, and an "upper" step (pre-A1, A1, A1 upper, ...)? **Status: proposal. Nothing in the roadmap code is changed.**

1. What the research says (and does not)

- The CEFR Companion Volume (2020) adds **Pre-A1** and defines **plus levels**: the descriptors distinguish "criterion levels" (A2) from "plus levels" (A2+, also written A2.2); the official plus levels are **A2+, B1+, B2+**. I found **no official A1+ or C1+**; they are used by publishers but are not Council of Europe levels (CoE Companion Volume, TEFL Today guide).
- Publishers already work with finer steps: Pearson's Global Scale of English (10-90) splits CEFR levels into narrow bands and its course books overlap neighbouring levels (for example Level 1 = Pre-A1/A1, GSE 19-29; Level 2 = A1/A2, GSE 27-34) (Pearson mapping booklets). Ranges overlap, so a step is a guide, not a hard wall.
- Cambridge's guided-learning-hour guide is cumulative from a complete beginner: about A1 90-100, A2 180-200, B1 350-400, B2 500-600, C1 700-800 hours; Cambridge publishes **no Pre-A1 hour figure**, and says these are guidelines (Cambridge helpdesk).
- Not found: a source that recommends a "pre / level / upper" triple for every level, or any evidence that students learn better with that labelling. This is a design choice, not a research finding.

2. The catch: "Pre-B1" is the same place as "A2 Upper"

A "pre" step of every level overlaps the "upper" step of the level before it (Pre-A2 = A1 upper). Keeping both would put two names on one stage. So the clean ladder has **one Pre (at the start) and an Upper for every level**:

Step	CEFR meaning	Label we show
1	Pre-A1 (official)	Pre-A1
2	A1	A1
3	A1+ (not official, ours)	A1 Upper
4	A2	A2
5	A2+ (official)	A2 Upper
6	B1	B1
7	B1+ (official)	B1 Upper
8	B2	B2
9	B2+ (official)	B2 Upper
10	C1	C1
11	C1+ (not official, ours)	C1 Upper

"Upper" means the bridge: the student can do the level's tasks and starts the next level's. The label shows the CEFR level plus our word; we never claim an exam level from it. Level claims still come only from the separate level test (project rule).

3. Sizes: split the existing seasons, add only Pre-A1

The roadmap today has A1 10, A2 12, B1 16, B2 16, C1 16 Seasons (70 Seasons, 560 sessions of 8 per Season). Splitting each level in two halves keeps the totals; only Pre-A1 is new (6 Seasons, 48 sessions, see `docs/academy-pre-a1-curriculum.md`).

Step	Seasons	Sessions	Cumulative sessions
Pre-A1	6 (new)	48	48
A1	6	48	96
A1 Upper	4	32	128
A2	6	48	176
A2 Upper	6	48	224
B1	8	64	288
B1 Upper	8	64	352
B2	8	64	416
B2 Upper	8	64	480
C1	8	64	544
C1 Upper	8	64	608

Sanity check against Cambridge's cumulative hours (1 session = 1 hour of live lesson; the Daily 10 adds roughly 10 minutes a day on top): end of A1 Upper 128 (A1 90-100, A2 starts later: fine, slower on purpose for teens), end of A2 Upper 224 (A2 180-200), end of B1 Upper 352 (B1 350-400), end of B2 Upper 480 (B2 500-600, slightly under), end of C1 Upper 608 (C1 700-800, under by about 100; the Daily 10 and extensive reading make up part of it). Treat as rough.

4. What would change in the code

- `AcademyLevel` gets `'Pre-A1'`; every Season gets a `stage: 'core' | 'upper'` (Pre-A1 has only core).
- Level checks: a short **step check** at the end of each Upper step; the full level test stays at the end of the Upper step of each CEFR level.
- The library groups by CEFR level with two tabs inside (core / upper); Pre-A1 first.
- Tests that assert 70 Seasons / 560 sessions are updated to 76 / 608; the lesson blueprint's level-specific supports (hints, speed, speaking ladder) get an "upper" setting that fades the supports a little further than the core step.
- Season sizes: A1 Upper is 4 Seasons (not 5) because A1 is 10 Seasons; this keeps the existing A1 Seasons as they are.

5. Scale: the platform is growing (research and measurements, 2026-10-12)

What other platforms do (limited, from search): Lingoda covers A1-C1 with CEFR labels and a certificate after each 50 classes (Lingoda); Novakid uses its own age-appropriate level names aligned to CEFR and covers Pre-A1 to B1 for children (Novakid); Pearson's Global Scale of English keeps a fine numeric scale (10-90) and maps course books onto it, with free learning objectives per audience (young learners, adult, professional) (Pearson GSE); Duolingo maps its test score bands to CEFR with an outside validation (Duolingo). Could not confirm: EF level details, Duolingo course unit counts. Licence note: the CEFR can-do statements belong to the Council of Europe (permission needed to republish), so our can-dos must be our own wording.

What our own repo says about growth (measured today): | Risk | Today | At 608 lessons | Advice | |---|---|---|---| | **Lesson production** | 3 hand-built deck lessons, each took many review rounds | 600+ lessons cannot be hand-built | build the map for all steps, but produce lessons in slices (Pre-A1 + A1 first); make a lesson mostly **data**: season spec → deck generator using episode templates + the game menu + lanes, then human review and the quality gate | | **Audio files** | 427 clips = 13 MB in `public/academy-audio/` (in git) | roughly 80,000+ clips, about 2-3 GB | move audio to object storage / CDN (not git); **one manifest per lesson**, loaded on demand (today `manifest.json` is one file loaded whole by `loadManifest`) | | **Roadmap in code** | 1,220 lines of TS in `levels/*.ts`, tests that assert 70 Seasons / 560 sessions | levels are hard-coded and every change breaks totals | one **ordered step list** with stable ids; tests check invariants (ordered, no gaps, every step has Seasons), not totals; later move the roadmap to data/DB | | **Lesson registry** | hand-listed `ACADEMY_DECK_LESSONS` | hundreds of entries | generate the registry from lesson files / DB; library already groups level → season → lesson | | **Choice overload** | 5 level tabs | 11 steps | students see a simple label ("A1", "A1 Upper") and the next lesson; the full ladder is for teachers/creators | | **Placement** | none yet | 11 steps cannot be told apart by a 5-minute test (Busuu's placement is about 5 minutes, Busuu) | placement picks the CEFR level; the step inside it comes from the first lessons (lane + results) |

Two different axes, do not mix them: the **ladder** says where the student is in the curriculum (Pre-A1 … C1 Upper); the **lane** (Start / Core / Stretch) says how hard one lesson is for this student today.

6. My recommendation

1. **Yes to the ladder, as one Pre-A1 and an Upper for every level** (not a Pre for every level; it duplicates the previous Upper). Show the CEFR label plus "Upper"; call A1 Upper and C1 Upper ours, never an exam claim.
2. **Make it data, not code, now** (cheap, and it is what lets the platform grow): an ordered step list with stable ids (`pre-a1`, `a1`, `a1-upper`, …) and display labels in one file; roadmap tests check invariants instead of 70 / 560.
3. **Build in slices, level by level, as you said:** Pre-A1 and A1 first (96 sessions of Seasons, with A1 Upper outlined); leave A2 and above as outlines until A1 has real students and data. Do not decide the A2+ splits now.
4. **Fix the scaling risks before the lesson count grows:** audio out of git and manifests per lesson (do this before Pre-A1 lessons are baked); a lesson generator for the repeated episode shapes.
5. **Placement and lanes:** keep lanes inside lessons; add a short placement later, to choose the CEFR level only.

7. Decisions needed

1. Approve the ladder (one Pre-A1, then core + Upper for every level)?
2. Approve doing the data-driven step list first (small change, no content), then Pre-A1?
3. Approve moving audio out of git and splitting manifests per lesson before more voices are baked?

Source: docs/academy-lesson-system.md

Academy lesson system — "Seasons" (one-on-one, 60 min, ages 13–18, A1 → C1)

Status: **proposal for owner approval** (2026-10-08). Nothing here is built yet. It extends `docs/research/academy-lesson-design.md` (evidence base), `docs/academy-learning-science.md` (**the scientific techniques, how each is built in, and how we measure acquisition**) and `docs/research/academy-teen-games.md` (teen game rules). Evidence labels: **[V]** seen in a source this session · **[K]** established literature/knowledge, re-check before quoting · **[RT]** rule of thumb · **[U]** unverified. Web fetching was mostly blocked, so many items are from search summaries.

Design brief (from the owner): lessons are **one-on-one, live, 60 minutes**; the **student's comfort is the top priority**; units are **themed**; lessons are **fun**; the student must **actually acquire English** and **feel** their progress; the player layout must suit teen taste.

---

1. The idea in one page

> **Every unit is a *Season*. Every lesson is an *Episode*. Every 60 minutes is a *Live Session* in which the student is the lead, not the audience.**

Four things make it ours (and four are borrowed from evidence, not invented):

1. **A themed story world per Season** (cast: Vee, Ava, Theo, Mia). One *clue* per episode is unlocked only by *using* the target language ("language is the key", like the existing `expedition_game`). The Finale solves the story with the student's own language.
2. **"My World" skins.** The language spine of an episode is fixed; the *topic skin* (football, gaming, music, anime, art, tech, animals, food, travel…) is chosen by the student. Personalisation and choice raise motivation and learning (Cordova & Lepper 1996) [K].
3. **Make-something Seasons.** Every Season ends with a *Release*: something the student **makes in English** and keeps (profile card + voice intro, recorded vlog script, café menu + order role-play, podcast episode, comic…). All Releases build a private **portfolio**: the "before/after" evidence of real acquisition.
4. **The student is the expert.** One segment per session flips roles: the teacher plays a clueless friend/alien/new classmate and the *student* explains, corrects the teacher's planted mistakes, or runs the game (protégé/teaching effect [K]).

Borrowed from evidence: noticing before rules; retrieval and spacing between sessions; choice (autonomy); low-stakes private speaking (see the evidence doc).

Honest status. The Season System is an *original synthesis*; no study tests it as a whole. Pilot with 5–10 learners and judge it with the measures in §9 before scaling.

---

2. Progression pattern (the same shape at every level)

2.1 Season = 8 Live Sessions

Ep	Name	Purpose	Main skill	New language?
E1	**Cold Open**	Hook + context text/dialogue; gist only	Listening / Reading (receptive)	Seen, not produced
E2	**Word Lab**	The Season's words (≤ 14) + sounds/stress	Vocabulary, Pronunciation	Yes — words
E3	**Pattern Lab**	Notice → pattern → ≤ 3-line rule → controlled use	Grammar	Yes — 1 structure
E4	**On Air**	Real-life exchange built from E2+E3 (functional language)	Speaking / Listening	Chunks only
E5	**Deep Dive**	Longer graded text/clip + a short written piece with rewrite	Reading / Writing	Few
E6	**Side Quest**	Student's pick: fluency, creative or cultural task; second structure (if any)	Integrated, high choice	Light
E7	**Remix**	Consolidation + boss round mixing this Season with earlier ones	All (retrieval)	**None**
E8	**Finale**	Peer task (≥ 1 unscripted turn) + Release + mixed checkpoint	Speaking / Writing	**None**

Rules: new vocabulary in E2 and E6 only; new structure in E3 and E6 only; E7–E8 are **zero new language**. Every 2nd Season, E7 is a **Big Remix** (cumulative, covers two Seasons). Matches coursebook practice: a productive end-of-unit task and a cumulative review every 2 units [V: Solutions, Roadmap].

2.1a The cast (owner rule, 2026-10-08)

Lessons use only the **Academy characters from the cast vault** (`cast_vault_characters`, hub = academy): **Vee** (mentor, 16–19 presenting; direct, upbeat, treats mistakes as normal), **Ava** (13–15; warm, curious, asks lots of questions), **Theo** (13–15; easygoing, friendly, a good listener) and **Mia** (13–15; a friendly student; her personality is empty in the vault). Nobody else speaks. Every Season hook features at least one of them, Vee appears in every lesson as the mentor voice, and each lesson blueprint names who plays which part (`cast` in `lessonBlueprint.ts`, roles in `cast.ts`). Open items for the owner: define Mia's traits, and set voices (none of the four has a `voice_id`; voices must be the approved recorded American voices).

2.1b The unit is a progressive stack (owner rule, 2026-10-08)

Inside every Season each lesson **adds to everything before it**: lesson 1 teaches something; lesson 2 = lesson 1 + lesson 2; lesson 3 = lessons 1 and 2 + lesson 3; and so on up to the Finale, which integrates all seven earlier lessons with no new language. Practically: Remember? revisits every earlier lesson of the unit (not only the last), the Mission and the Release must use language from all earlier lessons, and input texts use at least 95 % words already met. It is written into every lesson blueprint as `buildsOn` (earlier lesson ids, items known before and after, structures known before and after, the stack label, what must be reused) and enforced by `lessonBlueprint.test.ts`.

2.1c Vocabulary rule (owner rule, 2026-10-12)

After **every** vocabulary introduction (each teach page set) the student plays **two different memorising games** before anything new is taught: e.g. a drag-match and a flip-memory with pictures, or a number game (Locker Pop, Number Train) and a flip-memory. It is `VOCAB_GAMES_RULE` / `vocabGames` in `lessonBlueprint.ts`, a `mustHave` line of The Drop and of Notice & Build, and a player test. **Every lesson plan chooses its two games from the menu** (`VOCAB_GAME_MENU` in `src/curriculum/academy/vocabGames.ts`, 20 games, research in `docs/research/academy-memory-games-list.md`): the first is a

recognise game, the second a *deepen* game, different games, both suited to the level. Each blueprint carries `vocabGames.menu` and three `suggested` picks (`suggestVocabGames` , rotating by lesson number); the plan may swap any pick for another menu game (`validateVocabGamePicks` checks it). Games marked `planned` must be built in the lesson player before a lesson uses them. Budget about 2 minutes per word set; if a lesson then no longer fits the hour, split the lesson (fewer word sets each) instead of dropping the games.

2.2 Spiral across Seasons

- **Recycle:** each Season's E1 re-uses ~30 % of words from the previous two Seasons, so every target word meets ≥ 8–10 varied encounters across skills [K/RT]. 20–30 % new language per lesson [RT, from research].
- **Mix for retrieval, not for learning new words:** E7 and the *Daily 10* (§6) mix everything that is due (spacing + retrieval). New vocabulary is learned in blocks (interleaving worked *against* word learning, g = −0.39 [V]); only confusable grammar contrasts are interleaved, after each is learned alone. See `academy-learning-science.md` §2–3.
- **Dial down the supports ("training wheels").** Support fades by level and the student *sees* it:

Support	A1	A2	B1	B2
First-language hint button	on	on, tiered	on request	off (dictionary only)
Sentence starters	full frames	half frames	first words	none (optional)
Audio speed	0.8× available	0.9×	natural	natural + accents
Speaking ladder ceiling	repeat → substitute → answer → ask	exchange → extend	spontaneous 2 min	spontaneous 3–5 min + opinion defence
Teacher talk time target	≤ 40 %	≤ 35 %	≤ 30 %	≤ 25 %
Method in the Mission	notice → practise → produce	notice → practise → task	task → focus on form → repeat task	task-led; mediation (summarise/relay)

The student's **Training-Wheels meter** (hints used per session trending down) is an honest progress signal.

C1 shape adjustments (same 8 episodes, different weight): supports all off by default; E3 *Pattern Lab* becomes **Language Lab** (notice register, collocation and stance in an authentic text); E4 *On Air* becomes a seminar / pitch / interview; E5 *Deep Dive* uses long authentic texts and a 250–300-word piece with feedback on **precision and register**; every Season has **mediation** work (summarise, relay, mediate viewpoints) and ≥ 1 extensive-reading/listening target for the Daily 10. This also addresses the B2 "plateau" (suggested remedies: extensive reading just below level, collocation/chunk noticing, feedback on precision [V, weak sources]).

---

3. The 60-minute Live Session ("run of show")

Fixed order so the student always knows where they are; the *mechanics* inside change every session (Variety Rule: ≤ 2 same-kind in a row; ≥ 12 distinct mechanics per Season; ≥ 1 new or upgraded mechanic per Season).

Min	Segment	What happens	Comfort / fun lever
0–5	**Check-in**	The student picks how they feel with pictures and answers 2–3 quick questions (a picture choice or one short sentence). Today's mission and its success criteria are shown. The teacher adapts the plan.	Soft landing; spontaneous speaking with zero stakes
5–12	**Remember?**	Starts with the student's **own error list** from the last lesson (Mistake Bank), then the due items. 8–12 items, ≥ 60 % production, feedback after every item. Last lesson's language is *shown again* before it is asked. Each result is dated (delayed checks at about 7 and 21 days).	Competing only against yourself; mistakes go to the Mistake Bank, not shame
12–22	**The Drop**	**Meaning first, then modelling.** Every new word is met on its own page (moving picture, meaning, example, clue) before any game uses it; the cast then **model** the target language in use, line by line, with the pattern card (the frame stays, the changing part is coloured). A quick understanding check; the student picks 1 of 2 skins. Nothing is asked that was not shown.	Surprise (variable reward) + autonomy
22–32	**Notice & Build**	Controlled practice with immediate feedback; every game trains one named criterion. Rule (if any) ≤ 3 lines, after examples. Beginners can **choose answers by picture**, not only by reading; the meaning cue fades in later retrieval. No two neighbouring games of the same kind.	Choice of mechanic (2 offered)
32–36	**Energiser**	4-min break-the-pattern game (Wordle-style, Would-you-rather, lightning round, music), no ranking, no timer, still uses the target language	Attention reset; pure fun, no scoring pressure
36–48	**Mission**	The communicative task. The student picks **Chill / Normal / Push**; **Take 1** → specific feedback (prompt, clue, direct fix; a direct recast at A1; shown on screen as well as said) → **Take 2** in the same lesson. The teacher logs up to 3 recurring errors.	**Difficulty dial** — student chooses; "Need a minute" always available
48–55	**Release**	The exit task with the **model hidden** (shown only on "Show me", which is counted). Private first, then saved to the portfolio as the **delayed-evidence sample**; it reuses language from all earlier lessons of the unit.	Ownership; private-before-public
55–60	**Wrap**	"I can..." ticks tied to the criteria (yes / almost / not yet), **the error log** (up to 3 recurring errors → the start of the next lesson's Remember?), Best Line of the Session, the Daily 10 assigned for calendar days, the next clue	End on a win

Source of truth in code: `RUN_OF_SHOW` in `src/curriculum/academy/lessonBlueprint.ts` (each part's `mustHave`). Evidence and reasoning: `docs/academy-effective-lesson-plan.md` .

Recommended rhythm (guideline, never a promise of a level by a date): 2 lessons a week plus the Daily 10 on 5 days (`RECOMMENDED_RHYTHM`); 1 lesson a week is the minimum, 3 is fast-track. Cambridge's guide is about 200 guided hours per CEFR level, cumulative from zero; independent study is not counted.

Core vs flex. *Core (51 min, never skipped):* Remember? 7, Drop 10, Notice & Build 10, Mission 12, Release 7, Wrap 5. *Flex (9 min, teacher's call):* Check-in 5 and Energiser 4; Take 2 and extra practice also flex inside the core segments. If the student is tired (shown by the drawn face they picked at Check-in) the teacher swaps the Mission for the **Chill track** (lower-pressure game, same target language) — no student ever "fails" a session.

Fun ingredients (use ≥ 5 per session): surprise Drop · student-chosen skin · story clue · teacher-as-clueless-friend flip · a make-something Release · humour (absurd scenarios, "weird but true") · a boss moment (Remix/Finale) · collectable *Word Cards* (private deck, teen idiom — **not** stickers/mascots,

per the Academy prompt ban) · music/Song Take · live reactions/emoji · a running in-joke across the Season.

---

4. Roadmap A1 → B2 (sizing and sequence)

4.1 Sizing (data-informed; verify before publishing)

Level	Cumulative guided hours (Cambridge)	Cumulative words (target)	Seasons	Live sessions (60 min)	New words/Season
A1	~90–100 [K]	~800	10	80	80
A2	180–200 [V]	~1,650	12	96	69
B1	350–400 [V]	~2,750	16	128	75
B2	500–600 [V]	~4,050	16	128	80
C1	700–800 [V]	~5,400 (Oxford 5000 adds ~2,000 B2/C1 words to the 3000 [V]; C1 ≈ 5–6k word families, provisional [V])	16	128	~84 items (words + collocations; the per-session cap of 14 allows at most 84)
Total			**70**	**560**	

- **Reconciling with the hours data.** Cambridge's cumulative guided hours imply roughly 95 / 95 / 180 / 175 new 60-min lessons per level (≈ 545 to B2) [V for the hours]. This plan schedules **432 live sessions** and relies on ~120 h of *Daily 10* self-practice to close the gap. That trade is an **assumption**: one-to-one gives far more speaking per hour, but there is no hard data on how many fewer hours it needs, so do not cut the budget silently. **Alternative if the owner prefers to follow the hours strictly** (C1 adds ~200 hours, 700–800 cumulative [V]): A1 12, A2 12, B1 22, B2 22, C1 25 Seasons (≈ 744 sessions); the Season shape does not change.
- Guided hours are class hours, not guarantees, and depend on age, intensity, background and out-of-class study (Cambridge).
- Pace (sessions per week varies by family: 1, 2 or 3): A1→C1 (560 sessions) takes ≈ 10.8 / 5.4 / 3.6 years in a 52-week year (add ~10 % for holidays); A1→B2 (432) ≈ 8.3 / 4.2 / 2.8. **Tell families this honestly.** Reaching C1 inside the teen years needs ≥ 2 sessions a week from about age 12, or a start higher up the roadmap after placement. The teacher dashboard shows each student's own estimated finish date.
- Vocabulary supports: ~2–3k word families give ~95 % coverage of spoken text; 98 % needs 6–7k spoken / 8–9k written families (Nation 2006, van Zeeland & Schmitt) [V]. B2 ≈ 4k words is *enough to follow most speech*, not enough for academic reading — say so.
- Per Season: 1–2 structures, ≤ 14 new items per session (Academy's own cap), 8 sessions; roughly 60 % of new words productive, the rest receptive.
- **Calibrated against the public Oxford 3000/5000 lists by CEFR level (2026-10-08, downloaded for analysis only, not stored in the repo).** Distinct headwords: A1 901 · A2 799 · B1 699 · B2 600 (the Oxford 3000 totals 2,999) · plus the Oxford 5000 extras B2 698 · C1 1,282 (total 4,979). Cumulative: A1 901, A2 1,700, B1 2,399, B2 3,697, C1 4,979. The first draft targets for A1/A2 (700 / 1,500) were below these, so they were raised to 800 / 1,650 (closed-class function words are taught through grammar and not counted). B1+ targets sit above the Oxford counts because our items also count chunks and collocations. Whether the Oxford lists may be stored in the repo is a licensing question for the owner; until then the roadmap holds budgets and lexical fields, not item lists.

4.2 Grammar sequence by level (from the English Grammar Profile pattern; **verify against EGP [K]**)

- **A1:** be · have got · there is/are · present simple (+ questions, negatives) · can/can't · imperatives · possessives · this/that/these/those · countable/uncountable, some/any · prepositions of place/time · present continuous (now) · like + -ing · wh-questions · adverbs of frequency.
- **A2:** past simple (regular → irregular) · past continuous · comparatives/superlatives · going to / will · present perfect (experience, ever/never) · have to / must / should · quantifiers, too/enough · adverbs of manner · infinitive of purpose · first conditional (intro).
- **B1:** present perfect vs past simple · present perfect continuous · past perfect · used to · zero/first/second conditionals · passive (present/past) · reported statements · defining relative clauses · modals of deduction · linking words · phrasal verbs · future forms.
- **C1** (advanced structures agreed across teaching sources [V]; full list from the English Grammar Profile still to verify [U]): inversion after negative/restrictive adverbials and inverted conditionals · cleft sentences and fronting · mixed conditionals and the subjunctive · advanced participle/reduced clauses · ellipsis and substitution · nominalisation and complex noun phrases · passives with reporting verbs · modal nuance (*needn't have*) · hedging, stance adverbials, discourse markers · concession (*be that as it may*) · register control and collocation precision. About 2 per Season (~32 total), introduced early and recycled, not taught all at once; use inversion sparingly in writing.
- **B2:** third and mixed conditionals · passive range · reported questions/commands · non-defining relatives · future perfect/continuous · wish/if only · perfect modals · participle clauses · hedging and discourse markers · formal/informal register.

Sequencing follows learnability, not just frequency (order-of-acquisition and Processability Theory research) [K]: teach what the learner can process, re-visit forms (e.g. 3rd-person -s) in spiral recycling because they stay error-prone.

4.3 Themed Seasons — now a real roadmap

The 70 Seasons (themes, story hooks, CEFR-referenced can-dos, functions, grammar, lexical fields, pronunciation, mediation, Releases, skins) live in code and are the **single source of truth**:

- Data: `src/curriculum/academy/` (`levels/a1.ts` … `c1.ts`, `structureLevels.ts`, `validateRoadmap.ts`).
- Readable version (generated): `docs/academy-roadmap-v2.md`; regenerate with `scripts/academy-roadmap-report.ts`.
- Gate: `src/curriculum/academy/__tests__/roadmap.test.ts` (sizing, ordering rules, budgets, recycling).

It is brand new and Academy-only. The old Academy rows in the database and the Playground files are not used or changed. The theme lists that used to be here were drafts and are superseded.

---

5. Games and activities in the lesson pattern

The full catalogue (≥ 120 entries with skill, level, one-to-one adaptation and comfort rating) is `docs/academy-games-catalog.md`. **Rules for choosing from it:**

1. Pick by *what the learner must retrieve*, then by teen appeal.

2. One-to-one adaptations: teacher vs student, **student vs own best**, **teacher + student vs the game**, student-as-expert, or teacher plays the "clueless friend".
3. **Comfort rating** on every game: Low-stakes (default for Chill track and Check-in), Medium, Higher-pressure (only in Mission "Push" or Remix/Finale boss, only if the student opts in).
4. **Avoid:** public leaderboards, elimination, forced speaking/camera, visible countdowns as default.

Segment × episode map (families; pick one per segment from the catalogue, never the same twice in a row):

Segment	E1 Cold Open	E2 Word Lab	E3 Pattern Lab	E4 On Air	E5 Deep Dive	E6 Side Quest	E7 Remix	E8 Finale
Remember?	recall words from last Season	recall E1 story words	recall E2 words (type)	recall E3 pattern	recall E4 phrases	recall Season so far	cross-Season SRS	Season recap quiz vs own best
Drop	mystery message / clue	picture-word reveal	spot-the-pattern text	audio dialogue	graded text or clip	student-chosen skin text	boss briefing	finale briefing
Notice & Build	gist + true/false	match/type/dictation	find-the-pattern + builder	phrase-ladder	cloze + reading detective	free choice (2 offered)	mixed retrieval grid	checkpoint warm-up
Energiser	Would-you-rather	Wordle-style	fix-the-chat	charades/guess-who	20 questions	student's pick	rapid-fire	song / quiz
Mission	predict & share	describe-and-draw / info-gap	sentence-build duel	role-play / decision task	summarise & debate	creative project	boss round (opt-in)	peer-style task (take 1 + take 2)
Release	1-sentence opinion	voice-note: my words	written sentences	recorded dialogue	short text + rewrite	mini creation	recap clip	the Season Release

Per-skill mechanics to draw on (details in the catalogue): Vocabulary (type-the-word, spaced queue, Wordle-style, odd-one-out) · Grammar (fix-the-group-chat, tile builders, notice-the-pattern, expedition-style choose-then-justify) · Reading (branching story, detective reading, tap-gloss reader) · Listening (dictation, audio clue chains, spot-the-difference audio) · Speaking (voice-note tasks, collaborative decision, mini-debate, role-play, 2 truths & a lie, hot seat) · Writing (message/caption with rewrite, comic captions, review) · Pronunciation (shadowing, minimal-pair duels, stress-pattern tap).

Voice rule (repo hard rule): every spoken clip in listening, dictation, pronunciation or the Drop uses `speak()` with the approved recorded voices — never browser TTS.

---

6. Between sessions: the Daily 10

Acquisition needs spacing; one live hour a week is not enough alone [K]. The existing solo player and `srs.ts` /MemoryBank become a **10-minute daily set**: due items first (≈ same session → +1 → +3 → +7 → +21 → +60 days, a miss drops back to +1 [RT]), then 2–3 mixed mini-games, then one 30-s voice note. Optional, forgiving: daily goal separate from the streak, freezes, team/teacher-visible only (Duolingo's own tests: separating goal from streak helped retention [V, relative]).

---

7. Making progress felt and honest

Per-skill levels (Attempted → Familiar → Proficient → **Mastered only after a later mixed check**; levels can fall) · can-do checklist with before/after self-rating · Remember? retention score · Mistake Bank with a "fixed" counter · Training-Wheels meter · fading-skill indicator · portfolio of Releases with a **before/after recording** per Season · Season map showing episodes done · Best Line of the Session archive. Level claims ("B1") only from a **separate placement/checkpoint test** (re-test every 2 Seasons [RT]); never from XP.

---

8. Player layout and comfort (research-backed)

Layout (laptop): top bar 48–56 px (title, *stories-style segment strip* for the 8 run-of-show segments, quiet elapsed clock; no countdown) · **stage ≈ 72–75 %** (one task at a time) · right rail 280–360 px with teacher video on top, hideable self-view, chat/reactions · bottom dock 64–72 px with comfort controls · teacher-only drawer for plan/notes. **Phone:** portrait = sticky teacher video (≈ 25–30 % height, collapsible/PiP) + stage + thumb-zone dock (≥ 48 px, safe-area aware); landscape = stage 65 % + slim rail. Audio before video if bandwidth drops. Cambly/Preply/italki all use one big shared canvas + video tile/rail [V].

Style: dark-first with light option; one accent + one reward colour; 12–16 px rounded cards; big type (Lexend or Atkinson Hyperlegible; benefits of "dyslexia fonts" are weakly evidenced, don't claim them [V]). Two **theme token sets** on one layout: **Explorer (11–13)** — more colour/illustration, 18–20 px body, labelled icons; **Studio (14–18)** — muted Spotify/Discord-like palette, 16–18 px, icon-first with tooltips, subtle XP. Learner can switch; no evidence supports a hard 13/14 split [U].

12 rules: one task on stage · labels next to their object · signal what matters · don't duplicate text+speech · teacher's face visible by default · touch targets ≥ 44 px (WCAG 2.2 floor is 24 px) · body ≥ 16 px (18 for A1–A2/11–13), 45–70 char lines, contrast ≥ 4.5:1 · respect reduced-motion/colour-scheme/safe-area, no flashing · no visible timers by default · every sound has a visual equivalent + mute · feedback wording "Not yet — try again", never red-X buzzers, never colour alone · no hover-only controls.

Comfort dock (always visible to the student): Hint (tiered: picture → first letter → answer) · Slow down / Repeat · **"I need a minute"** (pauses everything, tells the teacher, calm message) · **Private rehearsal** (record → listen → send/retry) · type-instead-of-speak · emoji reactions · camera off / self-view hidden / mute / blur · **Easier / Same / Harder** dial · choose the next activity from 2 · "I'm confused" and a private "I'd like to stop" · L1 hint toggle. **Teacher cues:** soft flag when "minute"/hint is used > 3×; talk-time ratio (`TalkTimeMeter` exists); 5–7 s wait-time prompt; "switch to Chill track" suggestion.

Safety: recording only with guardian consent and a visible indicator; chat limited to the lesson, logged, filtered; no public profiles or location; COPPA (<13, US) / GDPR-K (13–16 by country) / UK Age Appropriate Design Code to be reviewed with counsel [V for the Code, U for specifics].

---

9. How we will know it works (pilot metrics)

Remember? retention score trend · Mistake Bank fixed-ratio · hints per session (↓) · student talk-time share (↑) · Release recordings compared before/after (rubric: CEFR speaking/writing descriptors) · end-of-session enjoyment emoji (≥ 80 % 😀) · attendance/Daily 10 completion · checkpoint scores and 2-Season re-tests. Pilot: 5–10 learners across 11–13 and 14–18, one full A1 Season (8 sessions), then adjust.

---

10. What the repo needs (nothing built yet)

1. **Live mode for the Academy player.** `PlayAcademyLesson` is solo-play only (its `roomId` / `role` props are documented as inert; "Phase 3 live sync" not built). Port the Playground pattern (`useSyncedState` / `activitySync` , authority side, `REAL_SYNC_KINDS`) and follow `classroom-sync-robustness` .
2. **Run-of-show model:** a `session_plan` with the 8 segments, core/flex flags, difficulty dial per segment, skins, and per-segment timing.
3. `LessonBlueprint` **fields:** `season` , `episode_type` , `skills[]` , `can_do[]` , `skin_options[]` , `release` , `recycle_from[]` ; validator: strands coverage, zero new language in E7/E8, ≤ 14 words/session, no more than two same-kind in a row.
4. **Academy roadmap data** (`cefrRoadmap.ts` returns an empty scaffold for Academy today): fill A1 first.
5. **Comfort dock, Remember? step, Mistake Bank, per-skill levels, portfolio, Daily 10** (reuse `srs.ts`).
6. **Theme tokens** for Explorer/Studio; align `supabase/functions/_shared/prompts/academy.ts` (ages 10–17, 13-type whitelist, "no sticker/reward language") with the real kinds, ages 13–18, and the Season System.
7. **Skills to update when approved:** `smart-lesson-architect` , `lesson-quality-gate` , `activity-pattern-library` , `generate-lesson` (Academy section), and the Remember rule in `CLAUDE.md` for Academy.

11. Owner decisions

Decided (2026-10-08): 1. **Season = one unit = 8 sessions: approved.** 2. **Sessions per week vary per student (1, 2 or 3).** Consequences built into the design: the roadmap is counted in *sessions*, never calendar weeks; the "Remember?" step and all spacing use **calendar days since last seen**, not "last session" (at 1 a week the last session is 7 days old, so Remember? gets longer and the Daily 10 matters more); the teacher sees an estimated finish date per student from their own pace. 3. **Go signal:** the owner will tell me when to start. Order agreed: finish gathering information and create the **skills** first, then build (A1 roadmap data → live mode → A1 Season 1 pilot).

Still open: - **Daily 10 in the first release?** (explained to the owner in chat: a short optional 10-minute practice between live sessions — due reviews, 2–3 mini-games, one voice note.) Recommendation: yes, a minimal version (due reviews + one voice note), because spacing cannot happen inside a single weekly hour. - Extra content cost of "My World" skins (3–6 per episode) — approve or reduce. - **C1 added (2026-10-08):** 16 Seasons / 128 sessions (560 sessions A1→C1); confirm the sizing or switch to the hours-strict alternative in §4.1.

Source: docs/academy-pre-a1-curriculum.md

Academy Pre-A1 curriculum — proposal (2026-10-12)

Owner request: a Pre-A1 curriculum for students with no English at all, focused on **reading and vocabulary**, slower than A1. Academy = ages 13-18 (Playground = 4-12). **Status (2026-10-14): the lean ladder (Pre-A1 Lite = Seasons P1-P3) is in `src/curriculum/academy/preA1.ts` (P1 with a built lesson, P2-P3 planned with 8 episodes each); P4-P6 (the Full ladder) are still only this proposal.**

1. Who and why

- Teen (13-18) with no English. They may read another script (Arabic) or a Latin script with different sound rules (Spanish, French, Italian, Turkish), so the first job is **letters and sounds**, not words.
- Not childish: no nursery songs, no cartoon animals. Teen worlds (club, phone, school, city) with the same cast.
- A1 lesson 1 ("Sign Me Up") assumes the student has met hello, numbers and countries at school. Pre-A1 is where a student with no school English gets there.

2. Principles (slower on purpose)

- **8 new items per session at most** (A1: 14). Every item meets **4+ varied encounters over 3+ sessions** (picture, sound, text, game, later recall).
- **Reading is in every session**: a short decodable text (letters taught so far + sight words), read aloud by the guide first, then by the student. Writing only copy-spelling and typing known words.
- **Two different memorising games after every vocabulary set** (the Academy rule) plus one retrieval warm-up at the start of the next session.
- One structure per Season, taught as a fixed **chunk** first ("My name is..."), analysed later.
- Home-language hint on, 0.8x audio, pictures on every word, no timers, "Not yet" wording.
- Comfort first: private rehearsal, type-instead-of-speak stay on.

3. Shape of a Pre-A1 session (60 minutes)

Part	Min	Job
Check-in	5	feeling, goal, no new language
Remember?	10	retrieval of the last two sessions (longer than A1's 7)
The Drop	8	picture story or scene, meaning first
Learn set 1	10	up to 4 items: teach + 2 different games
Read	8	decodable text: guide reads, student reads, tap-to-hear any word
Learn set 2	8	up to 4 items: teach + 2 different games
Mission	6	say or tap a chunk with Theo/Ava (Take 1, feedback, Take 2 short)
Wrap	5	can-dos, Daily 10, next clue

3b. Blending first, and age-appropriate (owner 2026-10-12: "focus more on blending, reading and vocabulary; it has to be age-appropriate")

- **Blending is the spine of the level.** Every session has a blending routine of 3-5 minutes inside the Read part: see the letters, hear each sound, slide them together (s-i-t → sit), then read the word, then read it in a line. Sound set grows by about 3 per Season; words are decodable from the sounds taught so far. Sight words (I, a, is, the, my, you...) are taught as whole words, a few at a time, because they cannot be blended.
- **Vocabulary is chosen to be read, not only seen:** words that can be blended now and matter to a teenager come first (cap, bag, bus, van, pen, map, phone, tap, pin, hat, sun, red, bed). Words that cannot be blended yet (phone, school) are taught as whole-word pictures and read as sight words.
- **Age-appropriate decodables:** teen scenes, no childish stories. Example lines: "Sam has a van. Tim has a cap." / "Dan sits on a bus." / "Mia has a pen. It is red." Cast: Vee, Ava, Theo (plus Mia in the Pre-A1 level if the owner adds her to the vault). Topics: phone, bus, bag, cap, music, football, friends. No nursery rhymes, no animal-mascot readers, no baby voices.
- **Look:** Studio-style text, real teen scenes (the club desk, the bus stop, the school gate), clean illustrated word cards; the blend slider is a game-like control (letters slide together with a click sound), not a worksheet.
- **Check:** every reading page is tested against the sounds taught (a decodability test: every word is blendable or a taught sight word).

4. Seasons (6 Seasons x 8 sessions = 48 sessions, about 24 weeks at 2 a week)

Target by the end: about 220 words, the alphabet names and about 25 letter-sound patterns, and the ability to read a 5-sentence profile. Lists are first drafts for the roadmap architect to check against the A1 Season 1 items.

#	Season (theme)	Reading focus	Vocabulary (about)	Chunk / structure
P1	**Hello, letters** (club desk)	alphabet names A-Z, own name, sound of the first letters	20: hello, name, me, you, yes, no, hi, bye, boy, girl, friend...	My name is ___.
P2	**First sounds** (phone)	s a t p i n m d: blend 3-letter words, sight words I / a / is / the / my	30: sit, tap, pin, man, dad... + 8 sight words	This is a ___.
P3	**Numbers and age** (lockers)	numerals 0-20 ↔ words, teen numbers 13-18 (thir-TEEN vs THIR-ty), digits one by one (phone number)	25: 0-20, age, old, phone, number	I am ___. How old are you?
P4	**My things** (school bag)	next sound set (o u e c k r h b...), read captions and labels	40 nouns: school and home	It is a / an ___. a vs an
P5	**People and places** (world map)	read 3-sentence texts	40: family, countries, nationalities	I am from ___. I am ___.

#	Season (theme)	Reading focus	Vocabulary (about)	Chunk / structure
P6	**My day** (city)	read 5-sentence texts, tap-to-hear	50: routine verbs, days, o'clock	I like ___. I go to ___. + Pre-A1 check

Exit task of the level: read a 5-sentence profile of a cast member and answer 5 questions; say 5 sentences about yourself. Pass = move to A1 Season 1 (where "Sign Me Up" becomes a revision lesson).

5. How it fits the roadmap

- A new level before A1 ("Pre-A1", 6 Seasons, 48 sessions, about 220 words) would change the roadmap totals (A1 10, A2 12, B1 16, B2 16, C1 16 = 70 Seasons / 560 sessions becomes 76 / 608) and the validators and tests that assert those totals. That is a code change in `src/curriculum/academy` (types, `levels/`, `validateRoadmap`, blueprint, tests) and needs the owner's OK first.
- Placement: a 5-minute adaptive check plus the student's own choice; the lane idea from Sample 2 can be reused (a student who starts at A1 and struggles is offered Pre-A1).
- New mechanics to build for reading: tap-to-hear text, sound-blend slider (s-i-t → sit), word-to-picture reading match, decodable reader page. These are not in the player yet.

6. Research (2026-10-12) and its limits

- Starter-level (Pre-A1) readers use a phonics page plus a sight-word page for the same story (Ladybird Readers Starter); the series targets ages 4-7, so the method may transfer but the stories will not. No teen Pre-A1 reader or published first-100-words list was found.
- Course sizes for Starters-level prep vary a lot by source (200-436 words in third-party listings; no official Cambridge count found); Oxford Phonics World levels list 75-100+ words per level in its app (Oxford Phonics World). So the 220-word target is our own judgement.
- Earlier sources: oral-first, chunks, recycling, TPR (TEFL.net, EBC TEFL); too many new words overloads beginners (Teaching Vocabulary to ELLs).

7. Decisions needed

1. Add Pre-A1 to the roadmap code (6 Seasons / 48 sessions)? Or keep it as a docs-only plan until A1 is finished?
2. Build the reading mechanics (tap-to-hear text, sound blend, decodable reader) before the first Pre-A1 lesson?
3. Does the first Pre-A1 lesson follow "Hello, letters" (P1, session 1)?

Source: docs/academy-pre-a1-reading-first.md

Pre-A1 reading-first design note (owner, 2026-10-15)

Rule: `CLAUDE.md` "Pre-A1 is reading-first". Research: `docs/research/academy-pre-a1-reading-research.md`.

The four steps in every Pre-A1 lesson

Step	Where (the 8-part run of show)	What the student does	Slide kinds
1 Activate	Check-in	taps "I know it" / "New to me" for the words of the day; the teacher sees what is already known	`sort` (no wrong answers)
2 Sounds and blending	Learn, Remember?	hears the sound, blends letters into words, spells them	`teach`, `rhythm` / `hearpick`, `blend`, `spell`
3 Read	Read (11 min)	decodable lines, then a short message from a character; read twice (listen, then read); tap any word to hear it	`reader`, `passage`
4 Word bank	Read, Wrap, Daily 10	keeps the words they want from the message; plays listen-and-match with the word tiles; the bank comes back on the spaced schedule	`passage` (keep), `match` (word tiles), recall plan

Text rules

- A text uses only the sounds taught so far plus the lesson's sight words (`taughtSounds`, `sightWords`, checked by `decodable.ts`); a few lines at first, growing each lesson.
- Teen content: a lock-screen message, a chat, a caption, a label. Never a child's story.
- Decodable lines are the bridge, not the whole diet: the message page is real-looking text with taught words.
- The words a student keeps become **practice items** (Remember? and the Daily 10 return them after 1, 2, 4, 8 and 16 lessons).

Pre-A1 S2 L1 example

Activate: phone, map, pin, tin, in, it. Sounds: i, n. Blend: in, it, pin, tin. Read: "It is a pin. It is a tin." then two short messages from Theo and Ava. Word bank: pin, tin, map, phone, in, it, is.

Status (2026-10-15)

- **Plan data for all 40 Pre-A1 episodes** (P1-P5, eight lessons each): `src/curriculum/academy/preA1Reading.ts`, checked by `readingProblems()` (every text readable from the sounds and words taught by that episode, bank words in the message). Shown in the creator Academy Library under each Pre-A1 lesson and in `docs/academy-curriculum/pre-a1.md`.
- **Built as a deck:** P1 E1 (Name Wall, earlier build, no passage page yet) and P2 E1 (reading-first, v3). Lessons P1 E2 to P5 E8 are plans only: each needs its own approved lesson plan (with this reading block), research file, scenario and plates before it is built.
- **To do for P1 E1:** it predates this rule; its plan needs the activate step, a message and a word bank before it counts as reading-first.

8. Check against the platform

Each claim in the supplied deck and notes was compared with the curriculum code (`src/curriculum/academy`), the lesson as built, and the project documents on 16 October 2026.

Claim in the deck / notes	Result	What the platform says
80 Seasons, 640 sessions; A1 12, A2 14, B1 18, B2 18, C1 18	✓ matches	SEASONS_PER_LEVEL in the code.
51 minutes core + 9 minutes flex; stage times 5 / 7 / 10 / 10 / 4 / 12 / 7 / 5	✓ matches	RUN_OF_SHOW: Check-in 5 (flex), Remember? 7, The Drop 10, Notice & Build 10, Energiser 4 (flex), Mission 12, Release 7, Wrap 5 = 60, core 51.
Remember? starts with the student's own Mistake Bank; 8–12 items, ≥ 60% production, feedback on every item	✓ matches	Same wording in the run-of-show requirements.
≤ 14 new items per session, ≤ 8 in Pre-A1, zero in E7 and E8	✓ matches	MAX_ITEMS_PER_SESSION = 14; Pre-A1 maximum 8; Remix and Finale introduce nothing.
Talk-time floors Pre-A1 40% … C1 65%	✓ matches (student floors)	SPEAKING_TARGETS in speaking.ts. The older figures (≥ 60% A1, ≥ 70% B1+, ≥ 75% C1) in the learning-science document are superseded. A teacher-talk cap of 40% is not coded.
Speaking ladder Shadow → Repeat → Controlled → Guided → Free	✓ matches	SPEAKING_LADDER; each level has the step it must reach.
Cast: Vee, Ava, Theo, Mia; no childish mascots	✓ matches	Cast vault; Pip is a Playground character and may not appear in the Academy (hub separation).
Variety gate (no triple repeat, ≥ 5 game kinds, fresh setting)	✓ matches	lessonVariety deploy test.
At least 80 student responses per hour	✓ matches	Project rule; checked in the lesson tests.
Six-strand checkpoint at the Finale	✓ matches	Unit assessment in checklist.ts marks six strands and the Release rubric.
Every item met at least 6 times across 4 skills or modes within the hour	⚠ not a project rule → adjusted	The project's own research says there is **no magic number** of encounters and rejects an "8–12 encounters" rule. Pre-A1 uses 4+ varied encounters over 3+ sessions. **Adjusted in the installed skill:** aim for at least **4 encounters in at least 3 modes** (hear, read, say, write) per new item inside the lesson, then the spaced returns; 6 is a stretch goal, never stated as a fact.
E1 introduces at most 12 receptive items	⚠ partly	The hard cap is 14 per session. E1's count comes from the Season budget (about 14% weight); B1 Season 1 Episode 1 has 12.
Student talk-time and the energy arc as mathematical guarantees of fluency	? unverified	Rhetoric in the deck. The project documents avoid claiming outcomes by a date and mark research limits (no human teacher has reviewed the plan).
Games catalogue size	⚠ differs	The catalogue lists 171 entries; the activity-selector skill text still says 148.
Standard stage times apply to every lesson	⚠ differs for B1-S01-E1	The B1 lesson as built uses its own split of 3 / 3 / 20 / 13 / 3 / 9 / 5 / 4 minutes (longer Drop for the story, listening, reading and cloze), allowed when the content needs it; the hour still adds to 60.
Skill file stored at `.claude/skills/academy-curriculum-lesson-blueprint.md`	✓ fixed: installed in the folder format	The repo's skills are folders: `.claude/skills/<name>/SKILL.md` with `name` and `description` front matter (all twelve `academy-*` skills follow it). A flat `.md` file is not picked up. It is now installed as `.claude/skills/academy-curriculum-lesson-blueprint/SKILL.md` (16 October 2026).
Academy code isolated in `src/curriculum/academy/` ; fails `isolation.test.ts` on Playground or Success imports	✓ matches	`isolation.test.ts` exists and allows only relative imports inside that folder (plus vitest and Node built-ins in tests). The lesson decks live separately in `src/academy-deck` .
Hard cap `MAX_ITEMS_PER_SESSION = 14` (≤ 8 Pre-A1, 0 in E7 and E8)	✓ matches	In `types.ts` and the item validators.
Stage lengths may flex "as long as total core timing equals 51 minutes"	⚠ not true as stated → corrected in the skill	The standard split has 51 core minutes, but the lesson as built (3 / 3 / 20 / 13 / 3 / 9 / 5 / 4) has 54 core and 6 flex minutes. The tests require the hour to add to 60, each required part to fill 70–125% of its minutes, and optional pages to stay within a limit. Say "60 minutes in total", not "51 core", for lessons that override the split.
Sample Episode 3 (A2): "prefer + verb-ing to verb-ing"	⚠ replaced	The invented "prefer … to …" pattern was not a verified A2 placement. The installed skill's sample now uses the real roadmap structure of **A2-S03 "Gadget Wars": comparatives and superlatives**, and tells the author to take structures and item budgets from the Season outline, never to invent them. The sample is still an illustration and has not been through the item validators.

Suggested follow-ups. (1) Decide whether "6 encounters per item per lesson" becomes a measured target (the lesson tests could count encounters per item) or is dropped. (2) Update the activity-selector skill text from 148 to 171 games. (3) Code the teacher-talk cap of 40% if you want it enforced. (4) State in the blueprint which lessons override the standard split (B1-S01-E1 does). (5) Done: the skill is installed in the folder format with these corrections.

9. Appendix: the Claude Code skill and the lesson JSON contract (proposal)

Status. This is the **repository-aligned version** of the skill supplied on 16 October 2026 (“academy-curriculum-lesson-blueprint”). A corrected version is now **installed** in the repository as `.claude/skills/academy-curriculum-lesson-blueprint/SKILL.md` (16 October 2026); the JSON contract itself is **not implemented** in the platform. Part 8 lists what was checked and what was corrected.

What the skill sets out

Area	Content	Check (Part 8)
Location	`.claude/skills/academy-curriculum-lesson-blueprint`. The repository format is a folder with `SKILL.md` and `name` / `description` front matter.	✓ installed in the folder format
Module isolation	Academy code lives only in `src/curriculum/academy/` (80 Seasons in `levels/a1.ts` to `c1.ts`); imports from Playground or Success are forbidden and fail `isolation.test.ts`.	✓
Item cap	`MAX_ITEMS_PER_SESSION = 14`; at most 8 in Pre-A1; 0 in E7 Remix and E8 Finale.	✓
Timing	60 minutes: the standard split is 51 core + 9 flex (5 / 7 / 10 / 10 / 4 / 12 / 7 / 5). Stages 3, 4, 6 and 7 may flex when an episode needs longer story plates or reading text.	✓ corrected: total 60; core is not always 51 (B1-S01-E1: 54 core, 6 flex)
Games	The 171-game catalogue in `docs/academy-games-catalog.md` and the video-game mechanics (boss fight, dialogue RPG and visual novel, detective board and bug hunt, crafting and loot, match-3, quiz ladder, word puzzle, deduction and bluffing).	✓
Mandate	Teens only: no childish mascots (Pip is a Playground character), no public leaderboards; cast Vee, Ava, Theo, Mia; four skills in real-life tasks; Harmer ESA and Nation’s Four Strands; a target of at least 4 encounters in at least 3 modes per new item inside the lesson (6 is a stretch goal).	✓ adjusted (the “6 per lesson” claim was not a project rule)
Speaking	Ladder Shadow → Repeat → Controlled → Guided → Free; student talk floors Pre-A1 40% to C1 65%; teacher talk ≤ 40%.	✓ student floors; teacher cap not coded
Comfort and gates	Co-op and personal best only; no speaking timers; private before public; no triple repeats, at least five distinct game kinds, fresh scene settings.	✓
Output	One JSON object: `unit_meta`, `knowledge_bridge`, and eight `run_of_show` stages.	proposal

Sample 1: Episode 1 (Cold Open), A2

```
{
  "unit_meta": { "hub": "academy", "cefr_level": "a2", "season_number": 1, "episode_number": 1,
    "episode_type": "E1_Cold_Open", "theme": "digital_identity_and_online_profiles", "target_talk_time_pct": 50,
    "target_chunks": ["I'm known online as...", "I'm really into...", "I consider myself...", "I'm not much of a..."] },
  "knowledge_bridge": {
    "prior_knowledge": "Basic present simple verbs and self-introductions (A1)",
    "current_knowledge": "4 prefabricated stance chunks + compound preference linking",
    "future_knowledge": "Streaming schedules and routine frequency adverbs (E2)" },
  "run_of_show": [
    { "stage_number": 1, "stage_name": "Check-in", "duration_min": 5, "activity_type": "intro",
      "content": { "mood_selection_cards": ["Energized","Chill","Focused","Tired"], "warmup_questions": ["What game or show did you jump into
yesterday?"],
                   "mission_title": "Design Your Gamer Bio Card", "success_criteria": ["State your online handle","Express 2 strong gaming/tech
preferences using stance chunks"] } },
    { "stage_number": 2, "stage_name": "Remember?", "duration_min": 7, "activity_type": "quiz_ladder",
      "content": { "game_name": "Hot Seat Spaced Retrieval", "mistake_bank_items": ["I am agree -> I agree","He like -> He likes"],
"due_spacing_items": ["playing games","streamer"] } },
    { "stage_number": 3, "stage_name": "The Drop", "duration_min": 10, "activity_type": "dialogue_rpg",
      "content": { "scene_plate": "Rooftop Studio (Sunset)", "cast_characters": ["Vee","Theo"], "story_script": "Vee shows Theo her new Esports
squad profile...", "memorizing_games": ["Listen-and-Match","Flip Memory"] } },
    { "stage_number": 4, "stage_name": "Notice & Build", "duration_min": 10, "activity_type": "sentence_builder",
      "content": { "inductive_task": "Grammar Detective: Spot how Vee links 'because' with 'into'",
                   "plain_rule_max_3_lines": "Use 'into' + [Noun/Verb-ing] to show passion. Add 'because' to give a reason.",
                   "emtas_substitution_table": { "columns": [ {"id":"col1","label":"Subject","options":["I","My partner"]},
{"id":"col2","label":"Stance Chunk","options":["am really into","is really into"]}, {"id":"col3","label":"Genre","options":["open-world
RPGs","competitive FPS"]} ] },
                   "game_engine": "Break the Clock Boss Fight" } },
    { "stage_number": 5, "stage_name": "Energiser", "duration_min": 4, "activity_type": "word_puzzle",
      "content": { "game_name": "Participle Wordle", "zero_stakes": true, "no_timer": true } },
    { "stage_number": 6, "stage_name": "Mission", "duration_min": 12, "activity_type": "roleplay",
      "content": { "help_dial_options": ["Chill","Normal","Push"], "task_take_1": "Interview Theo about his gaming channel and agree on a squad
name",
                   "feedback_mechanism": "On-screen error fix + audio prompt", "task_take_2": "Repeat interview applying feedback" } },
    { "stage_number": 7, "stage_name": "Release", "duration_min": 7, "activity_type": "portfolio_product",
      "content": { "product_type": "60-Second Audio Gamer Bio", "model_hidden": true, "private_first": true } },
    { "stage_number": 8, "stage_name": "Wrap", "duration_min": 5, "activity_type": "metacognition",
      "content": { "can_do_self_evaluation": true, "log_mistakes_count_max_3": 3, "daily_10_assignment": "Unit 1 Episode 1 Daily 10 Spaced Pack" }
} ]
}
```

Sample 2: Episode 3 (Pattern Lab), A2-S03 “Gadget Wars” (as installed in the skill)

> Uses the real structure of the Season outline: comparatives and superlatives. It shows the JSON shape only; item counts and wording have not been through the validators. The first version of this sample (an invented “prefer … to …” pattern) was replaced.


```
{
  "unit_meta": { "hub": "academy", "cefr_level": "a2", "season": "A2-S03", "episode_number": 3, "episode_type": "pattern-lab",
    "theme": "Gadget Wars: comparing technology", "target_talk_time_pct": 50,
    "target_structure": "comparatives and superlatives (from the Season outline)",
    "target_chunks": ["It's faster than...", "It's much more expensive.", "The best one is...", "Which is better?"] },
  "knowledge_bridge": { "prior_knowledge": "A2-S01/S02 past tense stories; E1-E2 gadget words",
    "current_knowledge": "one structure: comparative adjectives (-er, more ... than) with short, regular adjectives first",
    "future_knowledge": "E4 On Air: persuade a friend which gadget to buy; E6 superlatives in a review" },
  "run_of_show": [
    { "stage_number": 1, "stage_name": "Check-in", "minutes": 5, "activity_type": "intro", "content": { "mission": "Choose the better gadget and
say why", "success_criteria": ["Say one comparison with -er or more ... than", "Give one reason"] } },
    { "stage_number": 2, "stage_name": "Remember?", "minutes": 7, "activity_type": "quiz_ladder", "content": { "mistake_bank_items": ["more fast ->
faster"], "due_items": ["screen", "battery", "price"] } },
    { "stage_number": 3, "stage_name": "The Drop", "minutes": 10, "activity_type": "story_plates", "content": { "cast": ["Vee", "Theo"], "plates":
3, "modelled_lines": ["Theo: This phone is faster than mine.", "Vee: But mine is cheaper."] } },
    { "stage_number": 4, "stage_name": "Notice & Build", "minutes": 10, "activity_type": "detective_board", "content": { "rule_max_3_lines":
["Short adjective: add -er (fast -> faster).", "Long adjective: more + adjective (more expensive).", "Then use than: faster than my phone."],
"games": ["Grammar Detective", "Break the Clock"] } },
    { "stage_number": 5, "stage_name": "Energiser", "minutes": 4, "activity_type": "word_puzzle", "content": { "game": "Wordle", "no_timer": true }
},
    { "stage_number": 6, "stage_name": "Mission", "minutes": 12, "activity_type": "roleplay", "content": { "dial": ["Chill", "Normal", "Push"],
"take_1": "Compare two gadgets with Theo", "feedback": "one specific fix", "take_2": "Do it again with the fix" } },
    { "stage_number": 7, "stage_name": "Release", "minutes": 7, "activity_type": "portfolio_product", "content": { "product": "three-sentence
gadget comparison", "model_hidden": true, "private_first": true } },
    { "stage_number": 8, "stage_name": "Wrap", "minutes": 5, "activity_type": "metacognition", "content": { "can_do_ticks": true, "log_errors_max":
3, "daily_10": "A2-S03 E3 pack", "teach_back": "state the rule in your own words" } }
  ]
}
```

10. The top-quality lesson standard (all skills combined)

> **Source.** The 13 Academy skills in `.claude/skills/` (read on 16 October 2026), the repository rules in `CLAUDE.md`, and the expert-teaching research round of 16 October 2026 (`docs/research/academy-expert-teaching-research.md`, including the one-to-one online section). Where research is thin the text says so. Nothing here has been tested with a real student.

10.1 Which skill answers which question

Skill	The question it answers	Use it when
academy-season-system	What are the master rules (levels, Seasons, 8 episodes, non-negotiables)?	First, for any Academy work.
academy-roadmap-architect	What is the Season: theme, story arc, clue per episode, words and structures within budget, validators?	Creating or changing a Season.
academy-lesson-craft	What can the student *do* at the end, and does every screen serve it?	Before writing any lesson; again before "done".
academy-session-builder	What is the minute-by-minute plan: Last-Time card, Remember?, Drop, Notice & Build, Mission, Release, Wrap, Chill track, Plan B?	Turning an episode into a 60-minute plan.
academy-activity-selector	Which game fits this cognitive job, level, theme and student need?	Choosing every mechanic.
academy-deck-craft	How is the lesson authored as a deck of full-scene slides, each with one game?	Writing the lesson file.
academy-game-ui	Does it look and feel like a video game (the dullness test)?	Designing every screen.
academy-player-ux	Layout, comfort dock, teacher and student roles, sync, accessibility, safety.	Player and live-class behaviour.
academy-assessment-designer	How do we measure acquisition without scaring teens (checks, rubrics, checkpoints)?	Any quiz, checkpoint or rubric.
academy-daily-practice	What happens between lessons (Daily 10, homework, spacing by calendar day)?	Planning practice outside the live hour.
academy-learner-diagnostics	What does this student need more of (knowledge items, error taxonomy, decision rules)?	Adapting the next lesson and the Daily 10.
academy-curriculum-lesson-blueprint	One-page master reference plus the expert-teaching checks.	Reviewing any plan; onboarding.
academy-quality-gate	12 checks plus research, plan, speaking, recall and checklist checks.	Before reporting anything done.

10.2 The build order (one route through all skills)

Step	Do this	Skill	Proof
1	Read the Season and the episode in the roadmap; list what the student already knows and the home-language problems (ar, es, fr, tr, it).	season-system, roadmap-architect, learner-diagnostics	Student-need paragraph in the plan.
2	Write the objective as one observable performance, 3–5 "I can" criteria, the exit task (model hidden), and the language inventory the exit task needs.	lesson-craft	Objective, criteria, inventory.
3	Research the internet again (Oxford, Cambridge, British Council, GSE, apps, one-to-one platforms): mechanics only, with sources, quality, limits, verified/unverified.	CLAUDE.md research rule, quality-gate	`docs/research/academy-<lesson>-research.md`.
4	Build the 60-minute plan: Run of Show, response counts (≥ 80 per hour), speaking ladder step, Remember? from the recall plan, model and the rule (≤ 3 lines) before practice, teach-back at the end.	session-builder, daily-practice	Minute-by-minute table; traceability table (every activity names its criterion).
5	Choose the games: two different memorising games after every vocabulary introduction, ≥ 5 different games, one video-game mechanic with what the student says in English.	activity-selector	Games list and video-game mechanic.
6	Get the owner's written approval of the plan. **No scenes, art or audio before this.**	CLAUDE.md plan rule	`ownerApproved`.
7	Author the deck: a full-scene plate per slide, one game each, `stage` and `trains` on every slide.	deck-craft, game-ui, player-ux	Alignment matrix: every criterion has ≥ 3 slides and the last is production.
8	Write the assessment: Remember? checks, exit check, rubric.	assessment-designer	Rubric per criterion; delayed items ≥ 20%.
9	Run tests, the comfort audit, the voice audit; play it in a browser at 390 and 1280 px; run the gate.	quality-gate	Gate report with evidence; unverified facts listed.
10	Hand-off and preview (library, preview link); pilot with a real teacher and a real student before calling it ready.	CLAUDE.md	Teacher notes after the pilot.

10.3 What top quality means: the combined bar

A lesson meets the bar only when **all** rows hold, with evidence. The first column says where the rule comes from.

Area	Standard	Source
Objective	One observable performance at the student's level, 3–5 checkable criteria, an exit task with the model hidden; a student who did every screen could do it (reach test).	lesson-craft; CEFR can-do
Order	Nothing is asked that has not been shown: context → model (I do) → rule → controlled practice (we do) → free practice → production (you do) → teach-back. Task-first episodes: pre-task → task → language focus.	session-builder; Ellis principles 2–3; PPP vs task-based discussion
Four strands	Input, output, language-focused learning and fluency all appear. The fluency task is a *repetition* with no new language.	Nation four strands; Bygate on task repetition
Take 2	Take 2 changes one thing (new listener, tighter time, new angle). "Try again" alone is not a repetition.	Task repetition research
Feedback	Nudge → clue → direct fix. Correct after a fluency task, not mid-sentence. End every error on a success. Log up to three recurring errors.	Li 2010; Lyster & Saito 2010; teacher checklist
Vocabulary	Picture and meaning for every word; ≤ 14 items; two different memorising games after each introduction; each word used in a sentence about the student the same lesson (need, search, evaluation); returned on the spaced schedule.	session-builder; involvement-load studies; spacing meta-analysis
Spacing and recall	Remember? from the recall plan (production first, ≥ 60% production); Daily 10 on the calendar. The exact expansion matters less than the total number of spaced retrievals; adults gain from longer gaps.	daily-practice; spacing research
Listening	Predict → listen → compare → listen again → reflect.	Goh & Vandergrift
Reading	About 95–98% known words (a design target, not a law); tap-to-gloss for the rest; Pre-A1 follows the reading-first rule.	Hu & Nation and its limits; CLAUDE.md
Speaking	Student talk and speaking minutes at or above the level target; ladder shadow → repeat → controlled → guided → free; being understood is the aim, not losing an accent; one high-impact error at a time.	speaking.ts; Munro & Derwing
Comfort	Private before public; no timers on speaking; type instead of speak always available; no ranking; friendly wording; targets ≥ 44 px. Lower speaking anxiety raises willingness to speak.	player-ux; anxiety and WTC studies
Look and feel	Full-bleed daytime school scene, a character, a tactile action, a reaction in 200 ms, one block of text; passes the dullness test at 390 and 1280 px; no zoom or pan on pictures; recorded voices only.	game-ui; CLAUDE.md
Games	Games with a story and a short teacher wrap-up are the better-supported kind; no two same-kind in a row; one signature game; never childish.	Game-based learning meta-analyses (design moderates effect)
Assessment	Each can-do is assessed; production-weighted; one construct per item; distractors from real errors; untimed; retry allowed; teacher checklist feeds the family report.	assessment-designer; checklist.ts
Claims	No promised CEFR level by a date; evidence labelled verified / weak / unverified; no effect sizes quoted from summaries.	quality-gate check 12

10.4 One-to-one online: what to design for

Evidence is thin. No study of online one-to-one English for teenagers was found. These are design choices from general tutoring research, small studies and practitioner advice, not proven rules.

Design choice	Why (source and limit)
Frequent short contact between lessons (Daily 10, voice notes)	Tutoring meta-analysis: larger effects with teacher-level tutors and frequent sessions (≥ 3 a week). General school subjects, mostly younger pupils.
A real 2–3 minute check-in and a warm sign-off; use the name and goals	A study of rapport online suggests contact at the edges of sessions builds rapport. University students; practitioner advice agrees.
Change activity every 5–8 minutes; one focus per screen; do not read text while the teacher talks	Videoconferencing studies report fatigue and higher cognitive load from dual-modal video. Small samples.
Use the shared screen, chat and reactions as extra channels	Hampel & Stickler on multimodal interaction (abstract only).
Teach turn-taking and repair phrases ("Could you say that again?", "Do you mean…?")	Conversation-analysis pedagogy (Wong & Waring); a one-to-one student has no classmates to follow.
Student leads the Remember? and the error-log review	Practitioner advice: student-led work lowers teacher talk. Not tested online.
Plan B if the connection fails (conversation-only version)	Session-builder requirement.

10.5 Worked audit: B1-S01-E1 "Have You Ever…? Cold Open" against this standard

What this is. A partial audit from the lesson's slide data read on 16 October 2026. The four gaps it found were fixed the same day (37 slides; parts now 3 / 3 / 22 / 11 / 3 / 9 / 5 / 4 minutes; the cloze became optional and the second memory game was removed to keep the hour). It is **not** a full run of the 12-check quality gate and no student has played it.

Check	Result	Evidence / what to do
Model and rule before practice; teach-back	✓ pass	Teacher model slides (`teach-words` , `model-task`), rule slide `rule-trio` before the controlled games, `teach-back` at the end.
Two different memorising games after the vocabulary	✓ pass	`teach-words` → `match-words` → `mem-words` .

Check	Result	Evidence / what to do
Every slide names a criterion (`trains`)	✓ pass	All teaching and practice slides carry `trains` ; title, brief, dial and wrap are frames.
Each criterion ends in production	✓ **fixed 16 Oct**	Criterion 2 (the vocabulary) now ends in production: `my-list` has a third row, "use one of the six words about you".
Listening check follows predict → listen → compare → reflect	✓ **fixed 16 Oct**	New slide `predict` (guess the dare) before the story; `listen-q` has a teacher cue to reflect. Replay is already available.
Take 2 is a real repetition	✓ **fixed 16 Oct**	Take 2 now changes the listener: Theo asks one follow-up ("When did…?"), answered in the past simple with a time.
Four strands present	✓ pass (check balance in a pilot)	Input: story, listening, blog. Output: Take 1 and 2, writing, Release. Language-focused: rule, forge, streak. Fluency: Take 2 and the Release; the optional Verb Draw adds a free chat.
Feedback ladder	✓ pass	Hints on every slide; teacher checklist records up to three errors.
Variety (≥ 5 game kinds, none three in a row)	✓ pass	Gate tests pass; 12 slides are optional so a teacher can trim to time.
Comfort tools in the live class	? confirm	On 15 October the owner asked to remove the "I need a minute" and "More" buttons from the class view. Gate check 5 asks for a comfort dock. **Confirm** which comfort controls the student still has.
Vocabulary pictures	× open	Art for the six words is not generated yet (Canva cooldown); the matching games need it.
Blueprint words vs taught words	× open	The blueprint lists 12 receptive items (for example expedition, remote, tent); the lesson teaches six different words plus six participles. Decide which list is right.
English Grammar Profile / GSE placement	? unverified	Official placement of "present perfect: experience" was not retrieved; the roadmap says "A2 late / B1".
L1 notes for the teacher	✓ **fixed 16 Oct** (note on the rule slide)	Added: tr/ar use the past simple instead of the present perfect; it/es/fr add finished-time words ("yesterday I have seen"); it *da*, es *desde*, fr *depuis* for "for/since". Teach the time-word rule early.
Pilot	× open	No real teacher or student has run the lesson. Timing, fatigue and anxiety are unknown.

10.6 What this standard does not claim

- It does not promise a CEFR level by a date or a learning gain; the research supports *practices*, not guarantees.
- It is not CELTA/Delta reviewed. The Scrivener, Ur, Thornbury and Harmer texts and the CELTA syllabus were not retrieved.
- Effect sizes from summaries (feedback, games, tutoring) were not quoted; check the originals before any public use.
- Online one-to-one evidence for teenagers is thin; a pilot is the only real test.